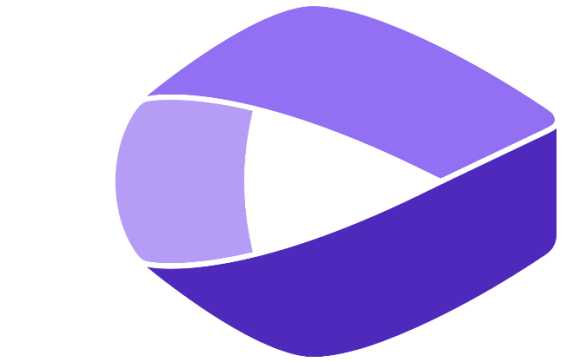


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Capstone Project
Acko: Building Confident First-Time Health Insurance Purchase

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Date: 14-11-2026

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Step 1: Market & User Research

Evidence base: survey of 68 people, 7 recorded interviews and about 10 informal conversations (5 to 9 November 2026); product teardown of Acko, Policybazaar, HDFC ERGO and ICICI Lombard (10 November 2026); review of the Acko Health II policy wording (UIN ACKHLIP27042V022627). People are described by their role, not their name.

1. Research questions and hypotheses

Headline: first-time buyers mostly can't predict what their plan will and won't pay for, even when the terms are written in plain language. Price matters, but it's a secondary barrier.

#	Research question	Hypothesis	What the research showed	Verdict
RQ1	What makes a first-time buyer start looking?	A health or family trigger starts the search, not a plan	Mixed triggers: relatives' health scares, COVID and peer pressure, and a sense that 'everyone needs one'. 3 of 68 said a parent's age made them act; 7 said office cover felt enough.	Partly supported
RQ2	After seeing the price, what do buyers still need to know?	What the plan will actually pay, not more options	Top doubts after the price: 'will it actually pay' (20), exclusions and waiting periods (15), which plan or cover amount (12). Only 2 questioned whether the price was fair. One interviewee expected about 80% of a family hospital bill to be paid and received 40 to 50%.	Supported
RQ3	Do buyers correctly read the terms that decide a claim?	Most misread waiting periods and assume full cover	36 of 68 (53%) got the cataract waiting-period question wrong or weren't sure; 16 thought the plan pays in full. 5 of 7 interviewees couldn't answer it at first. Cataract is item 1 on Acko Health II's own specified-disease waiting-period list (clause 4.1.2).	Supported
RQ4	How do family and language shape the decision?	The buyer can't explain the plan at home, so the decision stalls	37 of 68 were buying for family. 14 named family discussion as a blocker; 10 needed a spouse or parent to agree. The family questions buyers couldn't answer were about payout. 21 of 68 prefer a language other than English. None of the 4 sites lets a buyer share the plan with family before buying.	Supported
RQ5	Where do buyers go for help, and whom do they trust?	They leave the insurer to get things explained	Relied on most: family or friends (20), agents or banks (12), comparison sites (10), insurer apps (9), YouTube (7). Two interviewees use ChatGPT or Gemini to decode clauses.	Supported
RQ6	How do sales pressure and trust affect the decision?	Lead capture brings spam calls, and low prices trigger suspicion	10 of 68 named sales calls as a blocker; the most common complaint in informal conversations. All 4 sites ask for a phone number before showing a price; Policybazaar, HDFC ERGO and ICICI Lombard followed up with calls or messages; Acko called once, the day after the quote. Two interviewees called Acko's offer 'too good to be true', but only after it was pitched to them.	Partly supported

#	Research question	Hypothesis	What the research showed	Verdict
RQ7	Is price the main barrier?	No, it's secondary to understanding	9 named price; 9 said the premium was too high or jumped after adding parents; 11 wanted cheaper plans for young people. Real but secondary.	Partly refuted

2. Research plan

Buyer segments (survey Q1)

Segment	Survey (n=68)	Recorded interviews	Why it matters
Got a quote, didn't buy	12	1	The exact cohort behind the brief's 12%
Looked, then postponed	14	4	Where intent turns into stalling
Bought a plan	15	1	What tipped them over, and what they still misread
Haven't looked yet	16	1	Inertia, mostly 'office cover is enough'
Already had a personal plan	11	0	Comparison group

15 respondents got a quote on Acko's app or website.

Methods

Method	Sample	What it answers	Why this method
Online survey (13 questions)	68	How common each doubt and blocker is	Breadth: sizes the problem by segment
Recorded phone interviews (1.5 to 18.5 min)	7	Why buyers stall, in their own words	Depth: explains the survey results
Informal conversations at a Diwali gathering	About 10	Whether the themes hold in an informal setting	Triangulation
Product teardown	Acko, Policybazaar, HDFC ERGO, ICICI Lombard	How terms are shown at each step	What buyers actually see, not just what they recall
Policy wording review	Acko Health II	What the contract says about waiting periods, exclusions and cost-sharing	Checks every claim against the source

The interview guide was built on the Jobs-to-be-Done forces of progress (push, pull, anxiety, habit) and The Mom Test (ask about past behaviour, not hypotheticals). Guest, Bunce and Johnson (2006) found most themes appear within 6 to 12 interviews.

Timeline

Date	Activity
5 to 8 Nov 2026	Survey live, 68 responses
8 Nov 2026	About 10 informal conversations; field notes written afterwards
By 9 Nov 2026	7 recorded interviews, transcribed and summarised
10 Nov 2026	Product teardown of 4 sites; Acko Health II policy wording reviewed
12 Nov 2026	Count calls and messages received in the 48 hours after the teardown

Limitations

- A convenience sample from the researcher's network, mostly salaried professionals.
- In 4 interviews, Acko's offer was described before asking for a reaction. Those reactions are treated as responses to a pitch, not as demand.
- The informal conversations weren't recorded, so counts are approximate.
- The teardown used one buyer profile on one date. Prices and screens vary by profile.
- HDFC ERGO and ICICI Lombard are recorded together because they gave the same results.

Evidence of user interactions: the interview log, 2 to 3 recording clips and survey screenshots are in the Supporting Artifacts PDF.

3. Market and regulatory landscape

Headline: health insurance is growing and got cheaper after GST was removed, but complaints are rising much faster than sales. IRDAI already requires plain-language disclosure. The gap is in whether buyers can use it to predict what will happen to them.

Market

Indicator	Figure	Source
Overall insurance penetration, FY25	3.7% of GDP (global average 7.3%)	McKinsey, via Business Today, Sep 2026
Non-life penetration, FY25	1.0% of GDP (global 4.3%)	McKinsey, via Business Today
Health's share of general insurance	About 38%	McKinsey, via Business Today
People with individual health cover	About 32M (FY17) to 60M (FY25)	McKinsey, via Business Today

Indicator	Figure	Source
Population covered, including government schemes	About 39%	McKinsey, via Business Today
Health's share of ombudsman complaints, FY25	61.49% (vs 10.68% of premiums)	Business Standard, Jun 2026
Ombudsman complaints resolved, FY26	41,055	Business Standard, Jun 2026

Acko's position (from the brief)

Metric	Figure
FY26 gross written premium	Rs 2,732 cr, +32%
Retail health growth, FY26	55% (fastest segment)
FY26 profit after tax	Rs 43.6 cr (FY25: Rs 193.4 cr loss)
Health claim settlement	About 95.75% (reported)
IPO	Confidential filing, H2 2026

Regulations that shape the buying flow

Rule	What it says	What it means for this product
Customer Information Sheet (CIS)	Mandatory summary of sum insured, exclusions, sub-limits, waiting periods, free look, claims process and grievances	The content already exists. The opportunity is how and when it's shown.
Waiting periods	Capped at 36 months, including for pre-existing diseases	A fixed, honest anchor when explaining waiting periods
Moratorium	After 60 continuous months, claims can't be contested for non-disclosure (except fraud); exclusions and limits still apply	A trust message based on regulation, not marketing
Free look	30 days to cancel if no claim is made; refund within 7 days	Free-look cancellations are a regret signal and become a guardrail metric
Portability	Switch insurers at renewal and keep waiting-period credits	Makes the first choice less risky
Regional languages	Proposal form and CIS available in regional languages on request	Supports the brief's vernacular requirement

Rule	What it says	What it means for this product
GST exemption	Individual health insurance went from 18% to 0% GST from 22 Sep 2025; group cover stays at 18%	Personal cover is about 15% cheaper, which weakens 'office cover is enough'
Bima Sugam	IRDAI's not-for-profit marketplace to compare across insurers, expected by Nov 2026 (it has missed earlier dates)	Neutral comparison is becoming a public utility, so Acko has to win on clarity

What the Acko Health II policy wording says (relevant clauses)

Clause	What it says
4.1.3 30-day waiting period	Illness in the first 30 days isn't covered, except accidents
4.1.1 Pre-existing diseases	Excluded until the waiting period in the policy schedule ends; must be declared
4.1.2 Specified diseases	Listed conditions are excluded during their waiting period, 'even if contracted after the policy'. Cataract is item 1, followed by stones, hernia, joint replacement, ENT conditions and others.
4.2.3 Permanent exclusions (can't be waived)	For example dental (unless from an accident), external prosthetics, hormone therapy, substance-abuse treatment
3.2.2 Room rent	If a room-category limit applies and a costlier room is used, the bill is reduced proportionally
3.3.6 to 3.3.8 Optional cost-sharing	Co-pay, a co-pay outside the preferred network, and deductibles, if chosen for a premium discount

Brief constraints: IRDAI disclosures, consent and underwriting stay intact, and there's no personalised financial or medical advice.

4. Competitive analysis: how buyers actually decide

Headline: no channel gives a first-time buyer both a neutral comparison and a clear answer to 'when would I still pay?'

Channel	Relied on most (Q10, n=68)	Strength	Where it fails a first-time buyer	Evidence	Opening for Acko
Family and friends	20	Highest trust; real claim stories	Don't know the terms	One interviewee buys only on a peer's recommendation; another's family claim paid only 40 to 50%	Make the plan easy to explain and share at home
Agent or bank	12 (23 got a quote this way)	Explains face to face; filters options	Paid to sell; limited range	One interviewee moved to an agent to escape too many options and calls	An agent's clarity without the sales pressure
Comparison site (Policybazaar)	10 (15 got a quote here)	Compares across insurers; policy documents available before payment	Phone number before price; 9 steps to quote; room rent and co-pay not visible; calls followed	10 of 68 named sales calls; the top complaint in informal conversations	No-spam quotes; compare on what's actually paid
Other insurers' websites (HDFC ERGO, ICICI Lombard)	9 (insurer apps, incl. Acko)	Short flow (4 steps to quote)	Phone number on screen 1; room rent, co-pay and exclusions not shown before payment; waiting periods not explained in plain language; calls followed	Insurer sites described as confusing, with no comparison	Turn the quote page into a decision page
Acko (direct)	15 got a quote on Acko	Room rent and co-pay visible; waiting periods and exclusions in plain language; policy wording before payment; 4 languages; one follow-up call, the day after the quote	Phone number and OTP before price; exclusions 15 taps deep; '100% of the bill, you don't have to pay anything' shown without when you'd still pay; no family share	A respondent who bought on Acko said the plan pays in full during a waiting period	Show outcomes, not just terms, next to the 100% promise

Channel	Relied on most (Q10, n=68)	Strength	Where it fails a first-time buyer	Evidence	Opening for Acko
YouTube, finfluencers, AI	7, plus interview mentions	Free, plain language	Unverified; may not match the actual policy wording	Interviewees use ChatGPT or Gemini to simplify terms; one doesn't trust YouTube	An in-app explainer that only says what the policy says
Employer cover	7 said it felt enough	Free, already in place	About Rs 5L cap; ends with the job	Some interviewees rely on it; one said Rs 5L 'would not suffice'	Show the coverage gap without fear messaging

5. Product teardown

Quote-to-checkout walked on 10 November 2026 on Acko, Policybazaar, HDFC ERGO and ICICI Lombard, stopping before payment, using one buyer profile (self, age 27, Bengaluru), with ₹25L sum insured on Acko and ₹10L on the other sites, so prices aren't directly comparable.

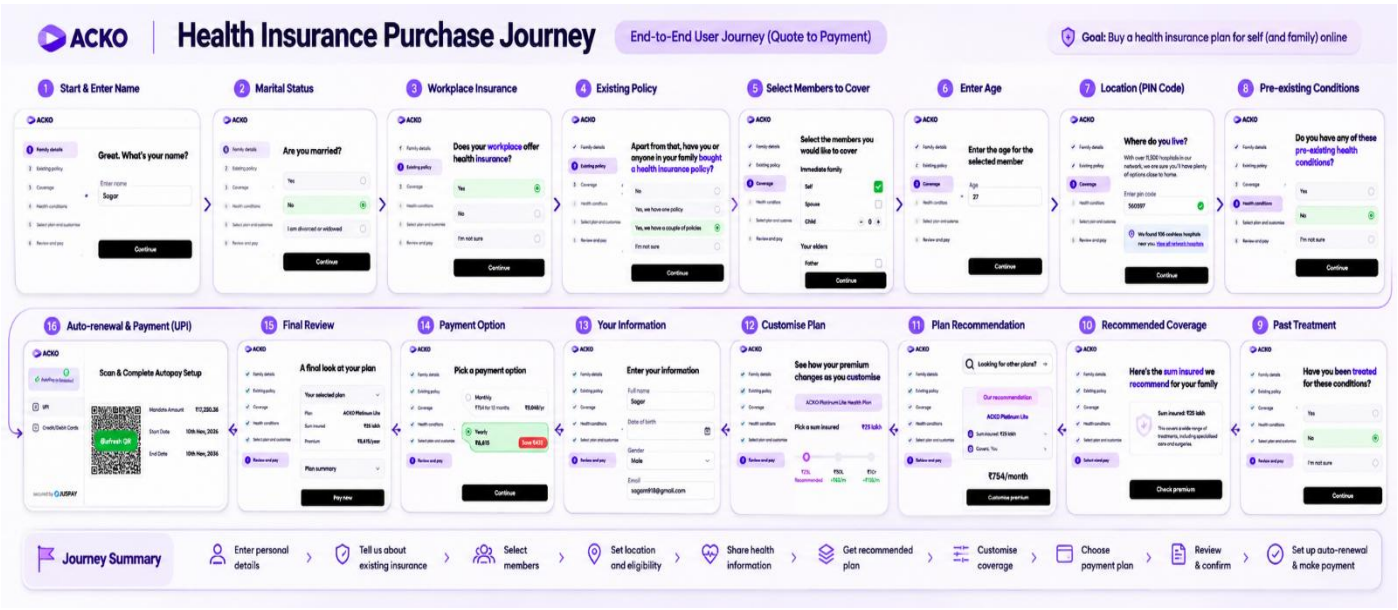
5.1 Step-by-step walkthrough

Each table records what the buyer sees at each step and where limits, waiting periods and exclusions appear. Annotated screens are in the Supporting Artifacts.

Acko (6 steps to quote)

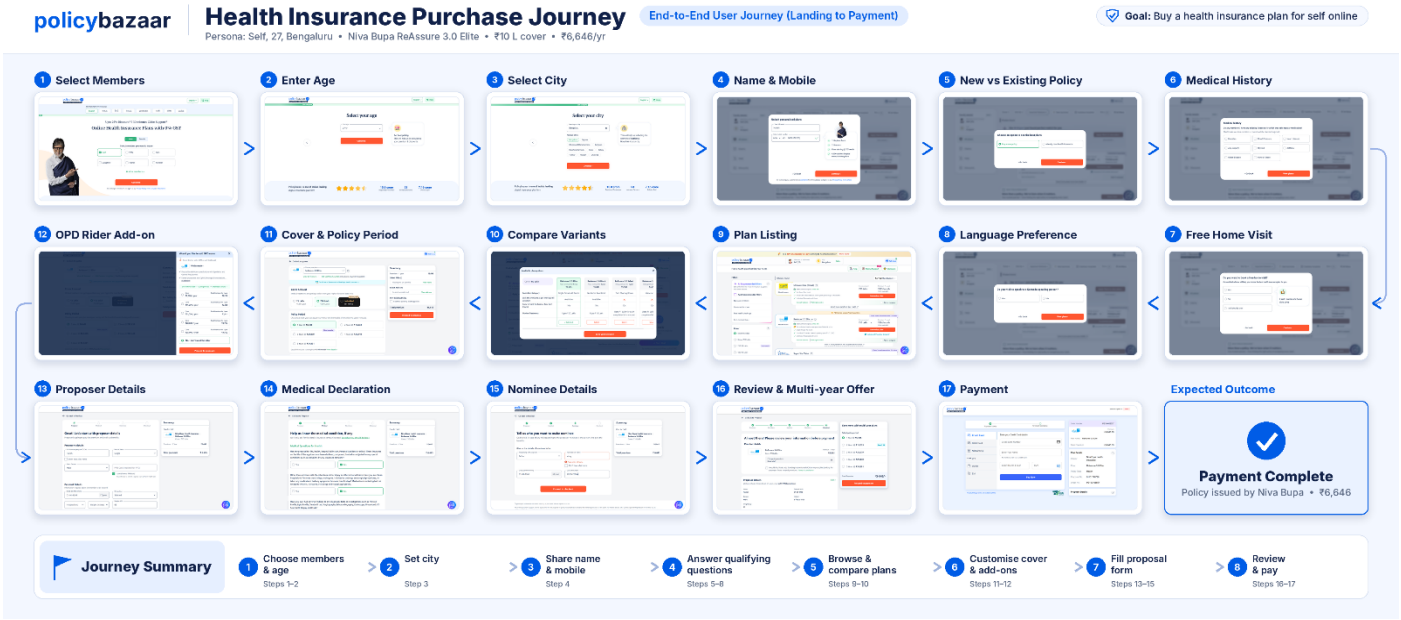
Step	What the buyer is asked or shown	Limits, waiting periods or exclusions shown here?	Observation
1 to 3	Name, marital status, workplace insurance	No	
4	Mobile number	No	Phone number required before any price
5	OTP	No	Extra verification step before price
6	Quote and plan page	Room rent (no limit on quoted plan), co-pay, waiting periods in plain language	'100% hospital bill payment' pop-up: 'We cover 100% of the bill, so you don't have to pay anything'
After quote	Exclusions	Exclusions in plain language	15 taps from the start to reach them

Step	What the buyer is asked or shown	Limits, waiting periods or exclusions shown here?	Observation
Before payment	Summary and policy wording	Main waiting periods, exclusions, room rent, bonus, health check-ups, consultations, tax benefits, pre-issuance health evaluation; detailed policy wording	No example of when the buyer would still pay; no option to share with family



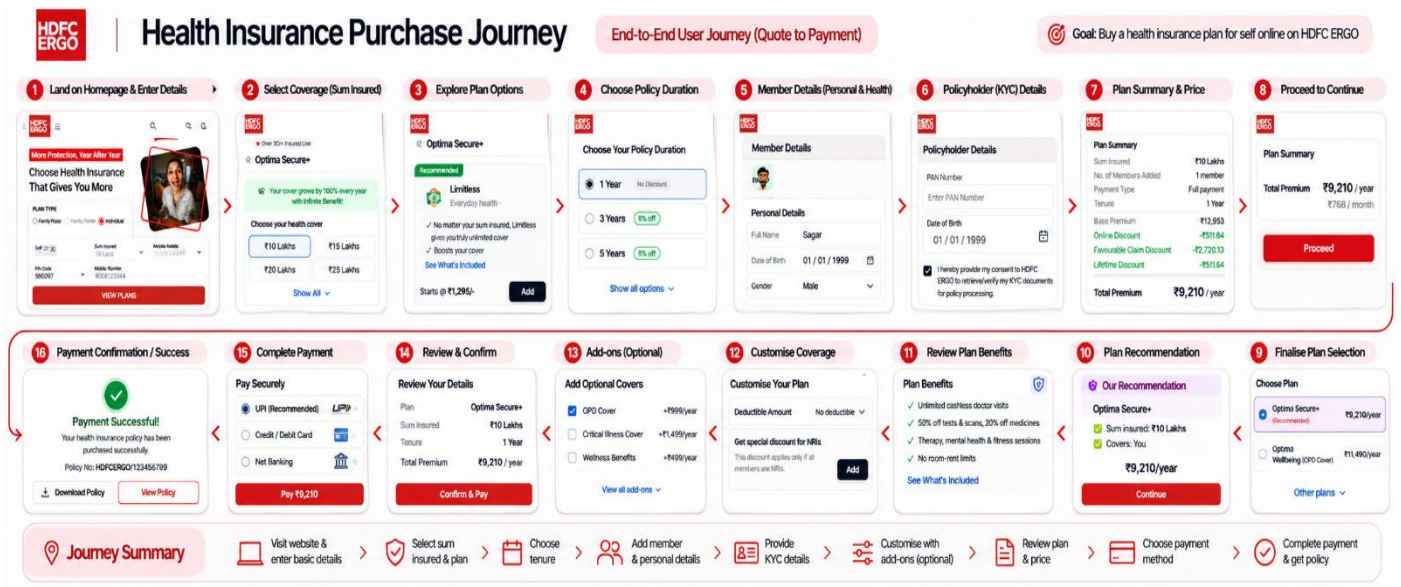
Policybazaar (9 steps to quote)

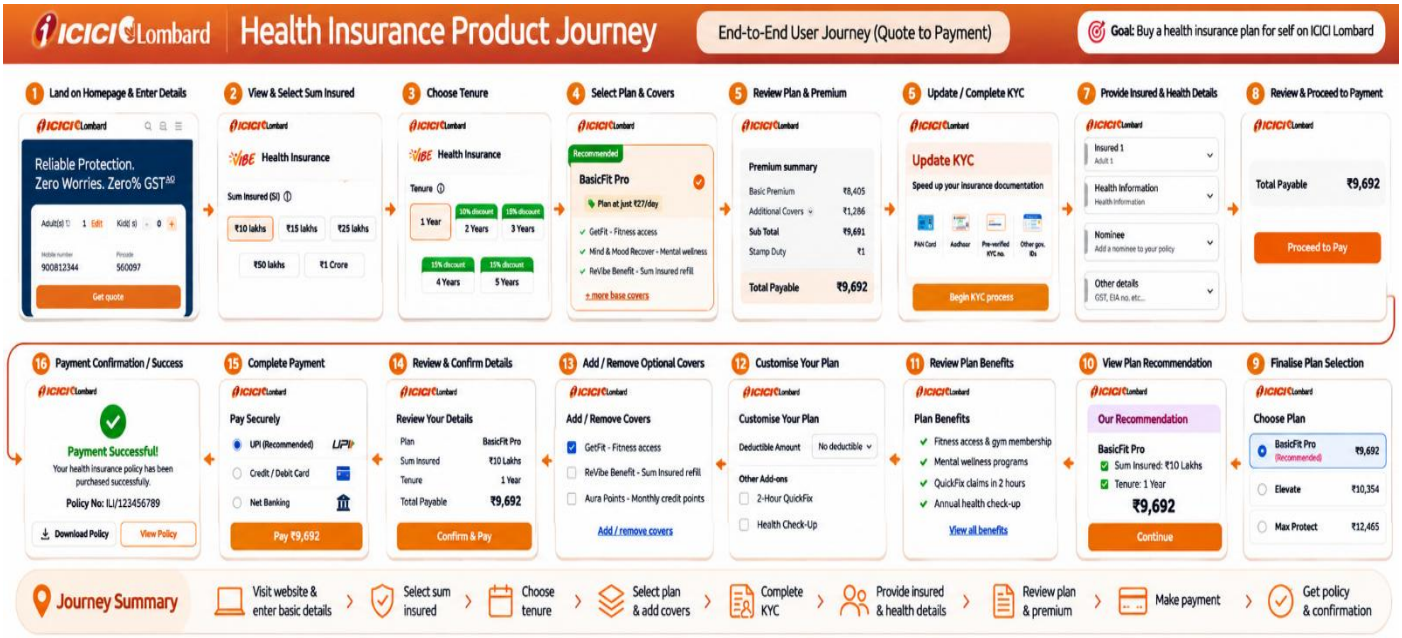
Step	What the buyer is asked or shown	Limits, waiting periods or exclusions shown here?	Observation
1 to 3	Select members, enter age, select city		
4	Mobile number	No	Phone number required before plan list
5 to 9	New vs existing policy, medical history, free home visit offer, language preference (for advisor calls), plan listing		
Plan details	Plan features	Waiting periods in plain language; room rent, co-pay and sub-limits not shown	Exclusions reached in 9 taps
Before payment	Policy documents section	Policy wording available	



HDFC ERGO / ICICI Lombard (4 steps to quote)

Step	What the buyer is asked or shown	Limits, waiting periods or exclusions shown here?	Observation
1	Mobile number	No	Phone number required on the very first screen
2 to 4	Select sum insured, choose plan, choose tenure		
Plan details	Plan features	Room rent, co-pay, sub-limits not shown; waiting periods not explained in plain language	Exclusions not available before payment
Before payment	Review your details: plan, sum insured, tenure and total premium	No CIS or wording shown	





5.2 Comparison grid

What to check	Acko	Policybazaar	HDFC ERGO / ICICI Lombard
Phone number required before price?	Yes: mobile number on screen 4, OTP on screen 5	Yes: mobile number on screen 4	Yes: mobile number on screen 1
Steps to quote	6	9	4
Room-rent limit visible before payment?	Yes (no room-rent limit on the quoted plan)	No	No
Co-pay and sub-limits visible?	Yes	No	No
Waiting periods: plain language or jargon?	Plain language	Plain language	Not shown in plain language
Taps to reach exclusions	15	9	Not available before payment
Out-of-pocket example shown?	No. A '100% hospital bill payment' pop-up says 'We cover 100% of the bill, so you don't have to pay anything'; no example of when the buyer would still pay	No	No

What to check	Acko	Policybazaar	HDFC ERGO / ICICI Lombard
CIS or wording shown before payment?	Yes: detailed policy wording, plus a summary of main waiting periods, exclusions, room rent, bonus, free annual health check-ups, doctor consultations, tax benefits and pre-issuance health evaluation	Yes, in the policy documents section	No
Language options	English, Kannada, Hindi, Tamil	English only	English only
Can you share with family before buying?	No	No	No
Calls or messages within 48 hours	None so far (recheck 12 Nov)	Yes	Yes

5.3 What the teardown shows

- **Acko is the most transparent at the top of the page.** It's the only site that shows room rent and co-pay before payment, explains waiting periods and exclusions in plain language, offers four languages, and followed up with just one call, the day after the quote.
- **Plain words aren't the same as a predictable outcome.** Acko's most prominent message, 'We cover 100% of the bill, so you don't have to pay anything', is accurate for covered treatment, including consumables. But it sits apart from the waiting periods and exclusions (15 taps deep), which, per the policy wording, still apply. Nothing shows the buyer a situation where they would pay.
- **Nobody shows an out-of-pocket example, and nobody lets you share the plan with family.** This is open ground across the market, and it matches barriers 1 and 2 below.
- **Every site asks for a phone number before showing a price.** Acko adds an OTP. Fear of spam calls comes from the industry; even Acko called once, the day after the quote.

6. Personas

	A. The family buyer	B. The overwhelmed self-buyer	C. The confident-but-wrong buyer
Who	Covering self plus parents or in-laws	Young professional covering only themselves, often with employer cover	Has bought, or felt 'clear' after seeing the price
Size in survey	31 of 68	31 cover only themselves; 40 of 68 are 30 or under	16 said 'I was clear'; 15 bought
Where they stall	At home: 9 of 31 named family discussion as their blocker	At comparison: too many plans, then spam calls; among those 30 or under, 7 named price and 6 named calls	They don't stall. They convert.

	A. The family buyer	B. The overwhelmed self-buyer	C. The confident-but-wrong buyer
What they misread	17 of 31 got the cataract question wrong or weren't sure; 9 said the plan pays in full	16 of 31 got it wrong or weren't sure	9 of the 16 'clear' respondents and 5 of 15 buyers got it wrong or weren't sure
What they need	Something to show their parents, in the family's language	A short list of what matters, a no-spam quote, and an honest answer to 'is office cover enough?'	To see when they would still pay, before paying
In their words	'How do you know how much of the bill will I be able to pay through the insurance?' (interviewee buying for parents)	'Too much to compare... honestly overstimulating' (interviewee who postponed); 'I just want someone who can explain to me all the clauses' (interviewee with employer cover)	A respondent who bought on Acko answered that the plan pays in full during a waiting period
Risk to Acko	Lost sale	Lost sale, or a sale to an agent	Free-look cancellation or claim dispute later

7. Anticipated barriers

Headline: the top two barriers are about predicting what the plan will pay and explaining it to family. They cut across all three personas.

Rank	Barrier	Survey evidence (n=68)	Interview, field and teardown evidence	In scope?
1	Can't predict what the plan will actually pay	35 unsure about payout or exclusions after the price; 36 wrong or unsure on cataract	6 of 7 interviews; one family claim paid only 40 to 50%; Acko's headline says 'you don't have to pay anything' while waiting periods and exclusions sit 15 taps away; no site shows an out-of-pocket example	Yes
2	Can't explain or defend the plan to family	14 named family discussion; 10 needed someone else's agreement; 21 prefer a non-English language	Family questions buyers couldn't answer were about payout; no site offers a share option	Yes
3	Too many options and no criteria to choose by	9 couldn't compare; 12 unsure which plan or cover fits	4 of 7 interviews; most informal conversations	Yes, without giving personal advice

Rank	Barrier	Survey evidence (n=68)	Interview, field and teardown evidence	In scope?
4	Sales pressure and low trust	10 named sales calls; 10 wanted a neutral explainer with no pressure	Top complaint in informal conversations; all 4 sites require a phone number before price; Policybazaar, HDFC ERGO and ICICI Lombard followed up	Partly (support staffing is out of scope)
5	Price feels high, especially when young or adding parents	9 named price; 9 said premium too high or jumped; 11 wanted cheaper plans for young people	2 interviewees (affordability, pre-existing condition loading)	Pricing is out of scope; explaining the price is in scope

A risk to watch: buyers who convert without understanding (Persona C). Removing friction alone would grow this group, so it becomes a guardrail in Step 6.

Sources

- IRDAI Health Department: CIS, waiting periods, moratorium, free look, portability (irdai.gov.in/health-dept)
- Department of Financial Services: GST on individual health insurance (financialservices.gov.in/node/3332)
- Business Today, 24 Sep 2026: McKinsey report 'India's new insurance track'
- Business Standard, 9 Jun 2026: 'Insurance plaints double in six years driven by health'
- NewsBytes, 27 Sep 2026: Bima Sugam expected by November 2026
- Acko Health II policy wording, UIN ACKHLIP27042V022627
- Airtribe capstone brief (Acko FY26 figures)
- Primary research: survey (68), 7 recorded interview transcripts, informal field notes, product teardown (10 Nov 2026)

Step 2: Frame the Problem

Headline: buyers who get an Acko quote can read the price and the terms, but they can't predict when the plan would and wouldn't pay in their own situation. That is the main reason they stall after the quote, and it also affects people who buy.

Evidence base: the same research as Step 1: survey (68), 7 recorded interviews, about 10 informal conversations, the product teardown (10 Nov 2026) and the Acko Health II policy wording.

1. Refined problem statement

First-time buyers who get an Acko quote see the price and plain-language terms, but they can't work out what the plan would actually pay in their own situation, especially during waiting periods and for excluded treatment. Without that, they can't choose with confidence or explain the choice to their family, so they stall, look for explanations elsewhere, or buy without really understanding.

Backed by

- 'How do you know how much of the bill will I be able to pay through the insurance?' An interviewee buying for her parents, on the question her family asked that she couldn't answer.
- 'I just want someone who can explain to me all the clauses, terms and conditions very clearly, so that I don't face any problem in future.' An interviewee who plans to buy.
- **Survey:** 53% of all respondents misread a basic waiting-period scenario (cataract surgery 10 months into a plan with a 2-year waiting period).
- **Teardown:** Acko's most visible message is 'We cover 100% of the bill, so you don't have to pay anything'. Waiting periods and exclusions are in plain language, but sit elsewhere (exclusions 15 taps in), and no screen shows a situation where the buyer would still pay.
- **Policy wording:** cataract is item 1 on Acko Health II's specified-disease waiting-period list (clause 4.1.2). The scenario buyers misread is a real clause in the plan they were quoted.

2. Funnel deep-dive

Acko's internal stage-by-stage data isn't available; the brief gives only the end point (12% of quote-holders buy within 14 days). So the funnel combines the stages seen in the teardown with where real first-time buyers stopped in the survey.

A. What happened after the quote (survey)

Base: respondents who got a quote and said they had looked at buying a first plan in the last 12 months (n=34). Respondents who already had a plan or said they hadn't looked are excluded.

Outcome	People	% of 34	Timing
Confirmed a purchase	13	38%	All within 14 days: same day 4, 2 to 7 days 7, 8 to 14 days 2
Didn't buy	21	62%	Decided against within 14 days 8; still undecided 8; took more than 14 days 5

Once a buyer stalls after the quote, they rarely come back within 14 days: 13 of the 21 non-buyers were still undecided or past 14 days.

Acko quote-holders: 15 respondents got an Acko quote (9 on Acko alone, 6 alongside other channels; Q2 allowed multiple answers). 11 of them also said they had looked at buying: 6 bought, 4 didn't, 1 postponed.

The survey's 38% is higher than Acko's 12% because respondents are self-selected and engaged. Use it to compare stages, not as a substitute for Acko's actual rate.

B. Where the journey loses buyers (teardown stages mapped to evidence)



Stage	What the buyer sees (teardown)	Evidence of drop-off	Drop-off risk
Screens 1 to 3: members, ages, pincode	Basic details	None raised	Low
Screens 4 to 5: mobile number and OTP	Phone number and OTP before any price	10 of 68 named sales calls as a blocker; spam fear raised repeatedly in informal conversations	Medium
Screen 6: the quote	Price	Only 2 of 68 questioned whether the price was fair	Low
Quote page: plan features	Room rent (no limit), co-pay, waiting periods in plain language; '100% of the bill, you don't have to pay anything' pop-up	10 of 21 non-buyers were most unsure about exclusions and waiting periods	High
15 taps in: exclusions and policy wording	Plain-language exclusions; detailed policy wording before payment; no example of when the buyer would still pay	11 of 21 non-buyers misread the cataract scenario	High
Outside the app: deciding with family	No way to share the plan	8 of 21 non-buyers named family discussion as their blocker, the top answer	Highest
Before payment: health declaration and pay	Health evaluation before policy issuance	3 of 21 most unsure whether existing illnesses would be covered	Medium

The steepest drop is after the quote and before the decision: while the buyer tries to understand the plan and get the family's agreement. Price and the phone-number step lose some buyers, but most are lost after they've seen a price they accept.

3. Primary barrier: symptoms vs cause

Symptoms (what buyers say or do)

Symptom	Evidence
Unsure what's covered or whether it will pay	15 of 21 non-buyers: exclusions and waiting periods (10), existing illnesses (3), whether it will pay (2)
'I need to discuss with family'	8 of 21 non-buyers, the top blocker
'Couldn't compare or choose'	6 of 21 non-buyers
Fine print or fear of rejection at the moment they stopped	At the moment they stopped: too much fine print (5 of 21), worried the claim would be rejected (4 of 21)
Going elsewhere for explanations	Agents (12 of 68), YouTube (7 of 68); interviewees use ChatGPT or Gemini
Postponing	8 of 21 non-buyers still undecided
Buying without understanding	4 of 13 buyers misread the cataract scenario

Cause: Acko already explains its terms in plain language. But the explanation stays at the level of rules ('2-year waiting period for cataract'), sits apart from the headline promise ('100% of the bill'), and isn't shown as outcomes in situations the buyer recognises ('if your mother needs cataract surgery in month 10, you pay; in month 25, the plan pays'). Buyers understand the words but can't predict what will happen, can't answer their family's questions, and can't tell plans apart on what matters.

Primary barrier: buyers can't predict when the plan will and won't pay in their own situation. The family stall, comparison paralysis and the 'will it pay?' doubt are symptoms of this one cause. A family discussion stalls because the buyer can't answer how much of the bill the insurance will pay.

Why this barrier, and not price or spam calls

- **Size:** 15 of 21 non-buyers had a coverage or payout doubt as their top uncertainty after seeing the price; 2 questioned the price itself.
- **Reach:** it's the only barrier that also affects people who bought (4 of 13 misread the cataract scenario), so it drives both lost sales and later regret.
- **Scope:** it's fully within the brief. Pricing and claims operations are out of scope; how terms are presented is in scope.
- **Price is real, but secondary.** When asked what they were thinking at the moment they stopped, 7 of 21 non-buyers said the premium was too high or jumped after adding parents. Price is a genuine barrier for about a third of non-buyers, especially young buyers and those adding parents. It can't be changed here, but what the price buys can be explained.

4. Business impact

The brief gives conversion rates but not quote volumes or average premium, so the model is per 100 quote-holders, with every assumption labelled.

	Today	Target	Change
Confirmed purchases per 100 first-time quote-holders	12	26	+14 (2.2x)
Quote-holders who don't buy	88	74	-14

Is +14 realistic? If Acko's non-buyers resemble the survey's, about 71% of the 88 (around 63 people) stall over a coverage or payout doubt. Reaching 26% means converting 14 of those 63, about 1 in 5 of the buyers held back by the primary barrier. That's ambitious but plausible, and it doesn't depend on winning over people who stall because of price.

Input	Value	Basis
Quote-holders per month	Q	Acko internal; not in the brief
Average first-year premium	Rs 15,000 (assumption)	Lower end of the Rs 15,000 to 20,000 an interviewee expected to pay; replace with Acko's actual figure
Extra first-year premium per 10,000 quote-holders	1,400 policies x Rs 15,000 = Rs 2.1 cr	14-point uplift

Every policy that renews adds that premium again in later years. Step 5 models renewals and adding family members.

The cost of getting it wrong: conversion that rises through pressure rather than understanding grows the 'confident-but-wrong' buyer (Persona C). That shows up as free-look cancellations within 30 days, which lose the premium and the acquisition cost, and as claim disputes over misunderstood terms. Health is already 61% of insurance ombudsman complaints, a real regulatory and reputational risk in an IPO year. So the target isn't just 26%: it's 26% of buyers who understood what they bought.

Step 2 summary

Item	Result
Problem	Buyers see the price and plain-language terms but can't predict when the plan would and wouldn't pay in their situation
Steepest drop	After the quote: understanding the plan and deciding with family
Primary barrier	Terms shown as rules, separate from the '100%' promise, not as outcomes in real situations
Symptoms	'Will it pay?', family stall, comparison paralysis, outside help, postponing, buying without understanding

Item	Result
Secondary barrier	Price, for about a third of non-buyers (out of scope to change; in scope to explain)
Impact	+14 policies per 100 quote-holders (2.2x); about 1 in 5 of those blocked by the primary barrier
Watch-out	Conversion without understanding leads to free-look cancellations and claim disputes

Step 3: Solution Ideation & Prioritization

Headline: 15 ideas were scored with RICE. The top 5 are the four highest-scoring ideas plus one strategic bet, a voice policy assistant. The top 2 solutions for v1 are 'Know what you'll pay, and when' (outcome-based coverage, a pre-payment summary and transparent pre-existing condition pricing) and 'Decide together' (a family share pack). The voice assistant follows as phase 2 and is prototyped in Step 8. Every idea works by presenting what the policy and the buyer's quote already say: no new disclosure risk, no discounts, no pressure.

1. Brainstorm: 15 ideas

Each idea targets a barrier from Step 2 and stays inside the brief: no changes to pricing, underwriting or claims operations, no personalised financial or medical advice, no discounts, fear messaging or aggressive notifications.

#	Idea	What it does	Barrier it targets
1	Outcome-based coverage view	Beside the '100% of the bill' promise on the quote page, a 'when you'd still pay' panel (first 30 days, listed conditions during their waiting period, pre-existing illness during its waiting period, permanent exclusions, undisclosed health details) and a per-member waiting-period timeline, with worked examples such as cataract in month 10 vs month 25. Every line links to its clause.	Can't predict when the plan pays
2	Scenario simulator	The buyer picks a situation ('Mother needs cataract surgery in month 10') and sees 'You pay' or 'Plan pays', from the policy wording and their quote.	Can't predict when the plan pays
3	Family share pack	A shareable plain-language summary of the quoted plan (WhatsApp link or PDF) in English, Hindi, Kannada or Tamil, with the 'when you'd still pay' list and answers to common family questions. Family can open it without an account; the buyer resumes the quote from the link.	Can't explain or defend the plan to family
4	Voice policy assistant	Ask questions out loud (or by text), in English, Hindi, Kannada or Tamil, about your own quote: members, sum insured, and declared conditions. Answers only from the policy wording and the quote, names the clause, gives no medical or financial advice, and hands over to a person when unsure.	Can't predict when the plan pays; going elsewhere for help; language
5	Transparent pre-existing condition pricing	Before the health declaration, explains what declaring a condition can lead to (a loading, an extra waiting period, a sub-limit or an exclusion). If a loading applies, shows an itemised breakdown in the app (base premium, loading amount and %, the condition it relates to, special conditions, the buyer's options), not only a counteroffer letter.	Can't predict what you'll pay; low trust
6	One-screen summary before payment	Shows the IRDAI Customer Information Sheet as a single readable card at checkout, in the buyer's language, with the 'when you'd still pay' list at the top.	Buying without understanding

#	Idea	What it does	Barrier it targets
7	Pre-payment understanding check	Three quick questions on the plan's key limits. Wrong answers are explained, never blocked.	Buying without understanding
8	Price before phone number	An indicative price before asking for a mobile number; the number is asked only to save or buy, with a clear no-spam promise.	Sales pressure and spam fear
9	Save and resume with consent	Save the quote and return later; one reminder only if the buyer opts in.	Postponing
10	Claim walkthrough	A short preview of how a claim works (cashless and reimbursement), what documents are needed and how long it takes.	'Will it actually pay?'; low trust
11	Claim stories	Anonymised real claims showing the bill, what was paid and why.	Low trust
12	Guided cover chooser	A few neutral questions with general rules of thumb for sum insured, framed as information, not advice.	Too many options
13	Compare variants by outcome	Compares Acko's own variants on what's paid in common situations, not feature lists.	Too many options
14	'Is office cover enough?' explainer	A neutral comparison of group and personal cover (group cover ends with the job, usually about Rs 5L), without fear messaging.	Inertia
15	Portability and renewal explainer	Explains that waiting-period credits move with the buyer if they switch insurers at renewal, so the first choice isn't permanent.	Fear of choosing wrong

2. Prioritization: RICE

How scored: Reach is the share of first-time quote-holders who would use or see the feature, estimated from the survey. Impact is the effect on the confirmed purchase rate for those people (3 massive, 2 high, 1 medium, 0.5 low). Confidence reflects how strong the evidence is. Effort is in person-months. Score = Reach x Impact x Confidence / Effort. All values are PM estimates for ranking, not measured data.

Rank	#	Idea	Reach (%)	Impact	Confidence	Effort (pm)	RICE	Evidence behind the scores
1	1	Outcome-based coverage view	100	2	80%	1.5	107	15 of 21 non-buyers had coverage or payout doubts; 53% of all respondents misread the cataract scenario; Acko's '100%' message sits apart from its limits; cataract is item 1 in Acko Health II clause 4.1.2

Rank	#	Idea	Reach (%)	Impact	Confidence	Effort (pm)	RICE	Evidence behind the scores
2	6	One-screen summary before payment	100	1	60%	1	60	4 of 13 buyers misread the cataract scenario; 9 of 68 wanted 'a clear list of what is not covered'; the CIS content already exists
3	3	Family share pack	54	2	70%	2	38	37 of 68 buy for family; family discussion was the top blocker among non-buyers (8 of 21); no site in the teardown lets buyers share a plan
4	5	Transparent pre-existing condition pricing	45 (assumption)	2	60%	2	27	Reach assumes buyers covering parents (31 of 68) are likely to declare a condition. Acko asks health questions before showing a price, and clause 5.2.14 applies loadings through a counteroffer letter after application. An interviewee with a thyroid condition faced loadings she couldn't see before paying; 7 of 68 worried a claim would be rejected over health questions
5	8	Price before phone number	100	0.5	50%	1	25	10 of 68 named sales calls; every site asks for a phone number before price, and all four followed up (Acko with one call the next day)
5	10	Claim walkthrough	100	0.5	50%	1	25	7 of 68 wanted real claim examples and a simple claim walkthrough
7	2	Scenario simulator	60	2	60%	3	24	Interviewees asked 'how much of the bill will I pay?'; overlaps with ideas 1 and 4
8	4	Voice policy assistant (strategic bet, moved to top 5; see section 3)	50	2	50%	2.5	20	Interviewees use ChatGPT or Gemini to decode clauses; one wants 'someone who can explain all the clauses'; 10 of 68 want a neutral explainer; 21 of 68 prefer a non-English language. Nobody asked for voice directly; highest cost of a wrong answer

Rank	#	Idea	Reach (%)	Impact	Confidence	Effort (pm)	RICE	Evidence behind the scores
9	7	Pre-payment understanding check	30	1	60%	1	18	4 of 13 buyers misread the cataract scenario; mainly a guardrail
10	11	Claim stories	80	1	40%	2	16	Trust comes from people; needs claims data and consent
11	9	Save and resume with consent	60	0.5	50%	1	15	8 of 21 non-buyers still undecided
12	12	Guided cover chooser	50	1	50%	2	13	12 of 68 unsure which plan or cover; borders on advice
13	13	Compare variants by outcome	40	1	50%	2	10	6 of 21 non-buyers couldn't compare
14	14	'Is office cover enough?' explainer	30	0.5	40%	1	6	7 of 68 said office cover felt enough
15	15	Portability and renewal explainer	20	0.5	40%	1	4	7 of 68 wanted a better renewal offer or easy portability

3. Final priority: top 5

Method: the top 5 are the four highest RICE scores plus one strategic bet. RICE favours low-effort, well-evidenced ideas; a strategic bet slot keeps room for one higher-effort idea with high potential that the evidence points towards but hasn't yet proven. The bet is validated with a prototype before it's built.

Priority	Idea	RICE	Type	Delivered in
1	Outcome-based coverage view (1)	107	Core	Solution A, v1
2	One-screen summary before payment (6)	60	Core	Solution A, v1
3	Family share pack (3)	38	Core	Solution B, v1
4	Transparent pre-existing condition pricing (5)	27	Core	Solution A, v1
5	Voice policy assistant (4)	20	Strategic bet	Phase 2; prototyped in Step 8

Why the voice assistant is the strategic bet

- **It serves two of the brief's must-haves at once:** 'must work in vernacular languages and for buyers purchasing for parents or family'. 21 of 68 respondents prefer Hindi, Kannada, Tamil, Telugu or Konkani, and 37 of 68 buy for family. A parent can ask their own question out loud instead of reading a summary.
- **It matches existing behaviour:** buyers already go to ChatGPT, Gemini, agents and YouTube to get clauses explained. A grounded assistant brings that conversation back to Acko, where the answer can be tied to the actual policy.
- **It scores lower on RICE for honest reasons:** nobody asked for voice directly, it's the most effort among the top ideas, and a wrong spoken answer about cover is a regulatory risk. That's why it's a bet, not a core v1 feature.
- **It's de-risked before it's built:** the Step 8 prototype tests whether it can answer only from the policy wording and the buyer's quote. Phase 2 builds on Solution A's structured content, so its answers come from the same checked source.

Just outside the top 5: price before phone number and the claim walkthrough (both 25) are cheap, low-risk improvements to test in v1.1. The scenario simulator (24) is largely covered by the worked examples in idea 1 and by the voice assistant.

4. Top 2 solutions

Ideas 1, 6 and 5 all answer the same question for the buyer ('what will I pay, and when won't the plan pay?') and sit on the same screens, so they're built as one solution. The second solution targets a different barrier.

Solution A: 'Know what you'll pay, and when'. On the quote page, Acko's '100% of the bill' promise appears with a 'when you'd still pay' panel beside it, a per-member waiting-period timeline and worked examples. Buyers who declare a condition see what a declaration can lead to before they declare, and an itemised loading breakdown if one applies. Before payment, a one-screen summary repeats the key limits in the buyer's language. Combines ideas 1, 6 and 5.

Solution B: 'Decide together'. A family share pack: a short, plain-language summary of the quoted plan in English, Hindi, Kannada or Tamil, with the 'when you'd still pay' list and answers to the questions families ask. Family members open it without an account, and the buyer resumes the same quote from the link. Combines ideas 3 and 9.

Why these two

	Solution A: Know what you'll pay, and when	**Solution B: Decide together**
Barrier	Primary barrier: can't predict when the plan pays, or what a declared condition will cost	Top symptom: can't explain or defend the plan to family
Evidence	15 of 21 non-buyers had coverage or payout doubts; 53% misread the cataract scenario; loadings are revealed only after application (clause 5.2.14)	8 of 21 non-buyers named family discussion as their blocker; 37 of 68 buy for family; 21 of 68 prefer a non-English language; no site offers sharing
Persona served	All three; protects Persona C (confident but wrong)	Persona A (family buyer)
Why it's feasible	Uses content already in the policy wording, CIS and quote; the loading breakdown shows the outcome of underwriting, not the underwriting rules	Reuses Solution A's content; Acko already supports 4 languages
Dependency	None	Builds on A's content, so ship A first

Why the voice assistant isn't in the top 2: it's the strategic bet, not a v1 core. It needs Solution A's structured content first, carries the highest cost of a wrong answer, and has the weakest direct evidence. Prototyping it in Step 8 and launching it as phase 2 lets it extend both A and B by voice once its answers are proven reliable.

Why the others aren't in the top 2

- **Price before phone number (8) and claim walkthrough (10):** worthwhile, cheap tests for v1.1, but smaller impact on the primary barrier.
- **Scenario simulator (2):** mostly covered by Solution A's worked examples and, later, the voice assistant.
- **Understanding check (7):** kept light inside Solution A's pre-payment summary rather than as a separate gate.
- **Claim stories (11):** need claims data and customer consent; claims operations are out of scope.
- **Guided cover chooser (12):** too close to personalised financial advice, which the brief rules out.

5. Trade-off analysis

Trade-off	Solution A: Know what you'll pay, and when	Solution B: Decide together
Optimises for	A confident, informed purchase: the buyer knows what they'll pay, including any loading for a declared condition, and when the plan wouldn't pay	A family decision the buyer can defend, in the family's language
Sacrifices	Some speed: a panel and timeline on the quote page and a short explainer before the health declaration. Some buyers will decide not to buy once they see the limits or the loading.	Immediacy: sharing invites the buyer to leave the session, which can push the decision past 14 days
Clarity vs speed	No new mandatory step: the panel sits on the existing quote page, collapsed to 5 lines (about 20 seconds to read, estimate); the timeline and examples expand on tap	Optional, one-tap share; the resume link returns the buyer to the same quote, so leaving doesn't mean starting over
Simplicity vs full disclosure	Shows the 5 situations where you'd still pay, not all 16 listed conditions; every line links to the full list and its clause, so nothing is hidden, only ordered. The loading breakdown shows what was applied and why, not the underwriting formula. All copy comes from the policy wording and is checked by compliance.	The summary is short but carries the same 'when you'd still pay' list and links to the full wording and CIS. It contains plan terms only, never the buyer's health declarations.
Risk accepted	A buyer who rightly decides not to buy stays in the cohort; the brief allows this	Some family discussions will still end in 'not now'
Guardrail	Free-look cancellations and claim disputes over misunderstood terms should fall (Step 6)	Share-to-return rate and 14-day conversion of shared quotes are tracked so delay doesn't erode the target

Voice policy assistant (strategic bet, phase 2)

Trade-off	Voice policy assistant
Optimises for	Explanations on demand, in the buyer's or family's language, about their own quote
Sacrifices	Build effort and time to launch; it waits for Solution A's structured content
Clarity vs speed	Optional and on demand; it never sits in the purchase path, so it can't slow the flow
Simplicity vs full disclosure	Spoken answers are short, so each one names its clause and offers the full text on screen; it never says 'you're covered' without the conditions that apply
Risk accepted	A wrong or advice-like answer; mitigated by answering only from the policy wording and the buyer's quote, declining medical and financial advice, and handing over to a person when unsure

What we're deliberately not optimising for: raw conversion speed. The brief keeps buyers who rightly decide not to buy in the cohort and adds guardrails so the rate isn't lifted by pushing hesitant buyers. A slightly slower path to a purchase the buyer understands is the goal: 26% of buyers who understood what they bought, not 26% at any cost.

Step 4: Experience Design, PRD & Prototype

TL;DR. We keep Acko's existing quote-to-purchase flow and change what the buyer sees at six moments, so every first-time buyer knows what they'll pay, and when the plan wouldn't pay, before paying, and can take the plan to their family. No new mandatory step, no new disclosure, no pricing or underwriting change. We'll prove it with an A/B test on first-time quote-holders, judged on the 14-day confirmed purchase rate with guardrails on free-look cancellations and disputes.

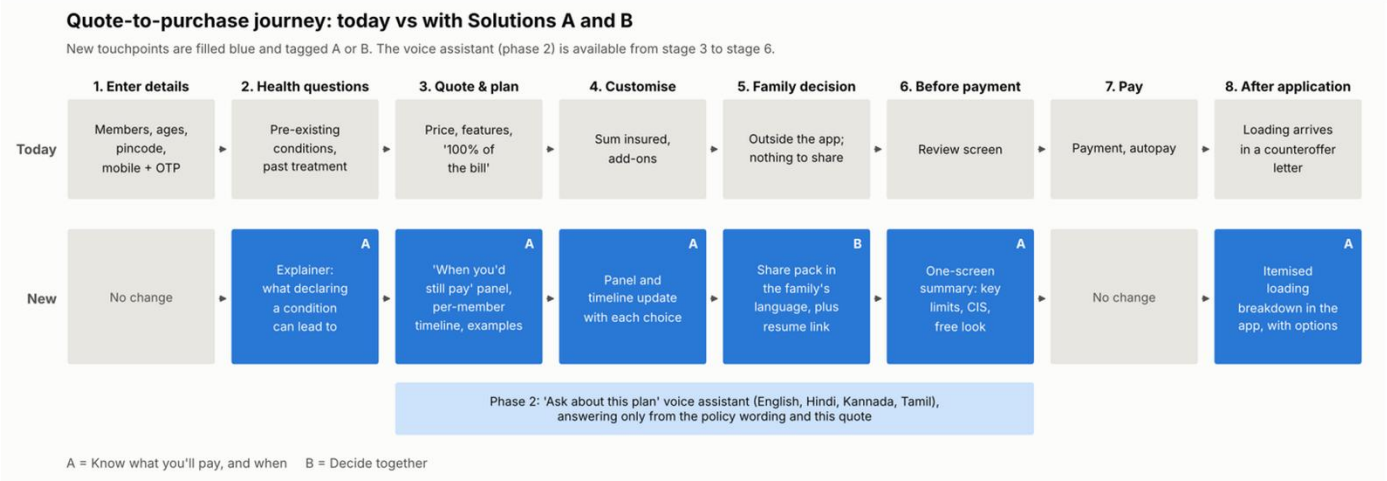
Why now

- **Retail health is Acko's growth engine:** 55% growth in FY26, the fastest segment. Lifting conversion of existing quote traffic is the cheapest growth available.
- **The cost of misunderstanding is rising:** health is 61% of insurance ombudsman complaints (FY25). In an IPO year (confidential filing, H2 2026), disputes over misunderstood terms are a reputational and regulatory risk.
- **Comparison is becoming a public utility:** Bima Sugam is expected to put neutral cross-insurer comparison in front of buyers. When every plan sits side by side, Acko wins by being the easiest plan to understand, not only the cheapest.
- **Price friction just fell:** GST on individual health cover went to zero in September 2025, so understanding, not price, is now the bigger bottleneck (Step 2).

Experience principles

Principle	What it means in the product	Research it comes from
Never show the promise without its limits	'100% of the bill' always says 'for covered treatment' and sits beside 'When you'd still pay'	Teardown: the 100% pop-up says 'you don't have to pay anything'; 53% misread the cataract scenario
One more glance, not one more step	New content lives on screens the buyer already visits; nothing new blocks payment	Steepest drop is after the quote; buyers already feel overloaded ('too much to compare')
Speak in situations, keep the clause one tap away	Show outcomes ('Mother needs cataract surgery in month 10: you pay'); link every line to its clause	Acko's terms are already plain language, yet buyers still can't predict outcomes
The family is part of the buyer	Anything the buyer sees can be shared, in the family's language, without an account	Family discussion is the top blocker among non-buyers (8 of 21); 37 of 68 buy for family
Show outcomes of underwriting, never give advice	Explain what was applied and why; never say which plan or declaration is right	Brief: no personalised advice; underwriting and pricing are out of scope

1. Experience flow: quote to confirmed purchase



Stage	What the buyer is asking themselves	Today (teardown)	With Solutions A and B	Signal we track
1. Enter details	'Will I get spam calls if I do this?'	Members, ages, pincode, mobile and OTP before any price	No change in v1 (price before phone number is a v1.1 test)	Drop-off at the mobile and OTP screens
2. Health questions	'If I declare Mother's BP, what happens?'	Questions asked before the price; consequences not explained	Explainer card: what declaring can lead to, the risk of not declaring, the 5-year moratorium (A5)	Explainer opened; completion of health questions
3. Quote and plan	'Will it actually pay when I need it?'	Price, features and the '100% of the bill' pop-up; limits elsewhere, exclusions 15 taps in	'When you'd still pay' panel, per-member timeline, 3 worked examples (A1 to A3)	Panel and timeline opened; examples viewed
4. Choose sum insured	'Why is the price this much, and will it change?'	Sum insured options and a single total price; no add-ons offered	Per-member premium breakdown; members with a declared condition are tagged 'may change after health review', linked to the A5 explanation (A4)	Sum insured changes; breakdown opened
5. Decide with family	'How do I explain this at home?'	Outside the app; nothing to share	Share pack in 4 languages, no login; resume link (B1 to B3)	Shares, opens of shared links, resumes within 14 days
6. Before payment	'What exactly am I buying?'	Review screen	One-screen summary with key limits, CIS and free look; optional quick check (A7, A8)	Summary viewed (100% by design); quick-check answers

Stage	What the buyer is asking themselves	Today (teardown)	With Solutions A and B	Signal we track
7. Pay	'Is this safe?'	Payment and autopay	No change; IRDAI consent untouched	Payment success
8. After application	'Why is it more expensive now?'	Loading arrives in a counteroffer letter; 7 working days to respond	Itemised loading breakdown in the app, with Accept or Decline and refund (A6)	Counteroffer acceptance rate and time to respond

2. PRD: 'Know what you'll pay, and when' and 'Decide together'

Field	Detail
Owner	Sagar R Naivaruni, Product Manager, Retail Health (capstone)
Status	Draft for review with Design, Engineering, Compliance, Underwriting and Data
Scope	First-time buyers of individual and family floater health plans, app and web
Release	v1: Solutions A and B. v1.1: price before phone number, claim walkthrough. Phase 2: voice assistant (prototyped in Step 8)

2.1 Problem and evidence

Only 12% of first-time quote-holders make a confirmed purchase within 14 days. Buyers see the price and plain-language terms but can't predict when the plan would and wouldn't pay in their own situation, or what a declared condition will cost. In our research, 15 of 21 non-buyers had a coverage or payout doubt as their top uncertainty; 53% of all respondents misread a waiting-period scenario that matches Acko Health II clause 4.1.2; family discussion was the top blocker among non-buyers; and 4 of 13 buyers misread the scenario too. Today, any loading for a declared condition reaches the buyer only through a counteroffer letter after application (clause 5.2.14).

2.2 Goals and non-goals

Goals	Non-goals
Lift the 14-day confirmed purchase rate for first-time quote-holders from 12% to 26% in 6 months	Lifting conversion through discounts, urgency, fear messaging or extra notifications
Every buyer sees when the plan wouldn't pay before paying	Changing underwriting rules, premium pricing or claims operations
Buyers can take the plan to their family and come back to the same quote	Recommending a plan, sum insured or declaration to a specific buyer
Buyers with a declared condition see exactly what was applied and why	Replacing or shortening any IRDAI-required disclosure or consent

2.3 Success metrics

Type	Metric	Baseline	Target
Primary	14-day confirmed purchase rate among first-time quote-holders (buyer's own selections, no agent override)	12%	26% in 6 months
Supporting (leading)	Share of quote-holders who open the 'when you'd still pay' panel or timeline	New	Set after 4 weeks of data
Supporting (leading)	Share rate; share-to-resume rate within 14 days	New	Set after 4 weeks of data
Supporting (leading)	Quick-check accuracy on the waiting-period question (opt-in)	53% wrong or unsure in research	Clear improvement vs research baseline
Guardrail	Free-look cancellations within 30 days	Acko internal	No increase
Guardrail	Complaints and claim disputes about waiting periods or exclusions in the first 12 months	Acko internal	Decrease
Guardrail	Purchases where the buyer never saw the key limits	Not measured	0% (summary is on the payment path)
Guardrail	Median time from quote to payment	Acko internal	Increase of no more than 1 minute (assumption to validate)

Full definitions and the event tracking specification are in Step 6.

2.4 Hypotheses

#	We believe that...	...will result in...	We'll know when...
H1	Showing 'when you'd still pay' next to the '100%' promise, with a per-member timeline and examples	more first-time quote-holders buying within 14 days, and fewer misunderstandings	the treatment arm's 14-day rate beats control with free-look cancellations flat or lower
H2	Letting buyers share the plan with family in their language	fewer quotes stalled at 'need to discuss with family'	shared quotes resume and convert within 14 days at a higher rate than unshared quotes in control

#	We believe that...	...will result in...	We'll know when...
H3	Explaining what a declaration can lead to, and itemising any loading in the app	more buyers who declare a condition completing the purchase, and accepting counteroffers	counteroffer acceptance rises and drop-off at health questions doesn't increase
H4	A one-screen summary on the payment path	no buyer paying without seeing the key limits, at little cost to speed	summary view rate is 100% and median time to pay rises by no more than 1 minute

2.5 Users and stories

Persona	User story
A. Family buyer (31 of 68 cover parents)	As a buyer covering my mother, I want to see when her conditions become covered and what her declared condition will cost, and send a summary to my parents in their language, so we can decide together.
B. Overwhelmed self-buyer (31 of 68 cover only themselves)	As a first-time buyer, I want a short, honest view of when the plan wouldn't pay, so I can stop comparing endlessly and decide.
C. Confident-but-wrong buyer (9 of 16 'clear' respondents misread)	As a buyer about to pay, I want one screen that tells me what I'm buying, so I'm not surprised at claim time.

2.6 Requirements

ID	Requirement	Acceptance criteria	Priority
A1	'When you'd still pay' panel beside the '100% of the bill' message	Up to 5 situations in plain language (first 30 days; listed conditions during their waiting period; pre-existing conditions during their waiting period; permanent exclusions; undisclosed conditions), member-specific where relevant; each line links to its clause; 'see all' opens the full list; collapsed to 5 lines by default; '100%' always reads 'for covered treatment'	P0
A2	Per-member waiting-period timeline	Markers at day 1 (accidents), day 31 (illnesses), the listed-condition and pre-existing waiting periods from the quote schedule, and month 60 (moratorium)	P0
A3	Worked examples	3 examples generated from the buyer's quote and schedule (e.g. cataract in month 10 vs 25; illness in the first 30 days), each with 'You pay' or 'Plan pays' and the clause	P0

ID	Requirement	Acceptance criteria	Priority
A4	Per-member premium breakdown	Shows the premium per insured member for the chosen sum insured and updates instantly when the sum insured changes; members with a declared condition carry a 'may change after health review' tag linked to A5; A1 to A3 stay visible on the same screen	P0
A5	Pre-declaration explainer	Above the health questions: what declaring can lead to (clause 5.2.14), the risk of not declaring, the 5-year moratorium; neutral; no advice	P0
A6	Itemised loading breakdown	On counteroffer: base premium, loading % and amount, condition, special conditions, deadline (7 working days), 'Accept' or 'Decline and refund'; matches the counteroffer letter exactly	P0
A7	One-screen summary before payment	On the payment path: members, cover, price, A1 list, key waiting periods, free look; links to CIS and policy wording; 4 languages; IRDAI consent unchanged	P0
A8	Optional quick check	3 tap-to-answer questions; wrong answers explained; skippable; never blocks payment	P1
B1	Share pack	'Share with family' on quote and summary screens; 4 languages; WhatsApp link or PDF; plan terms, price, A1 list, family FAQ; no health declarations; link expires in 14 days	P0
B2	No-login viewer	Opens without an account; loads on low-end phones and slow networks	P0
B3	Resume quote	'Continue this quote' restores the same quote and choices while valid; one reminder only if the buyer opts in	P1
V1	'Ask about this plan' entry point	Placeholder on stages 3 to 6 announcing the voice assistant; no live answers in v1	P2

2.7 Edge cases and states

Case	Expected behaviour
No member declares a condition	A1 shows 4 lines (no pre-existing line); A5 still shown; A6 never triggered
Optional benefits or cost-sharing (only if offered)	The retail plan seen in the teardown offers no add-ons, no co-pay and no room-rent limit, so v1 shows none. The Acko Health II wording does allow optional benefits and cost-sharing (e.g. clauses 3.2.2, 3.3.6 to 3.3.8, 3.3.12); if a variant ever offers one, A1 and A4 add a line for it with its clause

Case	Expected behaviour
Buyer changes the sum insured	Price and per-member breakdown update; waiting periods, timeline and examples stay the same (they don't depend on the sum insured at first purchase)
Underwriting declines a member	A6 shows the decision and the refund; no loading breakdown
Counteroffer not answered in 7 working days	Status shows 'Application cancelled, premium refunded', per clause 5.2.14
Shared link opened after 14 days or after the quote expires	Viewer shows 'This quote has expired' with a link to request a new one; no plan data shown
Translation missing for a string	Fall back to English for that string and log it; never show untranslated placeholders
Buyer is in Acko's existing agent-assisted flow	Out of the experiment cohort (agent overrides don't count as confirmed purchases)

2.8 Content governance and compliance

- **Single source of truth:** every line in A1 to A7 and B1 is generated from a structured map of the policy wording, keyed by product UIN, variant and clause. When the wording or UIN changes, the content updates from the map; nothing is hand-written per screen.
- **Compliance sign-off:** all templates and all 4 languages are approved by Compliance and Legal before launch and after any wording change.
- **No advice:** content explains what the policy says; it never recommends a plan, cover amount or declaration.
- **Underwriting outcomes only:** A6 shows what was applied to this buyer, never the underwriting rules or pricing model.
- **IRDAI requirements unchanged:** CIS, proposal form, consent and free-look communication stay exactly as today; the summary adds a view, not a replacement.

2.9 Non-functional requirements

Area	Requirement
Languages	English, Hindi, Kannada and Tamil at launch
Performance	New components render with the quote page; no extra network call on the payment path
Accessibility	'You pay' and 'Plan pays' written out, never colour alone; readable at default font sizes; screen-reader labels
Privacy	Share links carry plan terms and first names only; no health data; expire in 14 days

2.10 Experiment and launch plan

Item	Plan
Design	A/B test on first-time quote-holders (app and web), randomised at quote creation; control sees today's flow
Primary metric	14-day confirmed purchase rate; guardrails as in 2.3
Sample size	About 2,036 quote-holders per arm to detect a lift from 12% to 15% (80% power, 5% significance, two-sided); about 4,438 per arm to detect 12% to 14%
Duration	At least 14 days of exposure plus the 14-day purchase window, and long enough to reach the sample size
Ship criteria	Primary metric up with statistical significance; no guardrail breached
Stop criteria	Free-look cancellations or waiting-period complaints rise vs control; median time to pay rises by more than the agreed limit
Sequencing	A (P0) first; B once A's content map is live; detailed cohort rollout in Step 5

2.11 Stakeholders

Team	Role in this release
Product (PM)	Owns the problem, scope, metrics and launch decision
Design and content	Screens, plain-language templates, translations
Engineering	Content map, quote-page components, share service, counteroffer screen
Compliance and Legal	Approve all templates and translations; confirm IRDAI disclosures are unchanged
Underwriting	Expose counteroffer data (loading, special conditions) to the app
Data science	Experiment design, sample size, readout
Customer experience and claims	Tag complaints and disputes about waiting periods and exclusions for the guardrail

2.12 Milestones (indicative)

Weeks	Milestone
1 to 2	Policy content map for the first-time buyer plan variants; compliance review of templates
3 to 6	Build A1 to A4 and A7; usability test on the prototype

Weeks	Milestone
5 to 8	A5 and A6 with Underwriting
7 to 9	B1 to B3; translations
10	Compliance sign-off; experiment launch
14 onwards	Readout and rollout decision (Step 5)

2.13 Dependencies, risks and open questions

Item	Type	Owner
Structured policy data per UIN and variant	Dependency	Engineering with Compliance
Counteroffer data available to the app	Dependency	Underwriting
Simplified copy reads as advice or omits a limit	Risk (full register in Step 7)	Compliance
Sharing delays decisions past 14 days	Risk	PM, via the share-to-resume metric
Can some loadings be decided before payment instead of after application?	Open question	Underwriting
What share of first-time quote-holders declare a condition? (validates the Step 3 reach assumption)	Open question	Data science
Can the 'when you'd still pay' panel replace the current '100%' pop-up on the same screen?	Open question	Design

3. Prototype

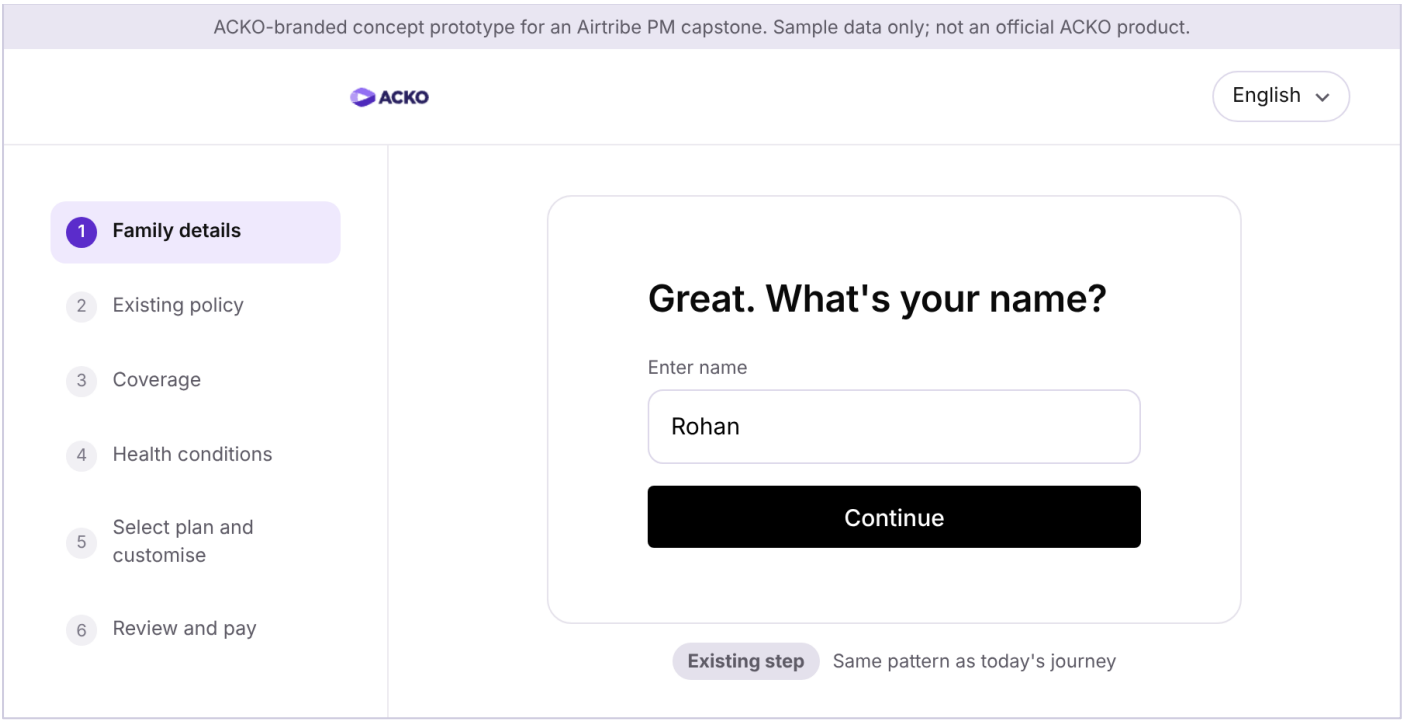
A clickable, high-fidelity prototype of the full quote-to-payment flow in the design language of Acko's current journey (one question per screen, section stepper, purple highlights, black CTAs), built as a single web page with a neutral wordmark and sample data, and labelled as a capstone concept not affiliated with Acko. It includes a language switcher (English, Hindi, Kannada, Tamil). New screens sit inside the existing flow so the change is easy to see.

Screens	Section	New or existing	Requirements shown
S1 to S3	Name, mobile number, OTP	Existing	Starting point
S4 to S9	Marital status, existing cover, members, ages, pincode	Existing	Today's flow, unchanged

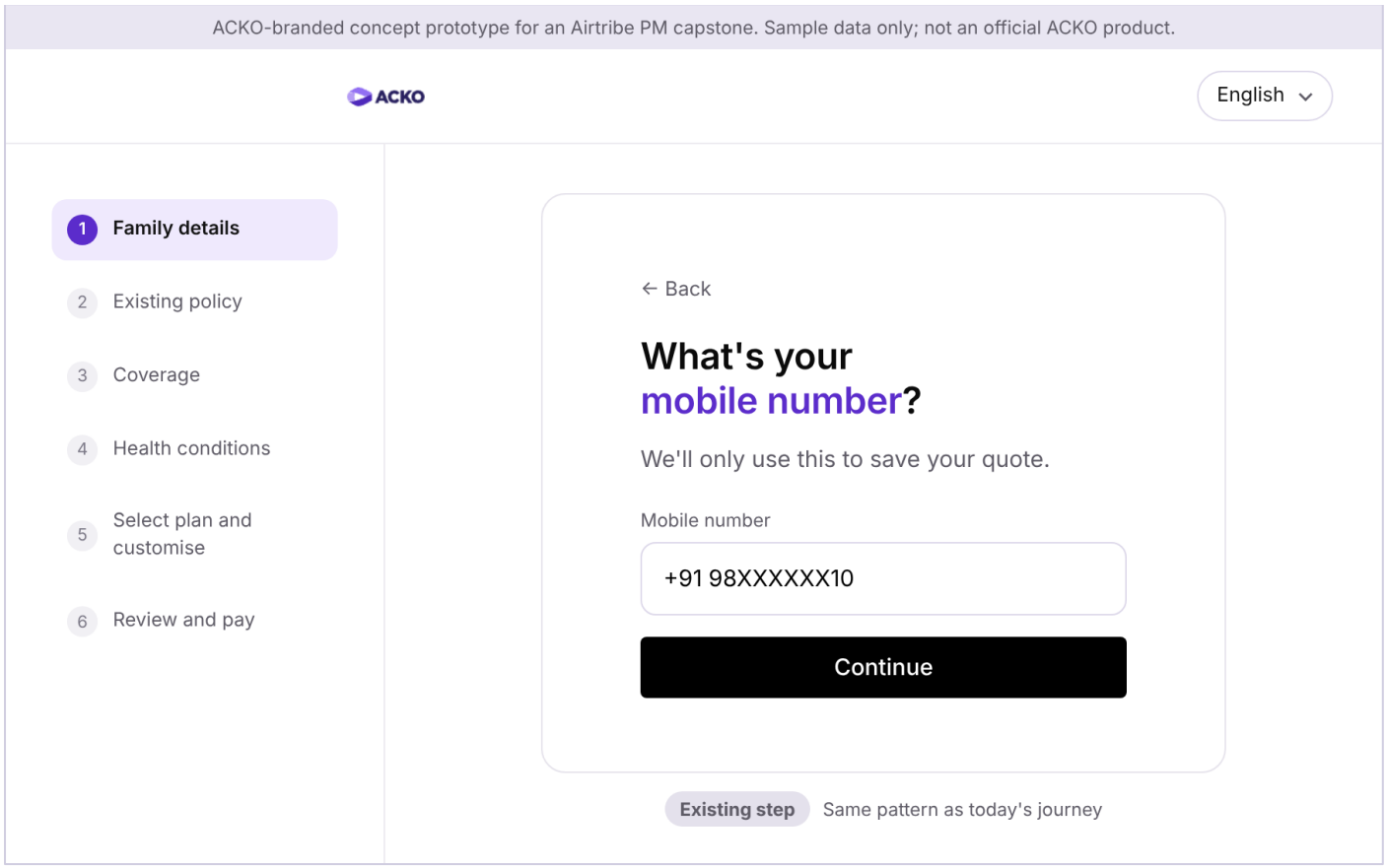
Screens	Section	New or existing	Requirements shown
S10	Pre-existing conditions with explainer card	New element on an existing step	A5
S11, S12	Past treatment; recommended sum insured	Existing	Unchanged
S13	Plan recommendation, redesigned	Existing step, redesigned	A1, A2, A3; share and 'Ask about this plan' entry points
S14	Customise premium (sum insured)	Existing step, extended	A4
S15, S16	Your information; payment option	Existing	Unchanged
S17	Before you pay: one-screen summary	New (replaces the plain final review)	A7, A8
S18	Autopay and payment (simulated)	Existing	Unchanged
S19	Loading breakdown after application	New	A6
Share sheet and shared page	Family sharing	New	B1, B2, B3

Prototype walkthrough: desktop web version of every screen in order, from the first question to payment, then the family-sharing screens and the phase 2 voice sheet. The purple 'Ask about this plan' button appears on S13 to S17.

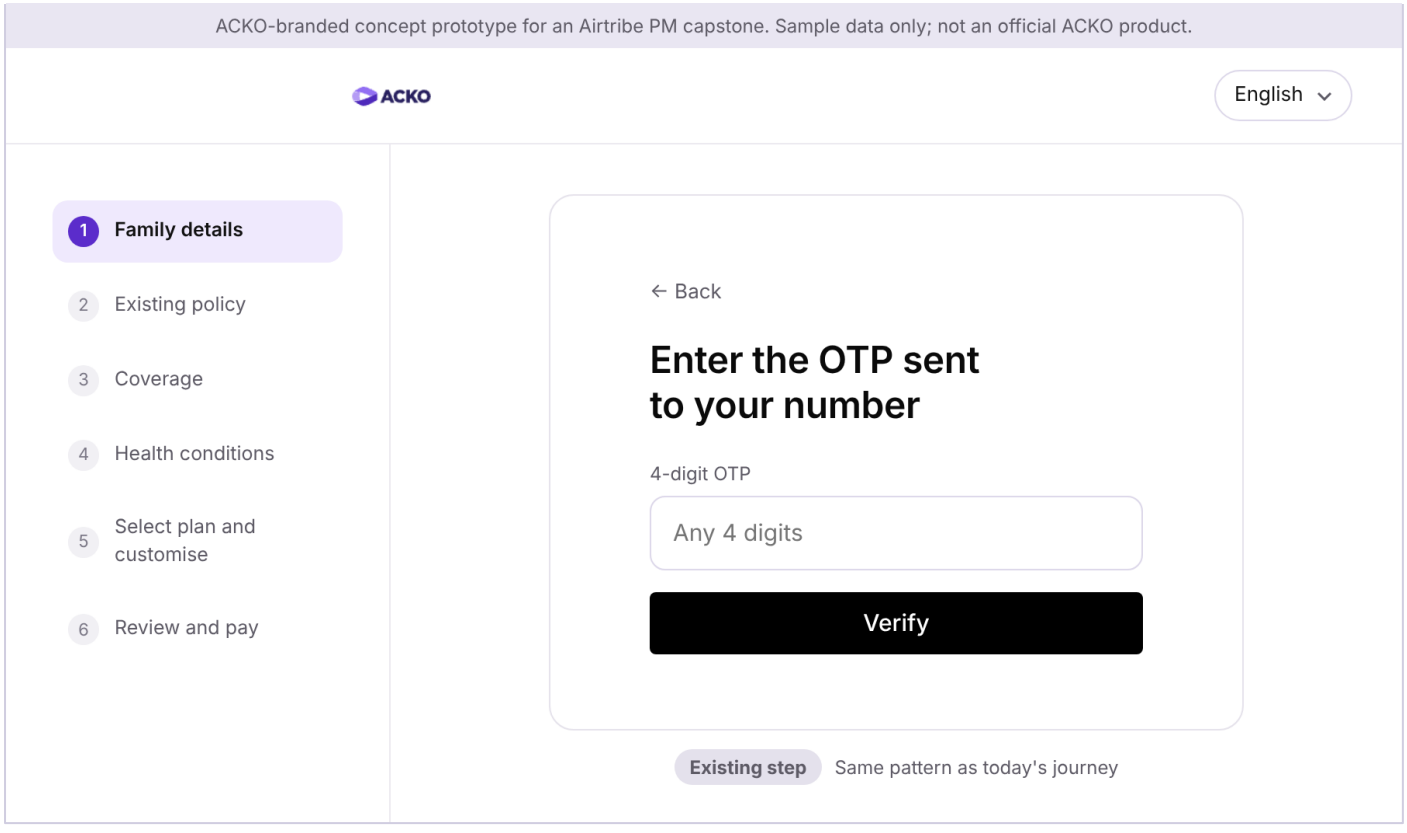
S1. Name (Existing)



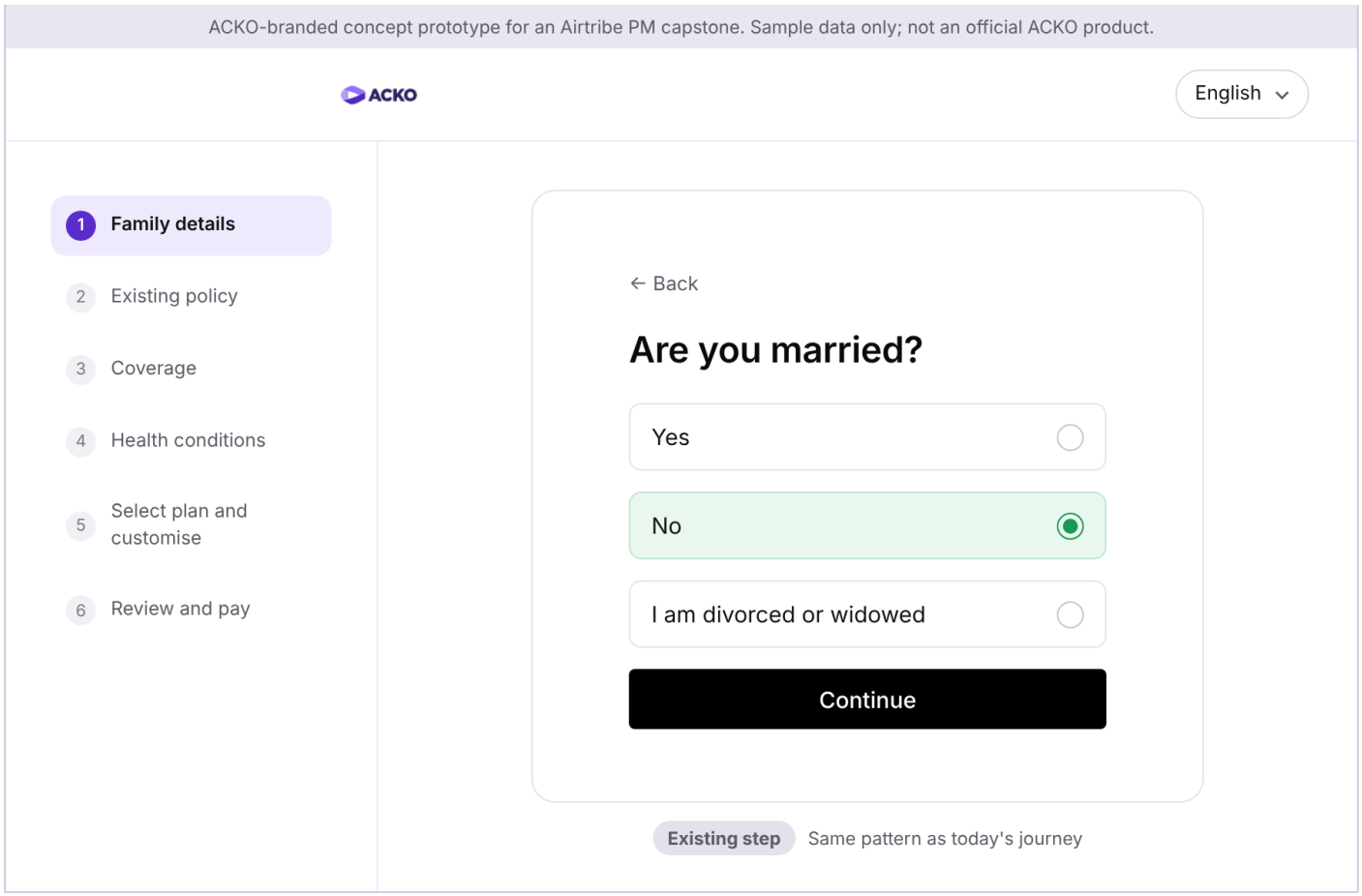
S2. Mobile number (Existing)



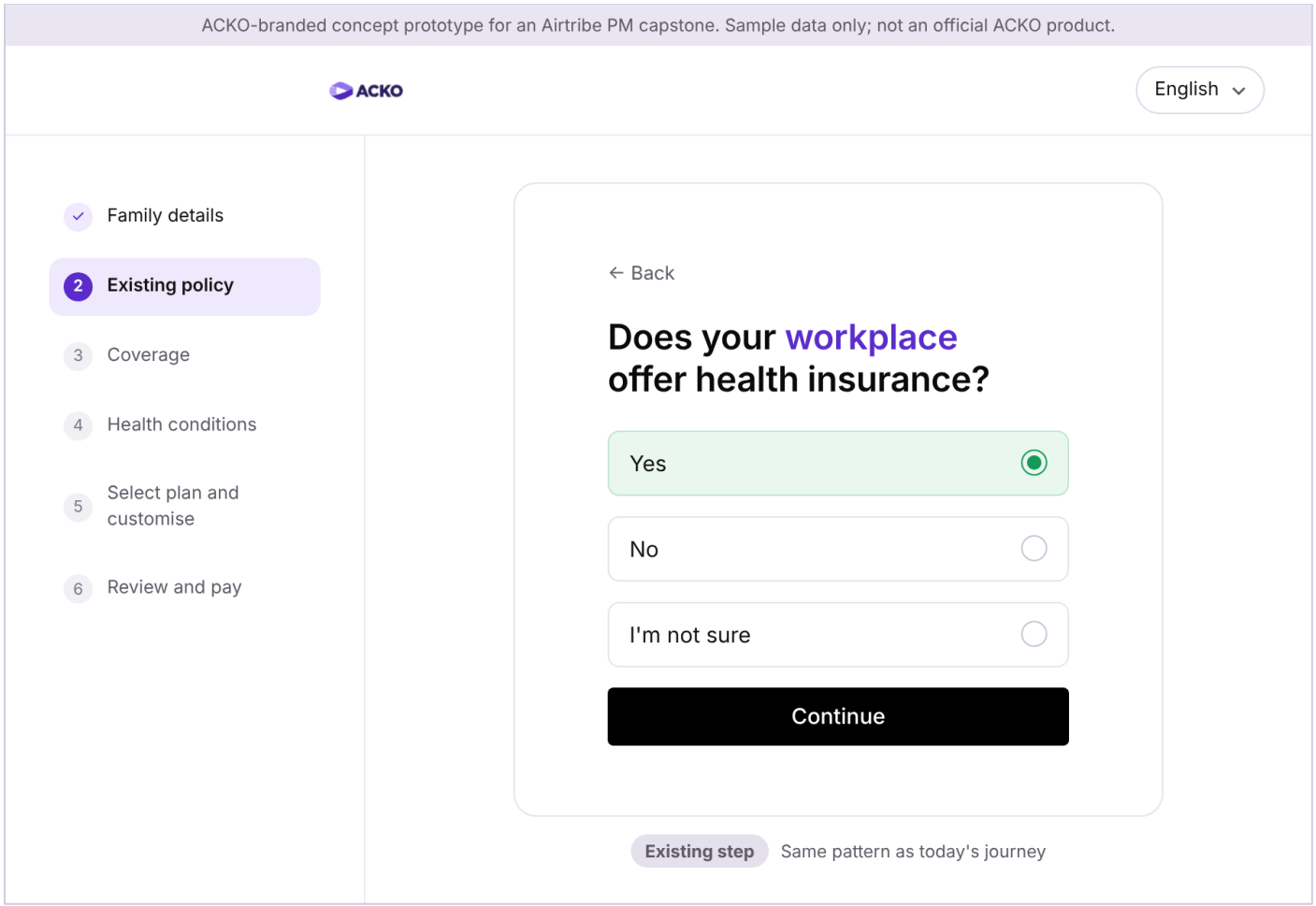
S3. OTP (Existing)



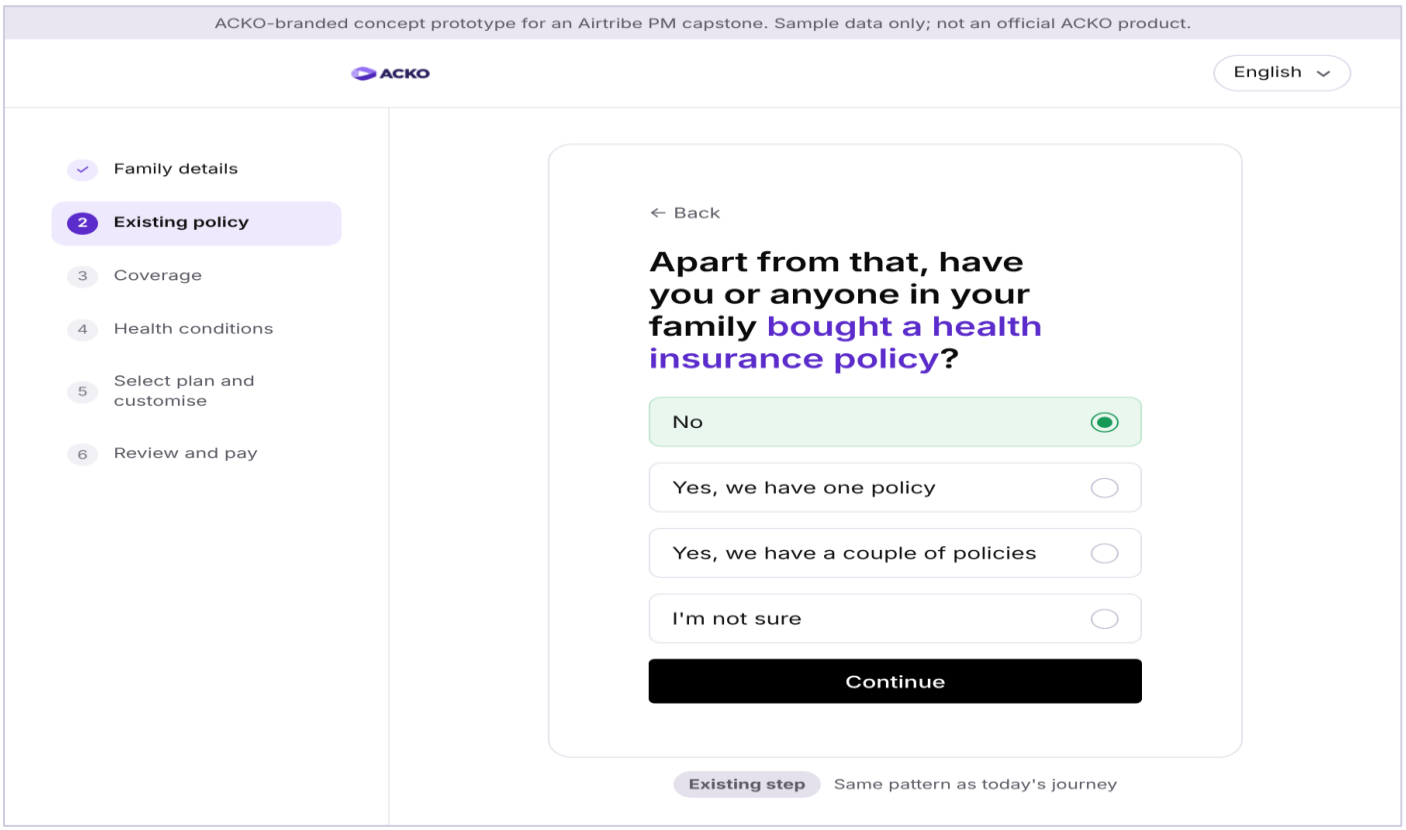
S4. Marital status (Existing)



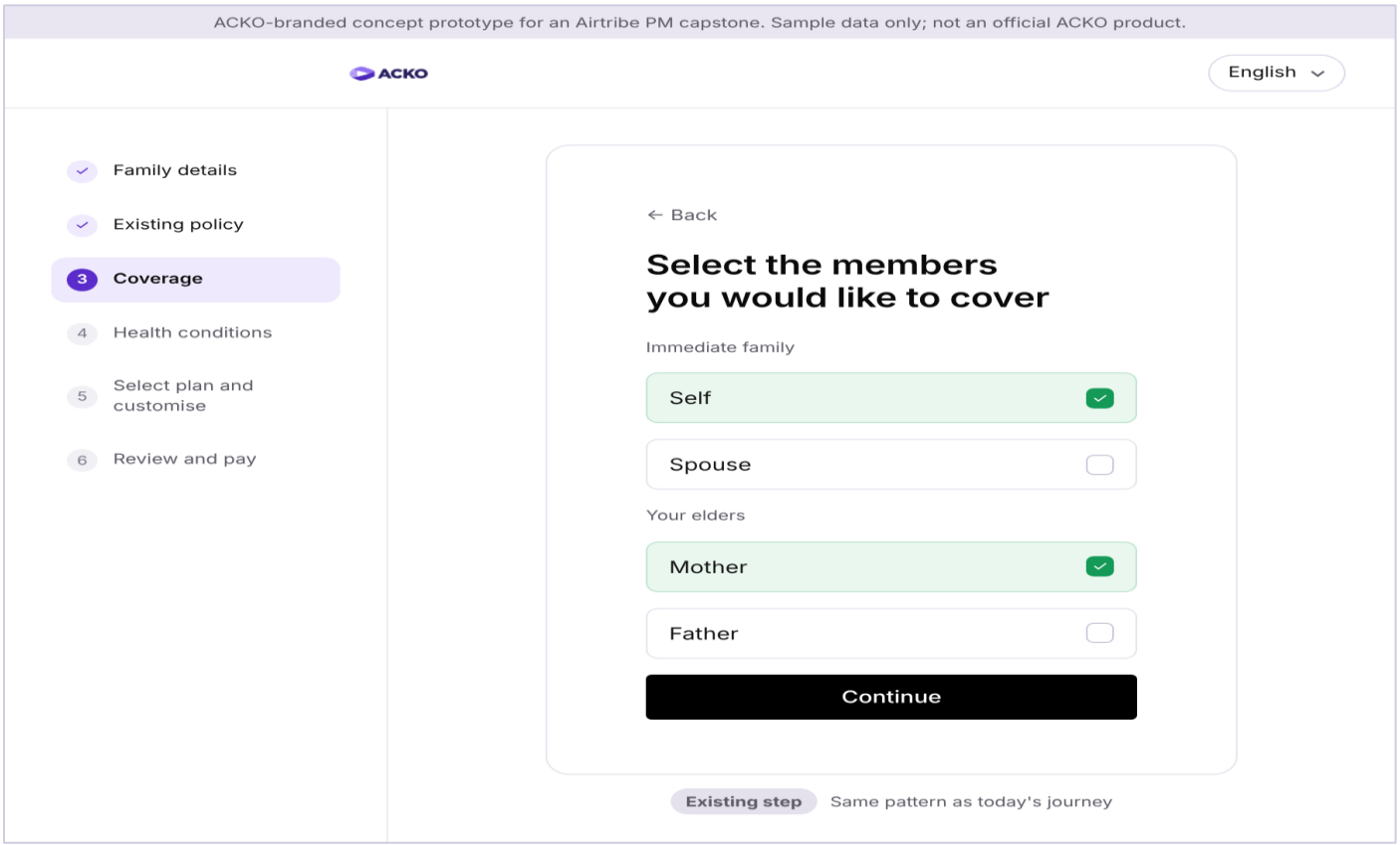
S5. Workplace insurance (Existing)



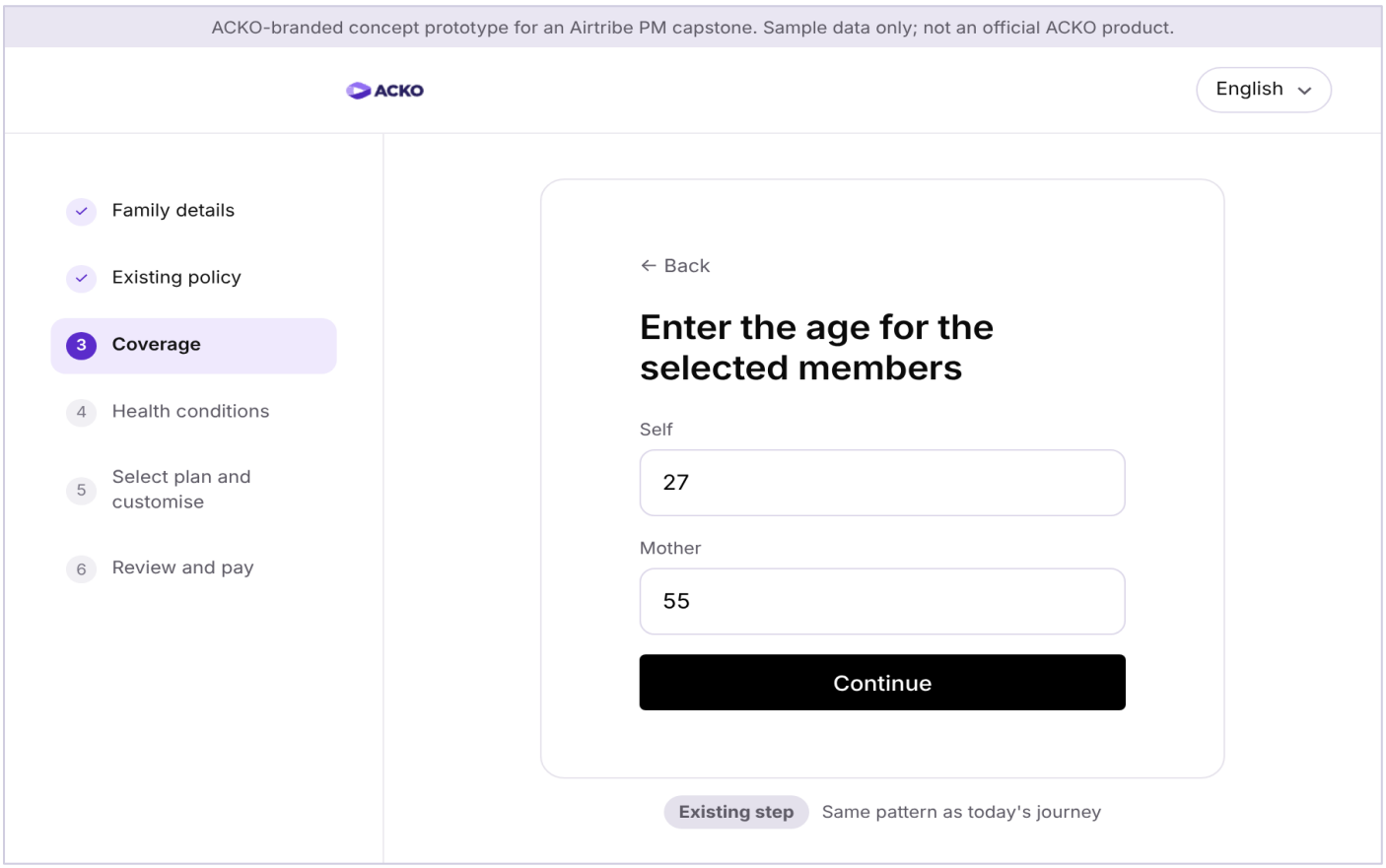
S6. Existing policy (Existing)



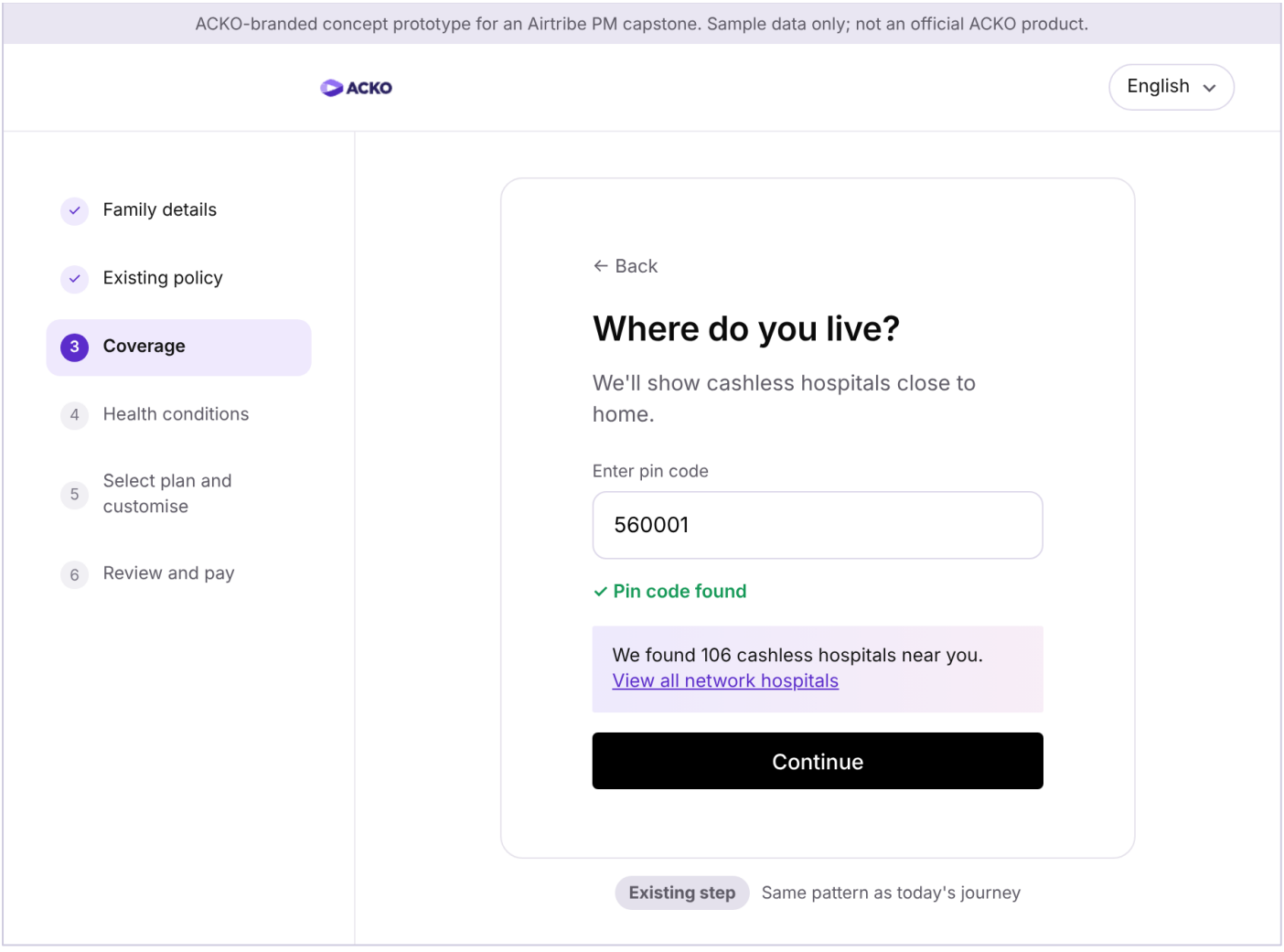
S7. Members (Existing)



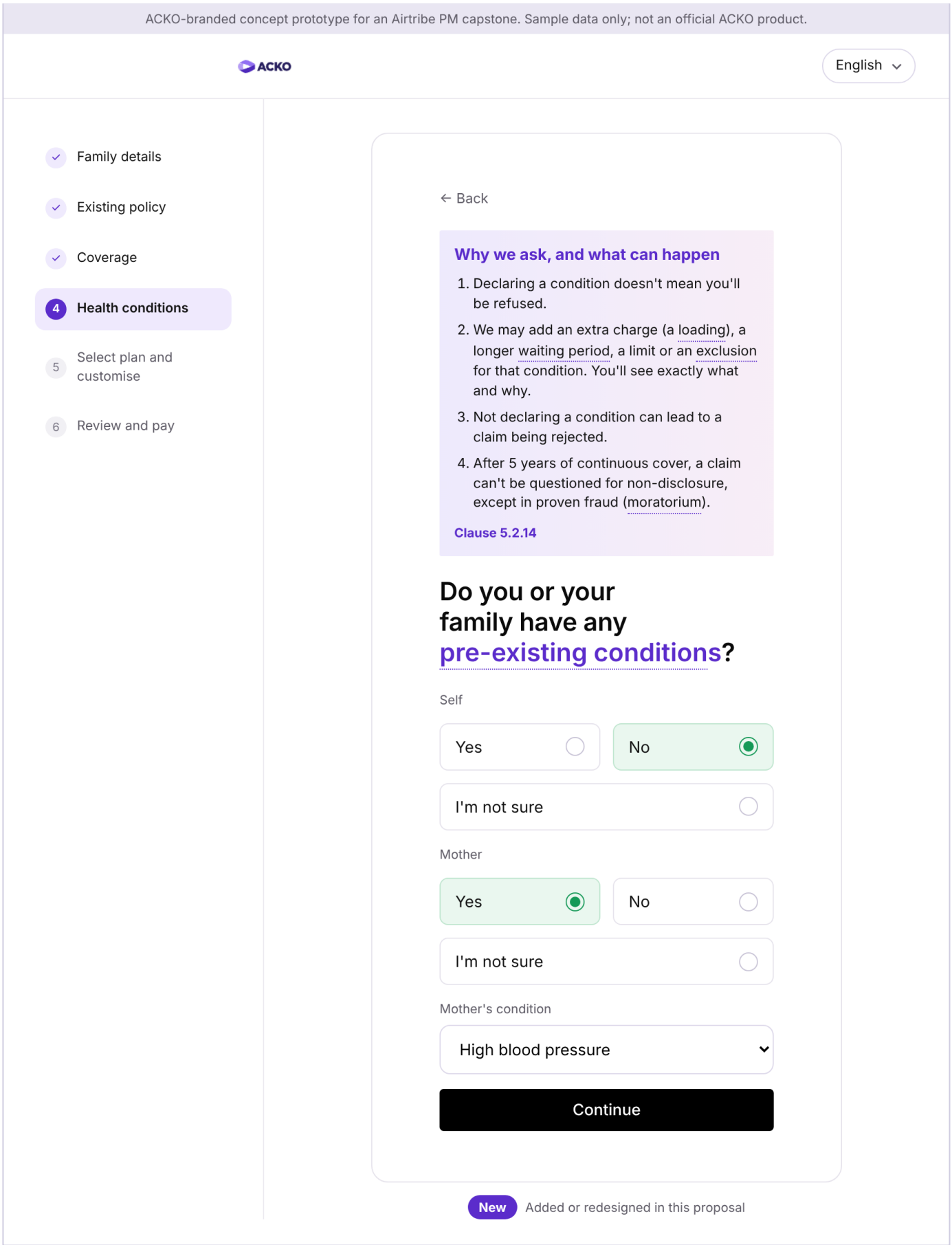
S8. Ages (Existing)



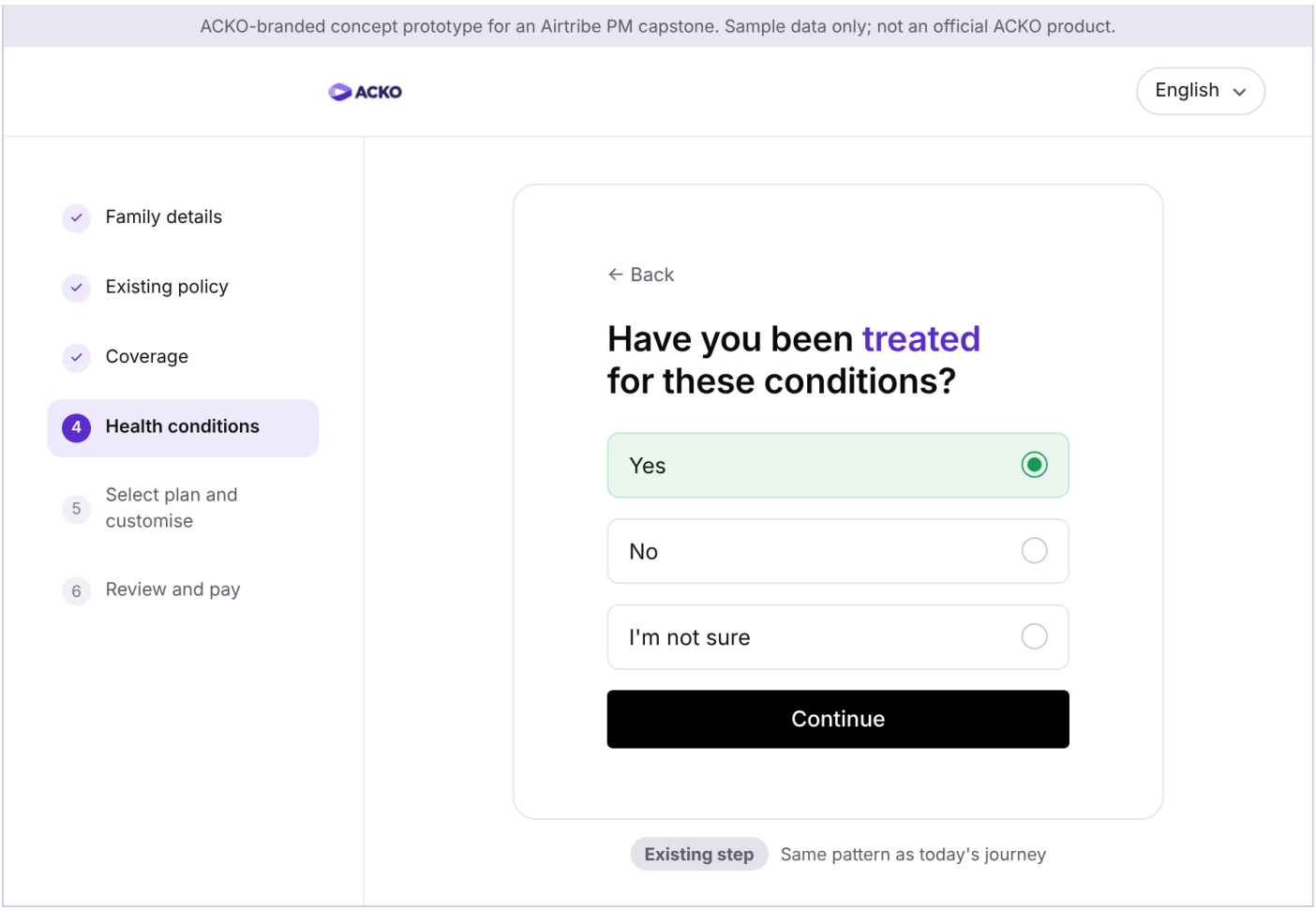
S9. Pincode (Existing)



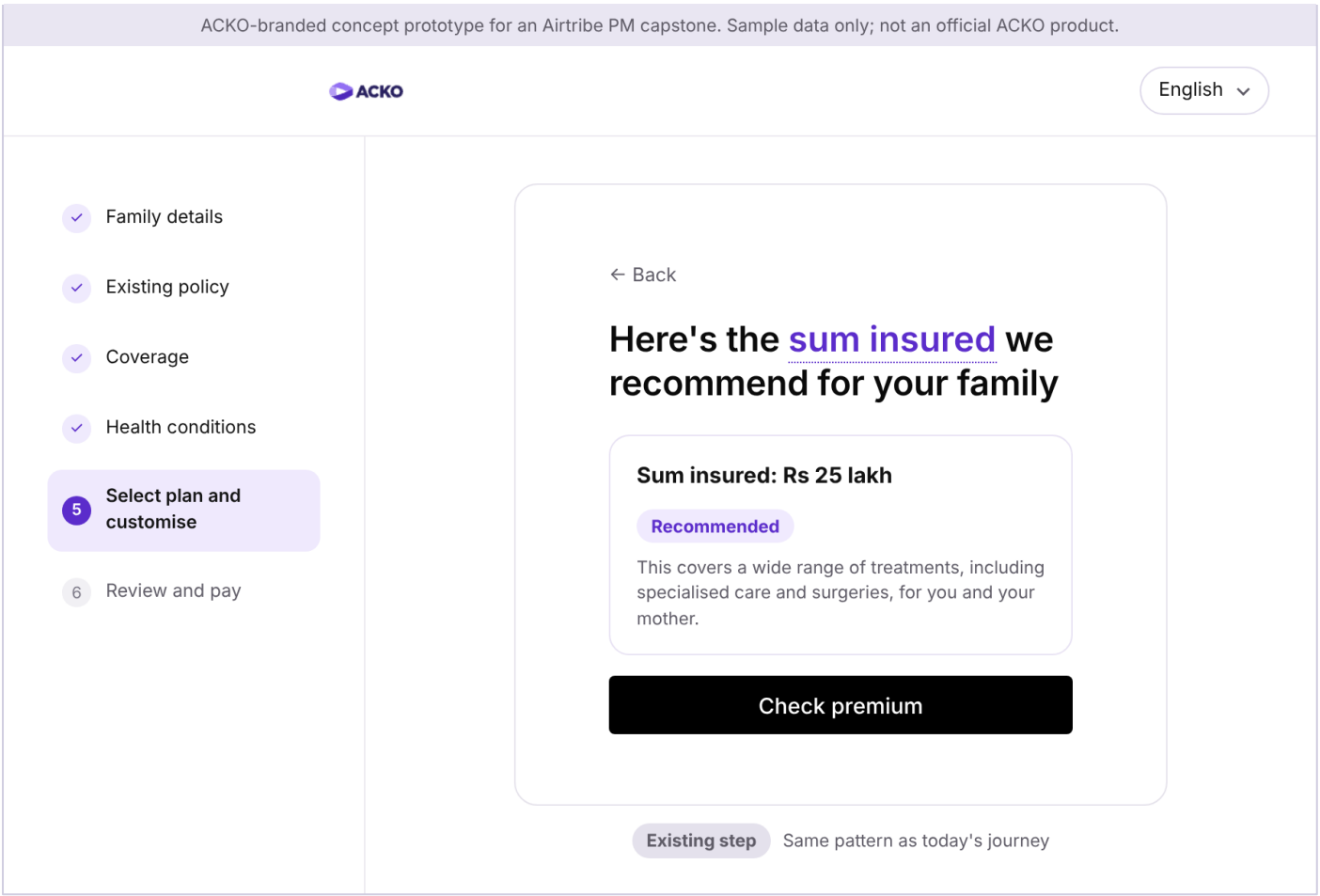
S10. Pre-existing conditions with explainer card (New element on an existing step, A5)



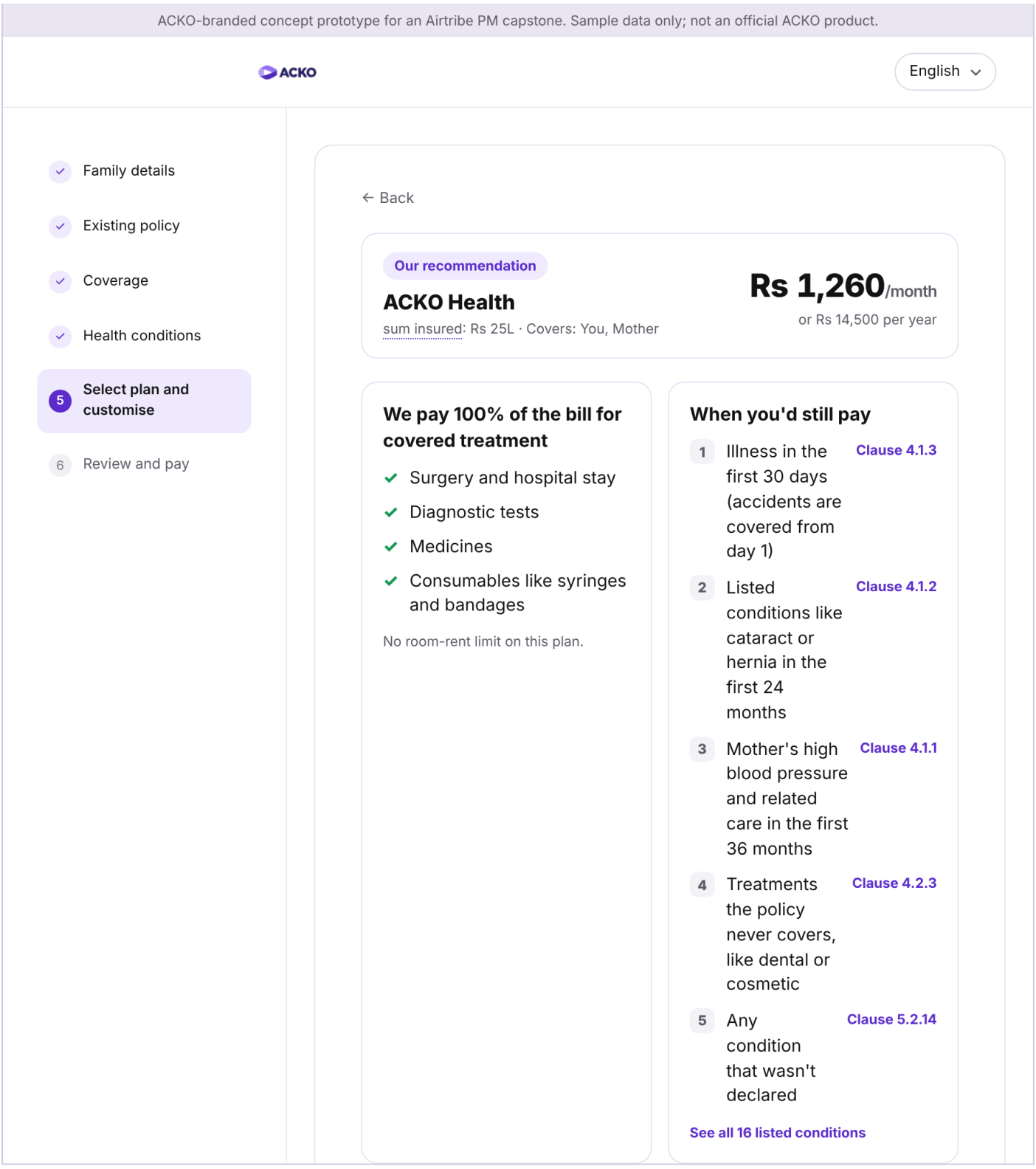
S11. Past treatment (Existing)



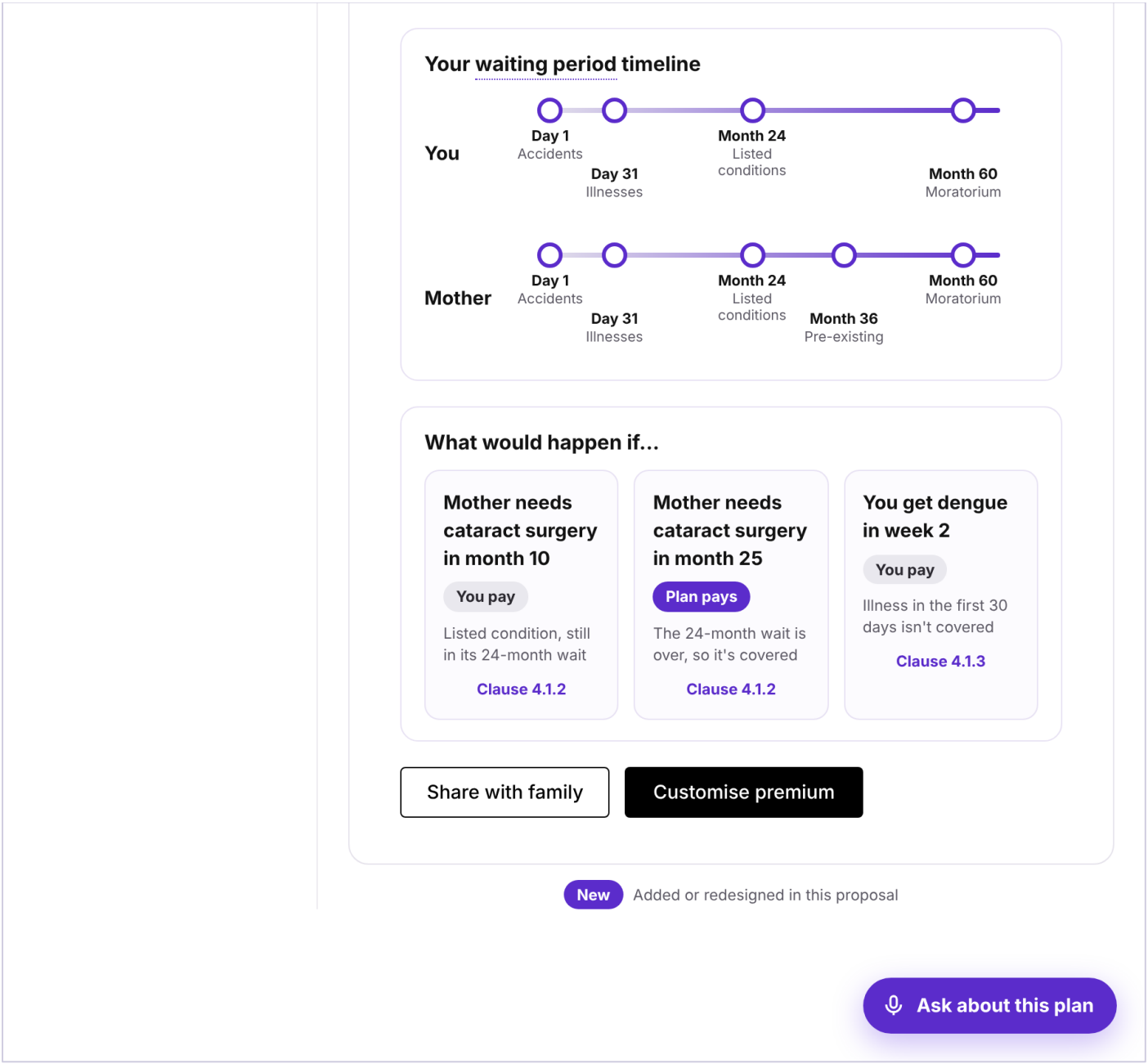
S12. Recommended sum insured (Existing)



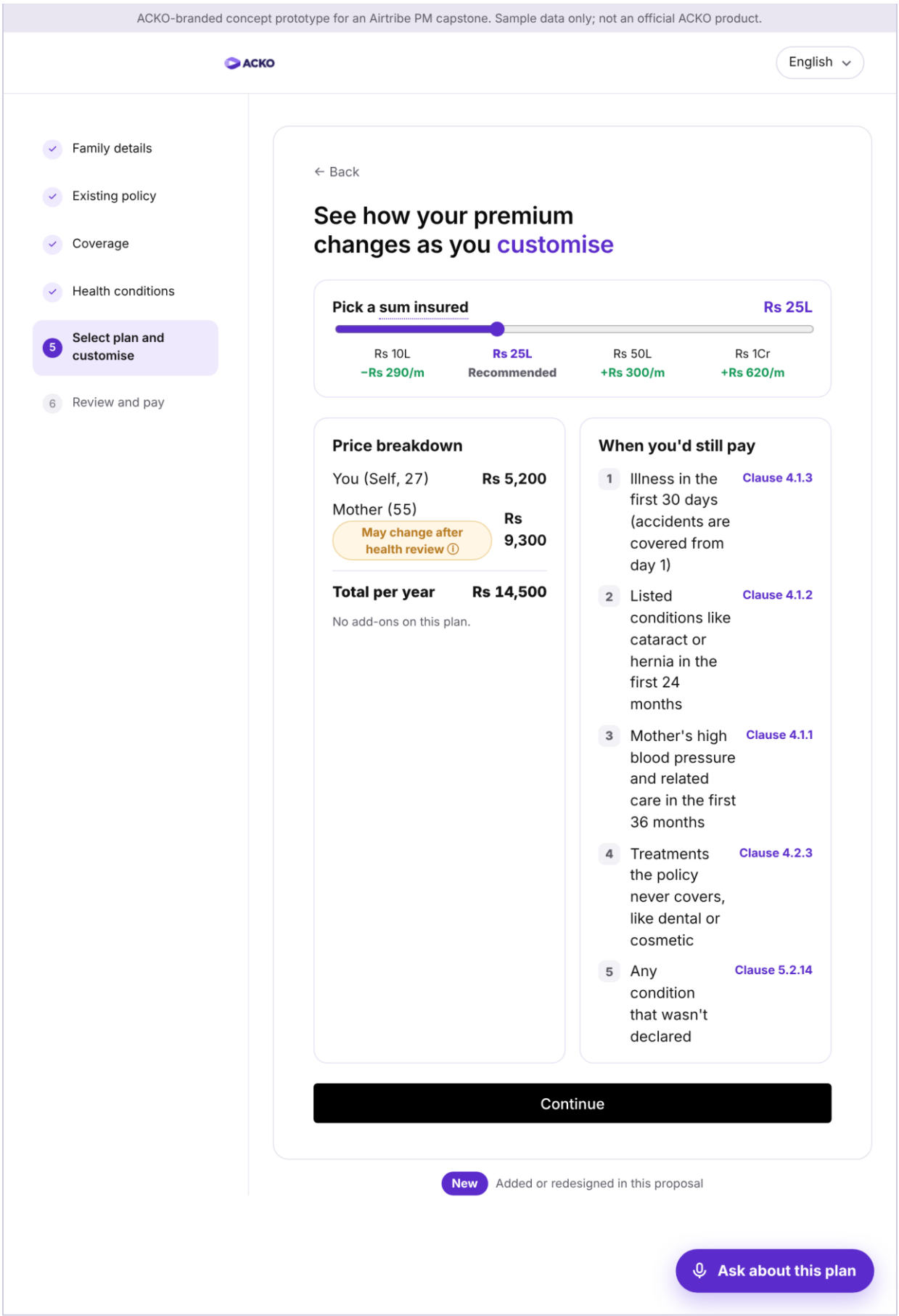
S13. Plan recommendation, redesigned (Existing step, redesigned, A1 to A3; 'Ask about this plan' button, V1)



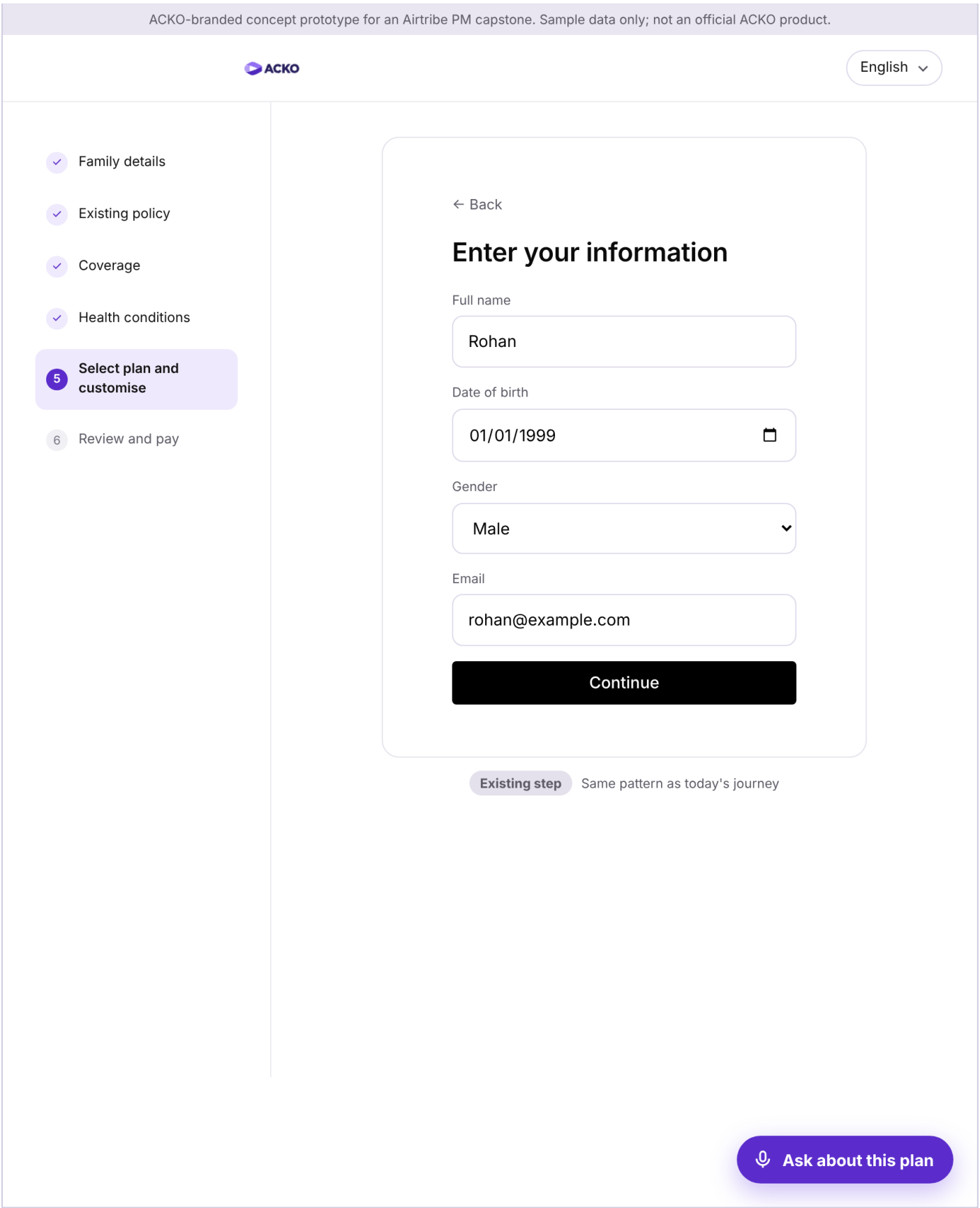
S13. Plan recommendation, redesigned (continued) (Existing step, redesigned, A1 to A3; 'Ask about this plan' button, V1)



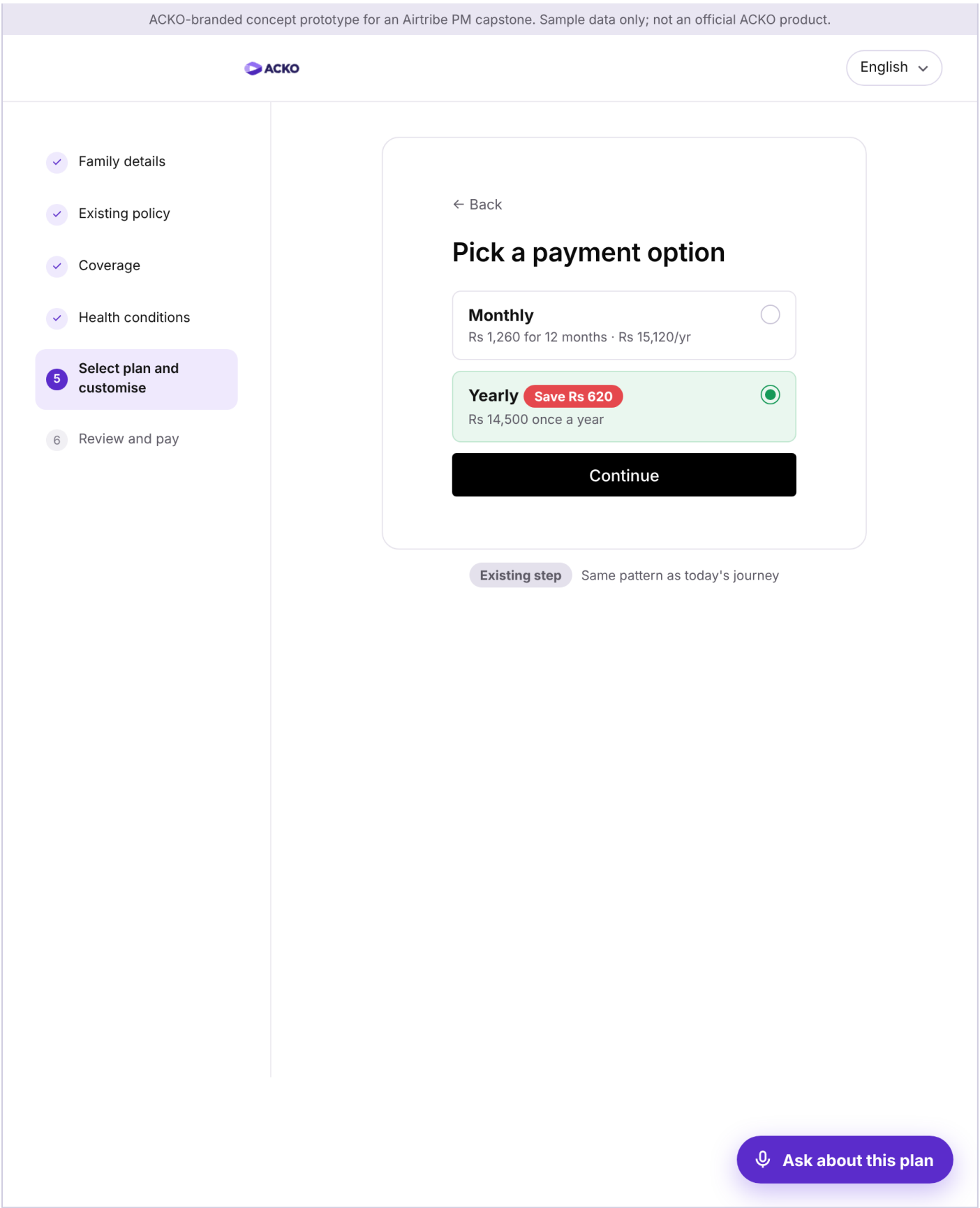
S14. Customise premium with per-member breakdown (Existing step, extended, A4)



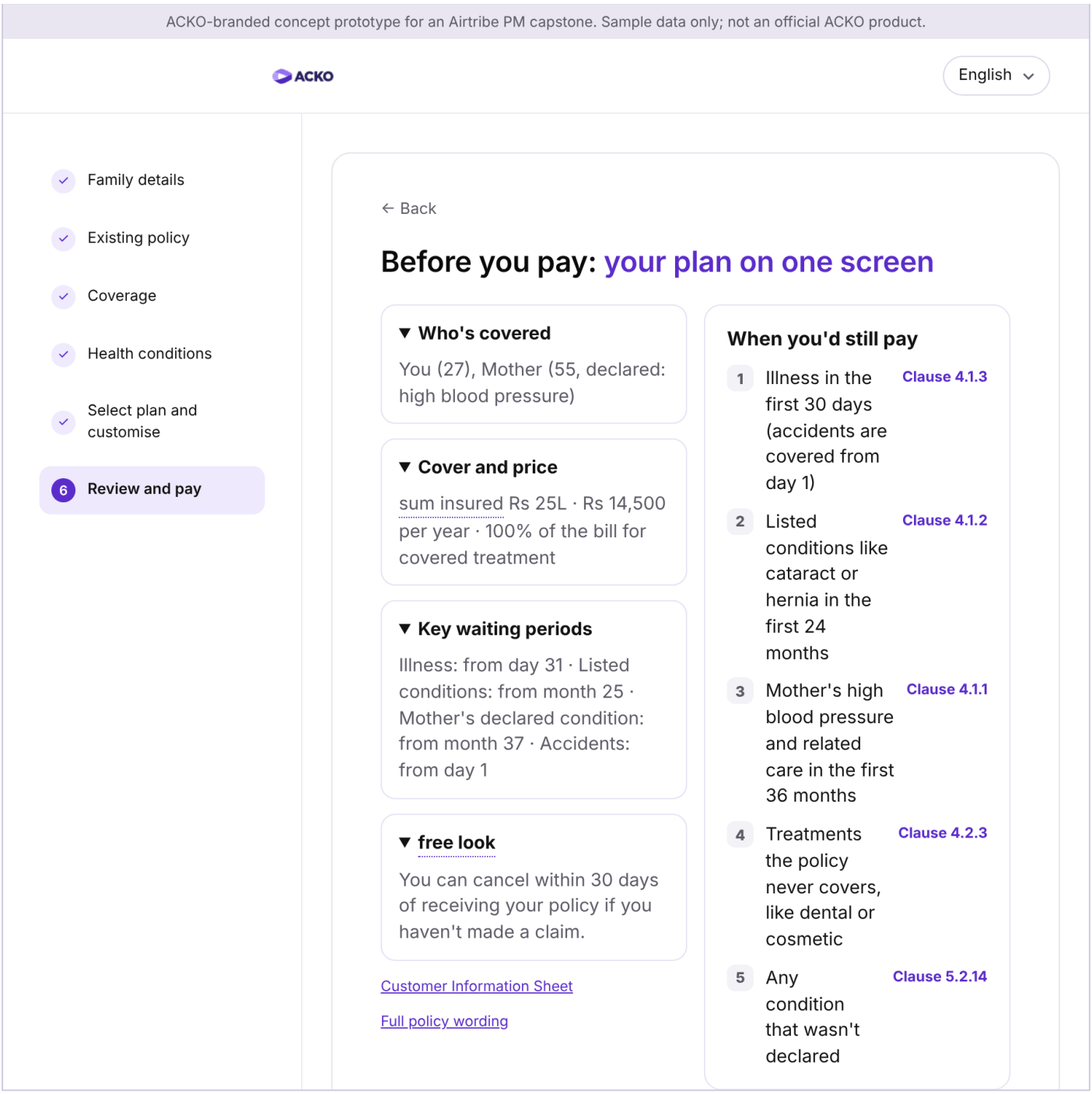
S15. Your information (Existing)



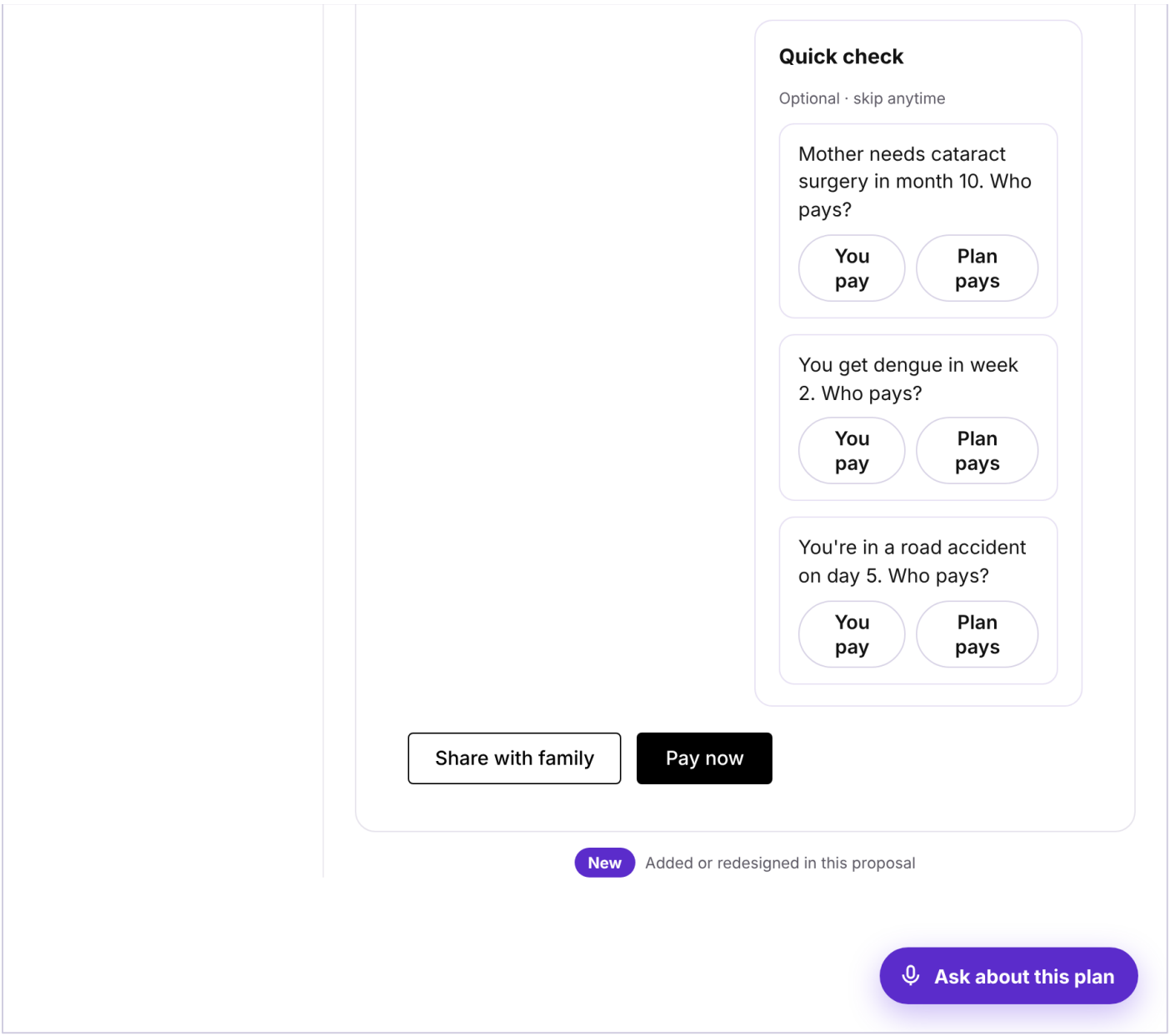
S16. Payment option (Existing)



S17. Before you pay: one-screen summary (New, A7 and A8)



S17. Before you pay: one-screen summary (continued) (New, A7 and A8)



S18. Autopay and payment (simulated) (Existing)

ACKO-branded concept prototype for an Airtribe PM capstone. Sample data only; not an official ACKO product.

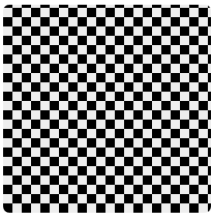
ACKO

English

- Family details
- Existing policy
- Coverage
- Health conditions
- Select plan and customise
- 6 Review and pay

← Back

Scan and complete autopay setup



Mandate amount	**Rs 14,500**
Frequency	**Yearly**
Start date	**11 Nov 2026**
End date	**11 Nov 2027**

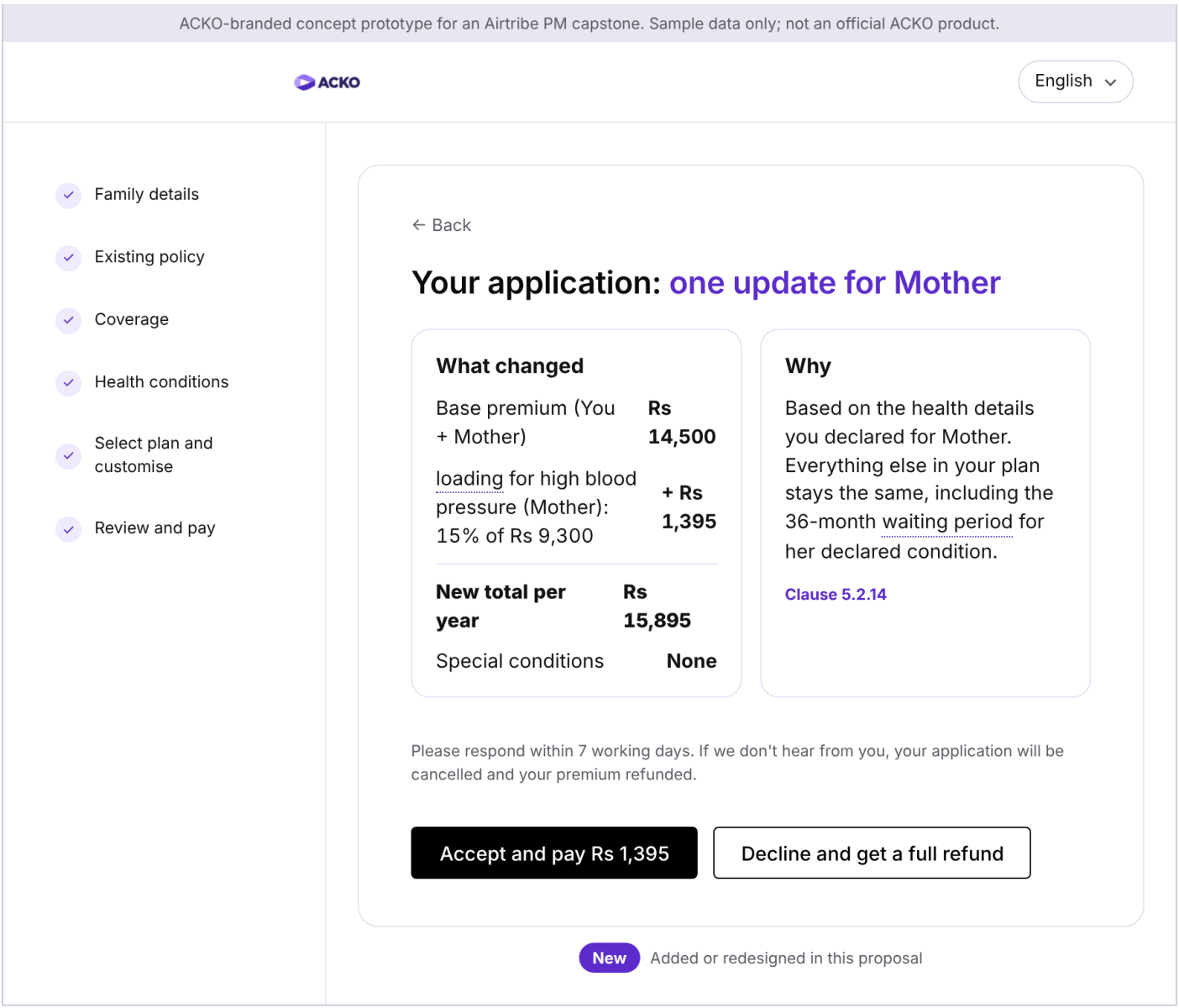
UPI | Credit or debit card

TEST MODE No real payment is taken. This QR is a placeholder.

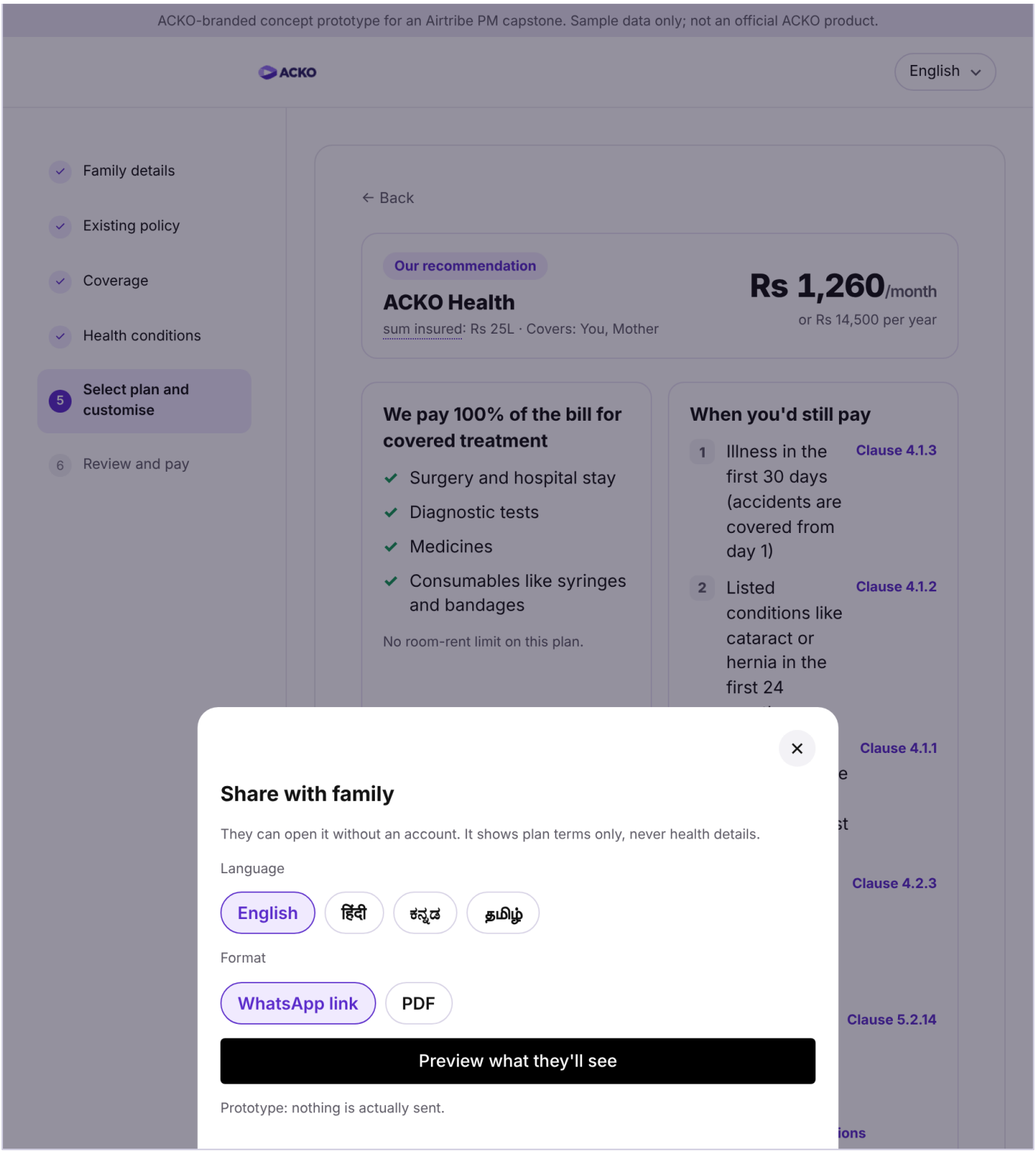
Make test payment

Existing step Same pattern as today's journey

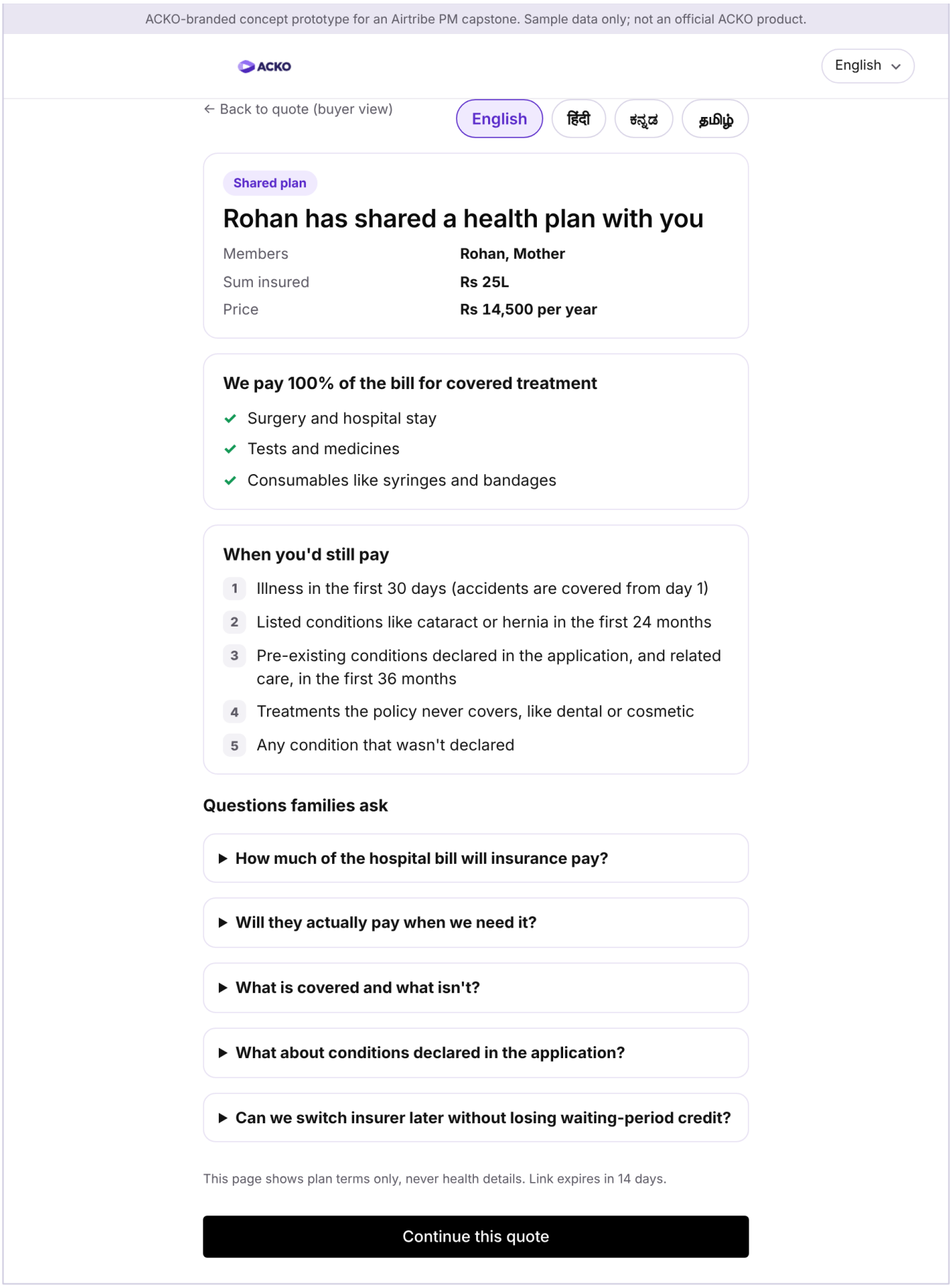
S19. Loading breakdown after application (New, A6)



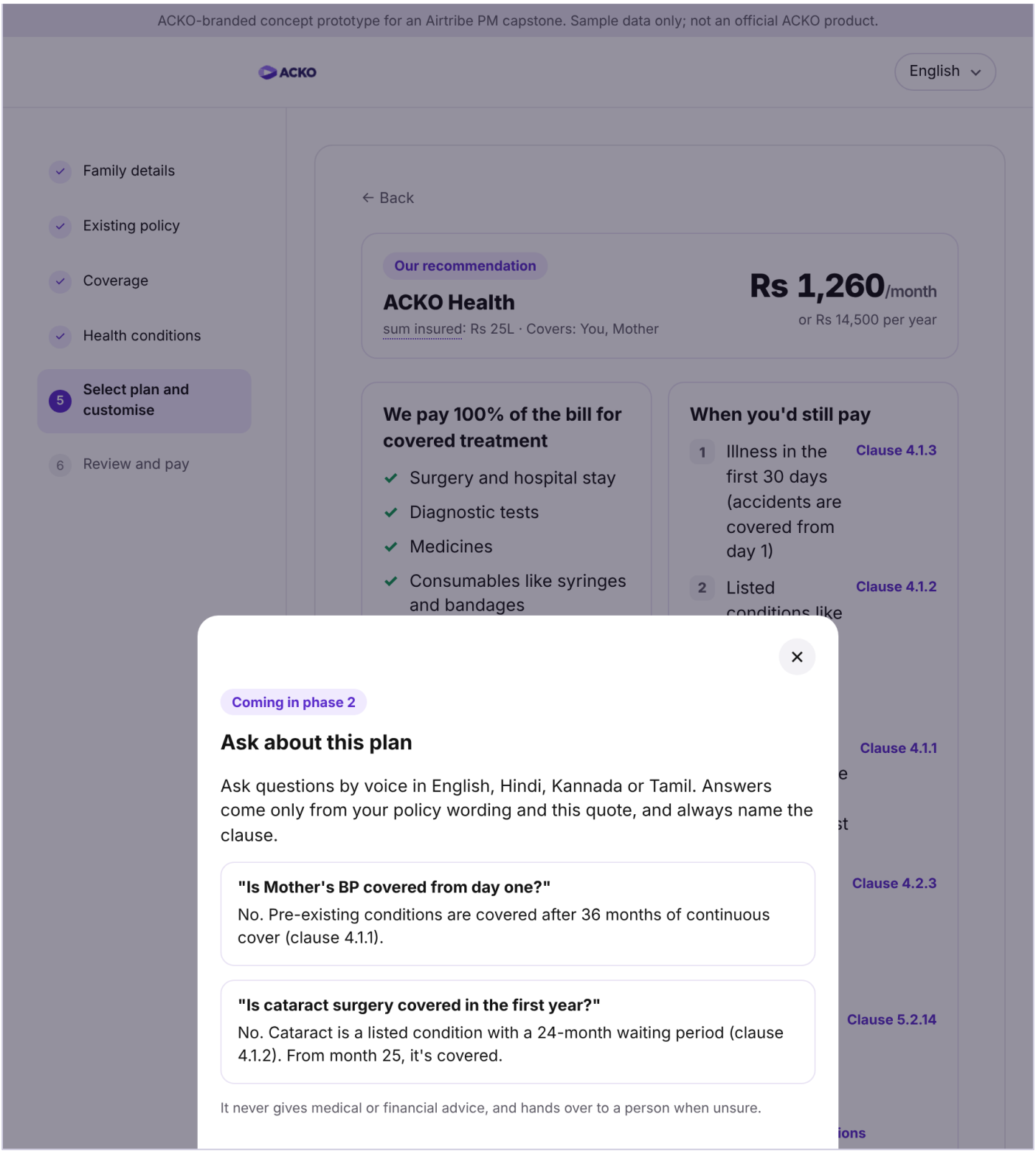
Share sheet (New, B1)



Shared page (family view) (New, B1 to B3)



'Ask about this plan' sheet (Phase 2 placeholder, V1)



Prototype link: https://sagarn9918.github.io/Acko-Health-Insurance/

Usability test plan

Item	Plan
Participants	5 to 6 people from the research who got a quote and didn't buy, including at least 2 buying for parents and 2 who prefer a non-English language

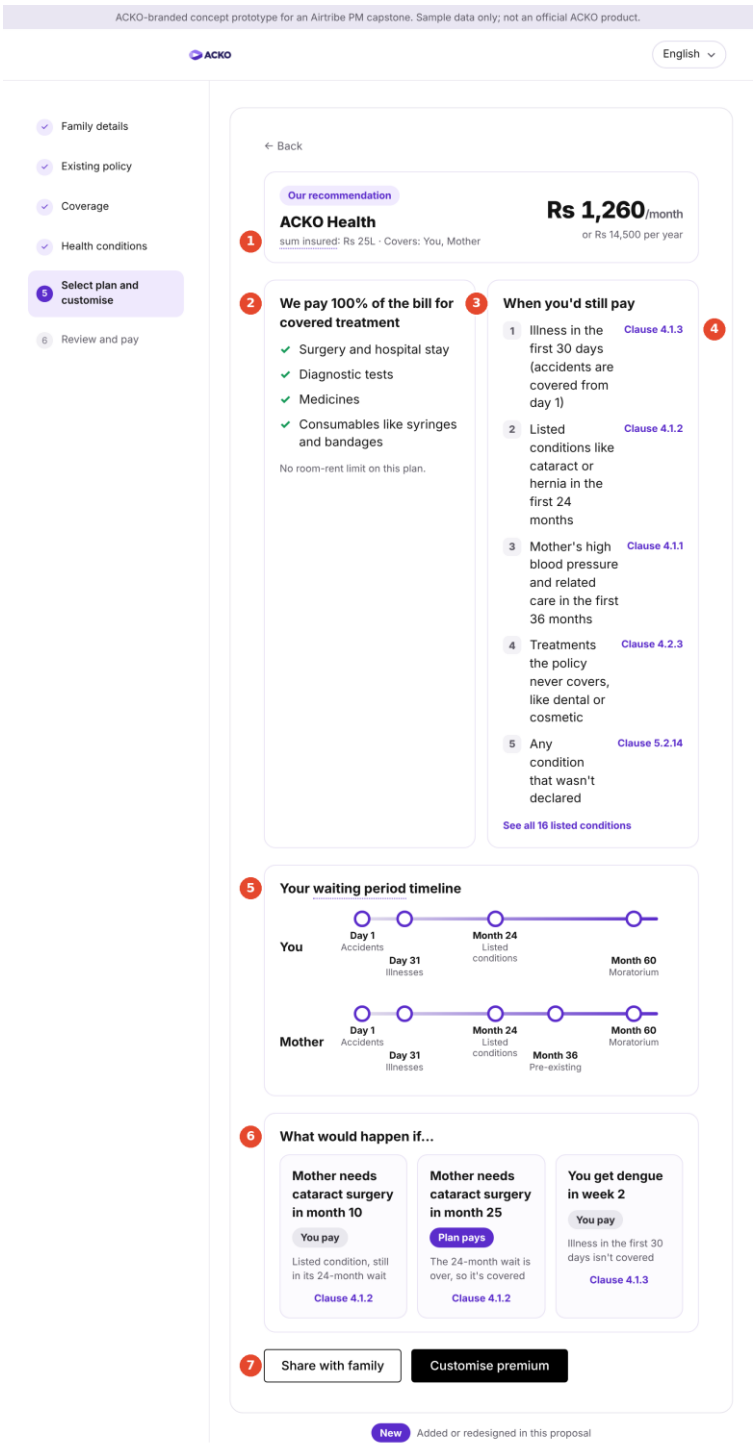
Item	Plan
Task 1	'Your mother needs cataract surgery 10 months after buying. Who pays?' Success: correct answer from S13 without help
Task 2	'Find out whether your mother's declared condition could change the price, and by how much.' Success: finds the tag on S14 and the breakdown on S19
Task 3	'Send this plan to your parents in Hindi.' Success: done in under 30 seconds
Task 4	'Pay for the plan.' Success: reaches payment without feeling slowed down (rated 4 or 5 of 5)
Decision rule	At least 4 of 5 participants pass tasks 1 and 3 before engineering build starts; otherwise iterate the copy and layout

4. Design rationale: annotated screens

Annotated screenshots of S13, S17, the shared page and S10, each traced to the research. Numbered callouts on each screen are explained below it.

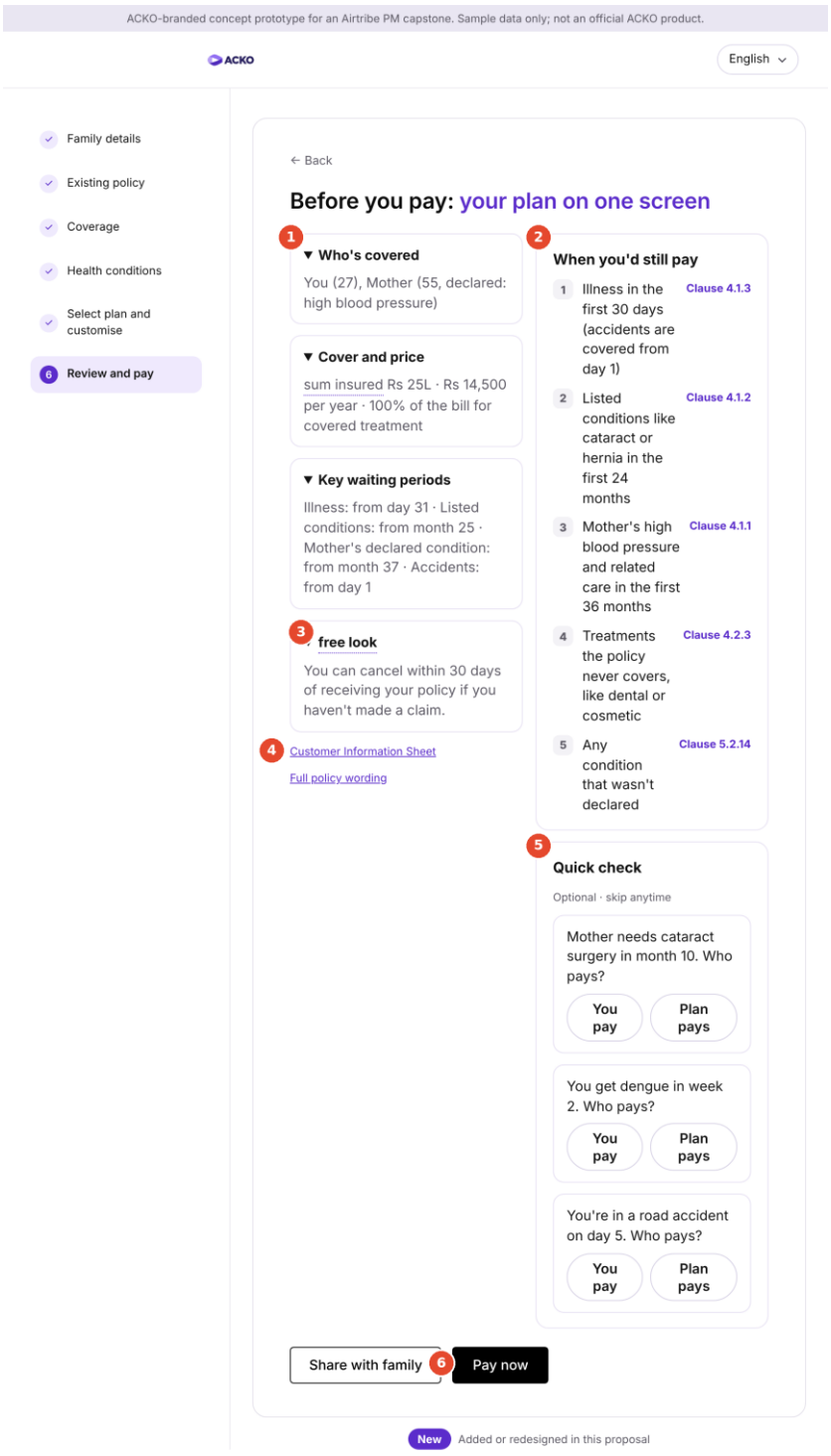
Screen	How jargon is explained	How exclusions are shown honestly	How the flow stays quick	Research it answers
S13. Plan recommendation	Dotted underline on every term with a one-sentence definition on tap; examples in everyday situations	'100% of the bill for covered treatment' beside 'When you'd still pay'; every line linked to its clause; full list one tap away	No new screen; panel collapsed to 5 lines; timeline and examples expand on tap	53% misread the cataract scenario; the 100% pop-up; exclusions 15 taps in
S17. One-screen summary	Short sentences; free look in one line	'When you'd still pay' at the top, so nobody pays without seeing it; CIS and wording linked	One screen already on the payment path; quick check optional	4 of 13 buyers misread; Persona C
Share sheet and shared page	Family's language; 'Questions families ask' from the interviews	Same 'when you'd still pay' list as the buyer saw	One tap; 'Continue this quote' returns to the same quote	Family discussion is the top blocker; 21 of 68 prefer a non-English language
S10. Pre-existing conditions	'Loading', 'waiting period' and 'moratorium' explained before the questions	States what declaring can lead to, and that not declaring can lead to rejection	A card above the existing questions; no extra step	Loadings arrive only after application (clause 5.2.14)

S13. Plan recommendation



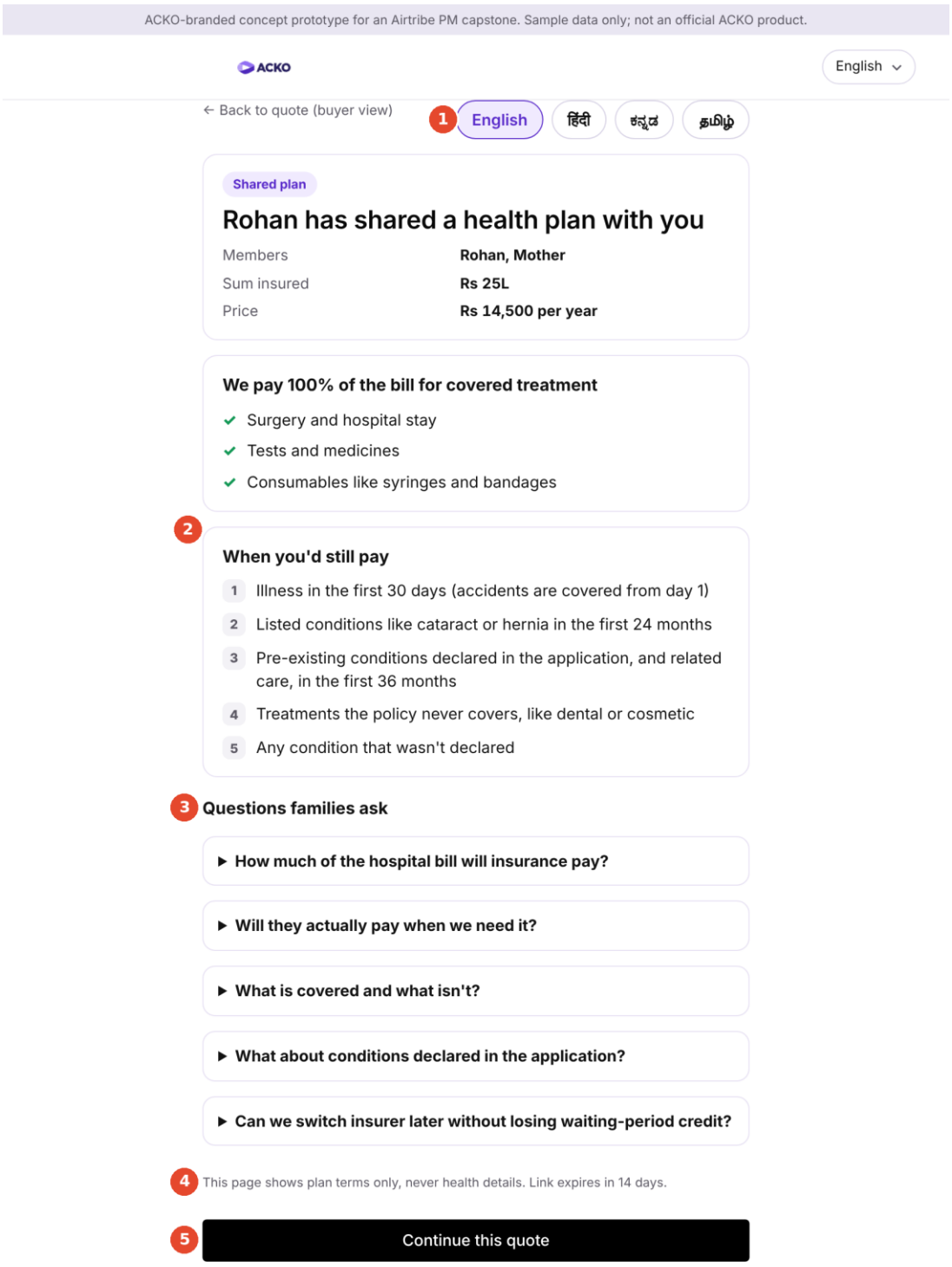
1. Dotted underline on terms such as 'sum insured': tap for a one-sentence definition.
2. The promise now reads '100% of the bill for covered treatment'.
3. 'When you'd still pay' sits right beside the promise, in 5 plain lines.
4. Every line links to the clause it comes from; the full list is one tap away.
5. Per-member waiting-period timeline: You and Mother on one view.
6. Worked examples in everyday situations, each marked 'You pay' or 'Plan pays'.
7. 'Share with family' in one tap.

S17. Before you pay: one-screen summary



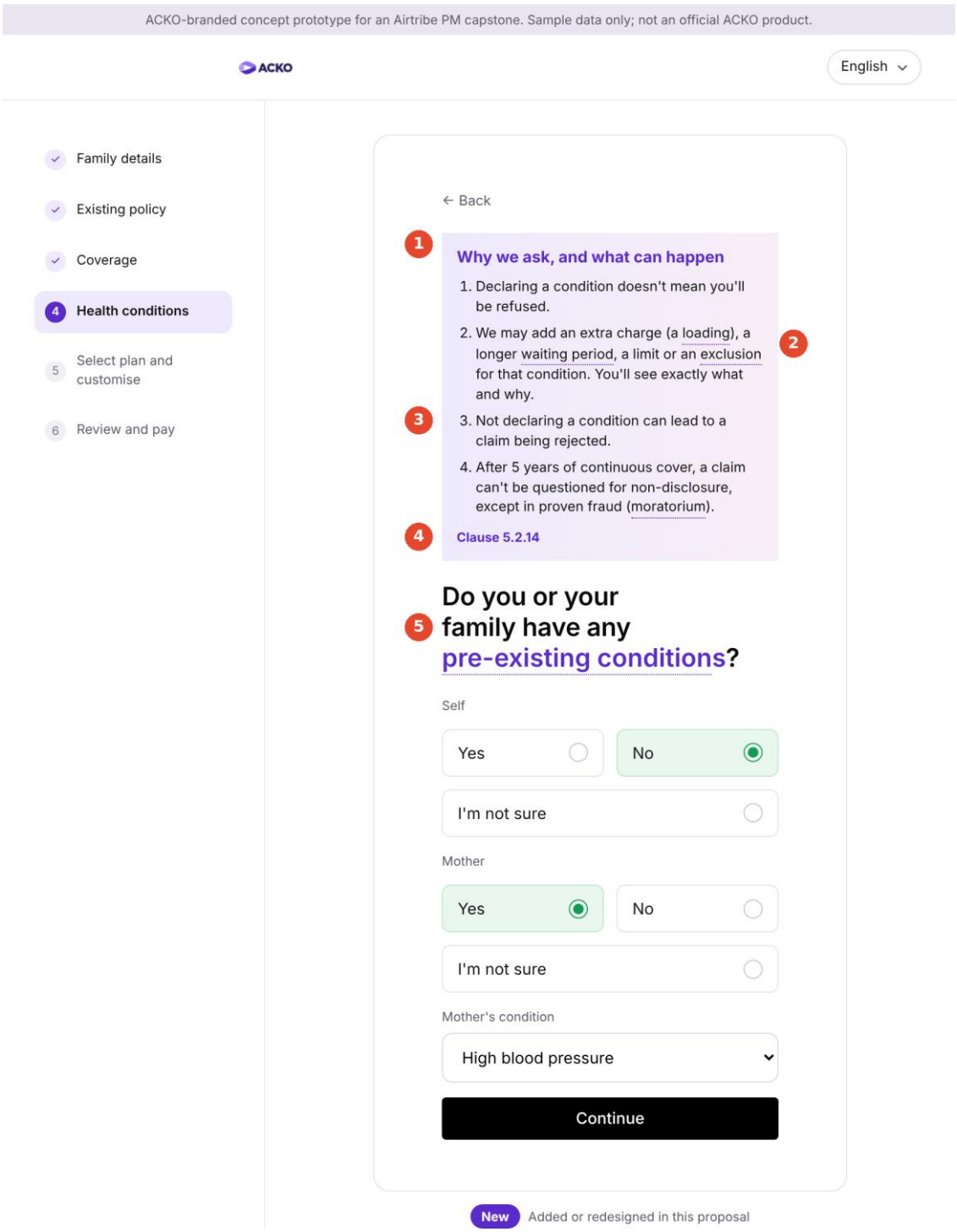
1. Short sentences: who's covered, cover and price, key waiting periods.
2. 'When you'd still pay' at the top of the payment step, so nobody pays without seeing it.
3. Free look in one line, with the term explained on tap.
4. Customer Information Sheet and full policy wording linked.
5. Quick check is optional and never blocks payment.
6. 'Pay now' is on the same screen: no extra step.

Shared page (family view)



1. The family picks their language: English, Hindi, Kannada or Tamil.
2. The same 'When you'd still pay' list the buyer saw.
3. 'Questions families ask', taken from the interviews.
4. No account needed; the link expires in 14 days.
5. 'Continue this quote' returns the buyer to the same quote.

S10. Pre-existing conditions



1. Explainer card sits above the existing questions: no extra step.
2. 'Loading', 'waiting period', 'exclusion' and 'moratorium' explained on tap.
3. States plainly that not declaring a condition can lead to a claim being rejected.
4. Clause 5.2.14 linked.
5. The health question itself is unchanged from today's journey.

Step 5: Go-to-Market, Growth Loop & Business Impact

Headline: launch to first-time buyers covering a parent, in all four languages, as an A/B test on Acko's existing quote traffic, then widen to every first-time buyer once the readout clears. At the 26% target, every 10,000 first-time quote-holders bring 1,400 more policies and about Rs 2.1 cr more first-year premium; with renewals at the online-market benchmark of 89%, the same 10,000 are worth about Rs 5.6 cr more over three years. The design only pays off if it wins more buyers than its extra reading loses: every 5% of today's buyers it slows away costs about 60 policies per 10,000.

Evidence base: the same research as Steps 1 to 4 (survey of 68, 7 recorded interviews, about 10 informal conversations, the teardown and the Acko Health II policy wording), plus one public renewal benchmark, cited where used. Acko's quote volumes and average premium aren't public, so the model works per 10,000 quote-holders and labels every assumption.

1. Go-to-market plan

1.1 Who we launch to first: first-time quote-holders buying for a parent

These are buyers covering a parent or in-law, with or without themselves. They are where the gap between intent and purchase is widest, where every part of the design gets used (outcomes, transparent pricing for a declared condition, family sharing), and where a misunderstanding costs most at claim time. If the design works for them, it will work for buyers covering only themselves; the reverse doesn't hold.

What we compared	Buyers covering a parent	Buyers covering only themselves	Source
Share of respondents	31 of 68	31 of 68	Survey Q5
Looked at buying in the last 12 months and bought	5 of 20 (25%)	9 of 16 (56%)	Survey Q1 by Q5
Misread the cataract waiting-period scenario	17 of 31 (55%)	16 of 31 (52%)	Survey Q8
Needed to discuss with family before buying	9 of the 14 who named it	3 of the 14	Survey Q9
Likely to declare a condition and face a loading	High (Step 3 reach assumption)	Lower	Step 3; clause 5.2.14
Premium per policy	Higher: more members, older ages	Lower	Acko quote structure

What we give up: a smaller test population than all first-time quote-holders. If parent buyers can't fill about 2,036 quote-holders per arm (Step 4 sample size) within four weeks, cohort 1 opens to all first-time quote-holders and parent buyers are read as a pre-registered segment.

1.2 Languages: all four at launch

The survey asked which language the buyer, or the family member who has to agree, would prefer. 47 chose English, 11 Hindi, 5 Kannada, 3 Tamil, 1 Telugu and 1 Konkani (more than one answer was allowed). Among parent buyers it was 23 English, 5 Hindi, 2 Kannada and 1 Konkani.

- **English** stays the default, since most buyers, including most parent buyers, chose it.
- **Hindi, Kannada and Tamil** ship at launch, as the PRD sets out. They matter most in the share pack, because the person reading it is often the parent who has to agree.

- **Telugu and Konkani** come next, if Acko's own quote data shows demand. One respondent each isn't enough to justify a translation and compliance cycle, and our sample is a convenience sample, so Acko's real language mix decides the order.

1.3 Channel and message

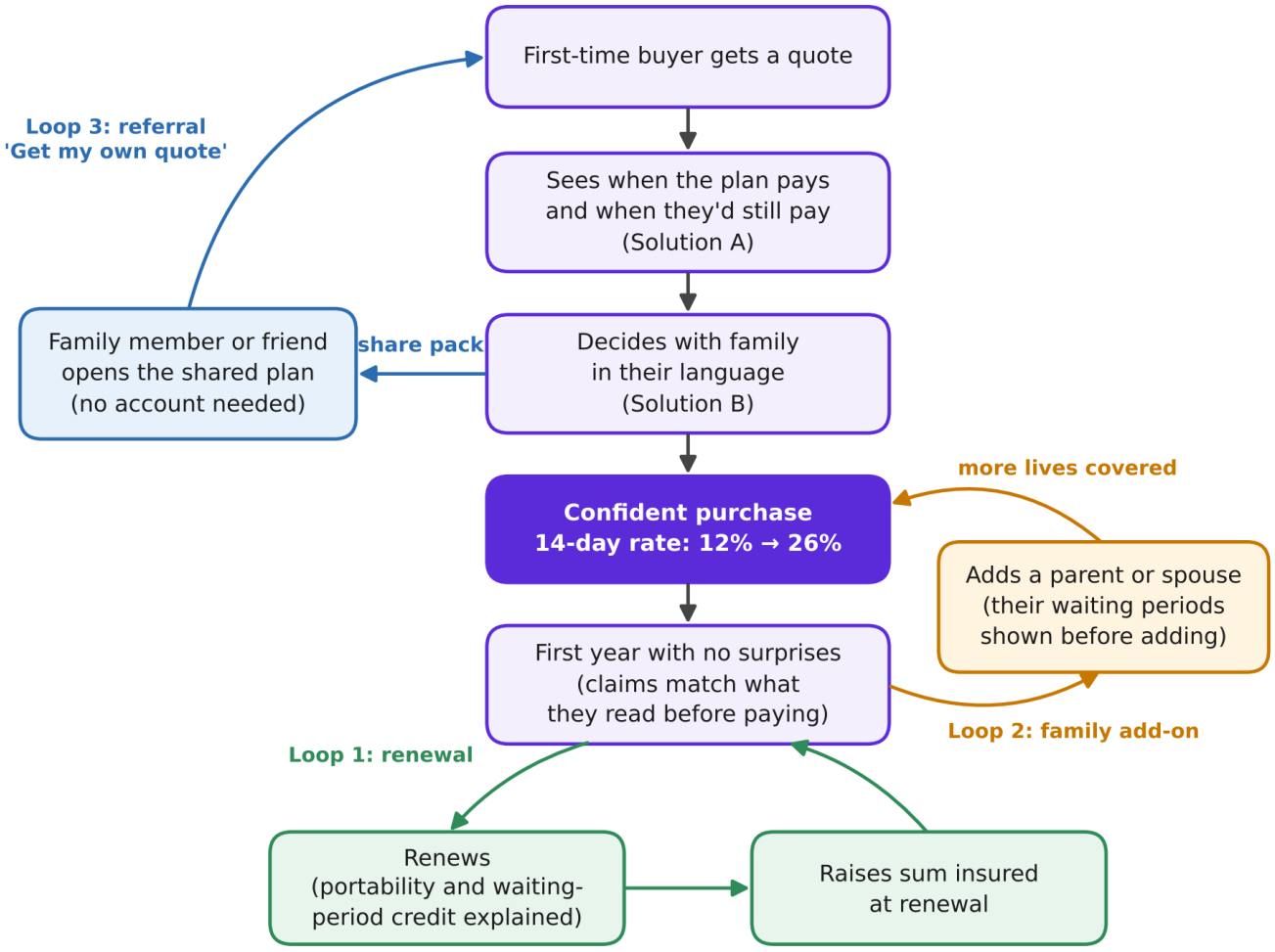
Decision	What we do	Why
Reach	No new acquisition spend during the test. The change sits on existing first-time quote traffic in the app and on the web.	Keeps the cohort comparable with the 12% baseline. A campaign during the test would change who arrives and blur the readout.
Message	'Know what you'll pay, and when.' The promise reads '100% of the bill for covered treatment', always beside 'When you'd still pay'.	The brief rules out discounts, urgency and fear. An honest promise is also the hardest one for a competitor to copy.
The follow-up call	Acko's existing follow-up call (one call the day after our teardown quote) uses the same 'when you'd still pay' list and the share link.	A buyer should hear the same thing on the phone that they read on screen.
After full rollout	Tell existing Acko customers, starting with motor policyholders in the app.	All 7 interviewees had heard of Acko, but only 2 knew it sells health insurance; one already holds Acko vehicle insurance.

1.4 Ready before launch (week 10)

Team	What they need before week 10
Compliance and Legal	Sign-off on every template and all four languages (Step 4 milestone, week 10)
Customer support and sales	The same 'when you'd still pay' answers and family FAQ, so calls and chat match the screens
Claims	A tag for complaints and disputes about waiting periods and exclusions, for the guardrail
Underwriting	Counteroffer data available to the app for the loading breakdown (A6)
Marketing	No campaigns that change first-time quote traffic while cohorts 1 and 2 run

2. Growth / behaviour loop

A confident first purchase should lead to three things: a renewal, a family member added, and a friend or relative who gets their own quote. Each loop reuses what Solutions A and B already build, so the loops add little new effort.



Loop	What happens	What the product does	Research behind it	How we'll know (Step 6)
1. Renewal	A buyer who had no surprises in year 1 renews, and some raise their sum insured	At renewal, shows the waiting-period credit they've built and how portability works; offers a higher sum insured only if they ask	7 of 68 wanted a better renewal offer or easy portability; the interviewee who bought at 26 chose lower cover and plans to top up later	Renewal rate, treatment vs control; sum insured upgrades
2. Family add-on	A buyer covering only themselves adds a parent or spouse at renewal	Shows the new member's price and waiting periods before adding, using the same panel, timeline and breakdown (A1, A2, A4)	31 of 68 cover only themselves; 37 of 68 buy for family; 7 of 21 non-buyers said the premium was too high or jumped after adding parents, so adding later is a real path	Members added at renewal per 100 policies

Loop	What happens	What the product does	Research behind it	How we'll know (Step 6)
3. Referral	A family member or friend who opens the shared plan gets their own quote	Adds 'Get my own quote' to the shared page: a fresh quote, with nothing carried over from the sender	Family or friends is what people relied on most (20 of 68); trust comes from people, one interviewee buys only on referral, another knew no one who had used Acko	Shared-page opens, new quotes from them, and their 14-day purchase rate

Loop rules: no reminders unless the buyer opts in, and no cash rewards for referrals. Rebates and inducements to buy insurance are prohibited under Section 41 of the Insurance Act, and the brief rules out aggressive notifications. The three loop additions (L1 renewal view, L2 add-a-member view, L3 'Get my own quote') go on the backlog after the v1 readout.

3. Business impact model

3.1 Assumptions

Input	Value	Basis
Confirmed purchase rate	12% today, 26% target	Brief
Unit	Per 10,000 first-time quote-holders	Acko's volumes aren't public; everything scales in a straight line
Average first-year premium	Rs 15,000 (assumption)	Lower end of the Rs 15,000 to 20,000 an interviewee expected to pay (Step 2); replace with Acko's figure
Renewal rate	89% a year	Policybazaar's health renewal persistency, March 2026 quarter, the closest benchmark for online buyers. Star Health reports 98 to 99% on a much older book, so it's treated as an upper bound
Premium at renewal	Same as year 1	Simplification. Real premiums rise with age bands, so this understates renewal value

3.2 Policies, premium and renewals (per 10,000 first-time quote-holders)

	Today (12%)	Target (26%)	Change
Year 1: policies	1,200	2,600	+1,400
Year 1: premium	Rs 1.80 cr	Rs 3.90 cr	+Rs 2.10 cr
Year 2: policies renewed (89%)	1,068	2,314	+1,246
Year 2: renewal premium	Rs 1.60 cr	Rs 3.47 cr	+Rs 1.87 cr
Year 3: policies renewed (89%)	951	2,059	+1,108
Year 3: renewal premium	Rs 1.43 cr	Rs 3.09 cr	+Rs 1.66 cr
Three-year premium	**Rs 4.83 cr**	**Rs 10.46 cr**	**+Rs 5.63 cr**

Rule of thumb for Acko's real volume: extra first-year premium a year = first-time quote-holders a month x 12 x 14% x Rs 15,000, which works out to Rs 25,200 for every first-time quote-holder Acko sees in a month. At 10,000 a month, that's Rs 25.2 cr a year.

How much the renewal rate matters: the extra three-year premium per 10,000 quote-holders is Rs 5.12 cr at 80% renewal, Rs 5.63 cr at 89% and Rs 5.99 cr at 95%. The case holds even at the low end.

Not counted, measured first: the loops. Each 1% of self-only buyers who add one family member at renewal adds about 12 lives per 10,000 quote-holders (2,600 buyers x 31 of 68 who cover only themselves = about 1,185, and 1% of that). Referral value depends on share, open and quote rates we don't have yet; cohort 1 measures them before anyone models them. Build effort is about 7.5 person-months (Step 3 estimates: 4.5 for Solution A, 3 for Solution B).

3.3 What it costs if comprehension slows the flow

More understanding means more to read, and some of today's buyers won't wait for it. The most exposed are the buyers who already decide fast: 4 of the 13 survey buyers bought the same day, and 18 of 68 said nothing stopped them. That cost shows up in three ways.

Today's buyers lost to extra reading	Policies lost per 10,000	First-year premium lost	Gross lift needed to still reach 26%
5%	60	Rs 9 lakh	14.6 points (not 14)
10%	120	Rs 18 lakh	15.2 points
20%	240	Rs 36 lakh	16.4 points

- **Lost buyers (table above).** This is why the design adds no mandatory step: the panel sits collapsed on the existing quote page and the summary replaces the existing review screen. The guardrail is median time to pay rising by no more than one minute (Step 4).
- **Decisions pushed past day 14.** Sharing invites a pause. A buyer who pays on day 20 brings real premium but counts as a non-purchase in the 14-day rate. 5 of 21 non-buyers in the survey took more than 14 days. We'll track the 30-day rate beside the 14-day rate, so sharing isn't cut for the wrong reason.
- **Regret.** If conversion rises with regret, it shows up as free-look cancellations within 30 days. At 26%, every 2% of buyers who cancel is 52 policies and Rs 7.8 lakh of premium per 10,000 refunded (5% is 130 policies and Rs 19.5 lakh), less the proportionate premium and costs IRDAI allows the insurer to keep, plus the acquisition cost already spent. The guardrail is no increase in free-look cancellations against control.

Bottom line: the target is worth about Rs 2.1 cr of first-year premium and Rs 5.6 cr over three years for every 10,000 first-time quote-holders. Friction can quietly eat into that, so the rollout gates on time to pay and free-look cancellations, not just on the purchase rate.

4. Cohort rollout plan

Each cohort has to pass its gate before the next one opens. A feature flag turns everything off at once, and the guardrails from Step 4 can stop the rollout at any stage.

Cohort	When	Who	Traffic split	What ships	Gate to the next cohort
0. Prototype	Weeks 3 to 6	5 to 6 research participants who got a quote and didn't buy; internal staff	Not live	Clickable prototype of A1 to A8 and B1 to B3	At least 4 of 5 pass usability tasks 1 and 3 (Step 4)

Cohort	When	Who	Traffic split	What ships	Gate to the next cohort
1. Launch segment	Week 10, read out at week 14	First-time quote-holders covering a parent; app and web; all four languages	50% new design, 50% today's flow	Solutions A and B	14-day rate up with statistical significance (about 2,036 per arm to detect 12% to 15%); no guardrail breached
2. All first-time buyers	Weeks 14 to 18	All first-time quote-holders, including self-only buyers	50 / 50	Same	Lift holds for self-only buyers; median time to pay up by no more than one minute
3. Full rollout	Week 18 to month 6	All first-time quote-holders	95% new design, 5% held back	Same, plus v1.1 tests: price before phone number, claim walkthrough	26% against the 5% holdout at month 6; free-look and dispute guardrails flat or lower
4. Phase 2	After month 6	Opt-in buyers in each language, starting small	Pilot	Voice policy assistant (prototyped in Step 8); loop additions L1 to L3	Spoken answers match the policy wording and give no advice; loop metrics set from cohort 1 data

Why keep a 5% holdout: quote traffic and buying moods change with the season. Without a group still on today's flow, nobody can tell at month 6 whether 26% came from the design or from the calendar.

Rollback: if a stop criterion trips (free-look cancellations or waiting-period complaints up against control, or time to pay above the limit), the flag goes off for that cohort. A wording error found in any language is fixed once in the policy content map and updates every screen and the share pack together.

Step 5 summary

Item	Result
Launch segment	First-time quote-holders buying for a parent; widest intent-to-purchase gap (25% vs 56%)
Languages	English, Hindi, Kannada and Tamil at launch; Telugu and Konkani next if Acko's data shows demand
Growth loops	Renewal, family add-on and referral, built on Solution A and B components; no paid rewards
Impact per 10,000 quote-holders	+1,400 policies, +Rs 2.1 cr first-year premium, +Rs 5.6 cr over three years at 89% renewal
Cost of friction	Every 5% of today's buyers lost to extra reading costs 60 policies and Rs 9 lakh

Item	Result
Rollout	Prototype, then parent buyers 50/50, then all first-time buyers, then 95/5 with a holdout to month 6, then phase 2

Step 6: Metrics & Success Measurement

Headline: the North Star is the confident purchase rate: the share of first-time quote-holders who make a confirmed purchase within 14 days, saw the plan's key limits before paying, and keep the policy past the 30-day free look. The target is 26% at month 6, measured against a 5% holdout. Below it sit leading signals that show whether buyers are actually reading and sharing, lagging results that show whether the business moved, and four guardrails that stop the rollout if conversion rises with confusion, regret or disputes.

How this links to earlier steps: the Step 4 PRD named the primary metric, guardrails and hypotheses and pointed here for full definitions. Step 5 added the 30-day purchase rate, the 5% holdout and the loop metrics. This step defines all of them in one place, with the events that feed them.

1. North Star Metric

Confident purchase rate: of first-time quote-holders in a given week, the share who make a confirmed purchase within 14 days of their first quote (their own selections, no agent override), had the key limits on screen before paying, and haven't cancelled in the 30-day free look. **Target: 26% by month 6** (baseline 12%).

Part of the definition	Why it's there
Confirmed purchase within 14 days	The brief's own measure of success. It keeps the North Star tied to the 12% to 26% goal and to the Step 4 experiment.
Saw the key limits before paying	A purchase only counts as confident if the buyer had 'When you'd still pay' in front of them. The one-screen summary sits on the payment path, so this should be true for every buyer in the new flow; any gap is a bug.
Kept past the 30-day free look	A buyer who cancels in the free look was pushed, not convinced. Taking them out stops the rate rising with regret.

Why not just the purchase rate: it can be lifted by pressure, which the brief rules out, and it can't tell a buyer who understood from one who didn't. **Why not a comprehension score:** we can't test every buyer's understanding without adding a mandatory step, which Step 3 rejected. Confident purchase rate combines what the business needs (a purchase) with two things we can observe on every buyer (saw the limits, didn't cancel).

When it's read: the free look runs 30 days after the policy is received, so the full North Star for a weekly cohort settles about 45 days after the quote. The 14-day confirmed purchase rate is the fast read used for experiment decisions (Step 4); the North Star confirms it a month later.

Checkpoint	Cohort	What we expect
Week 14 readout	Parent buyers, 50/50 (Step 5 cohort 1)	14-day rate up with statistical significance; the test is sized to detect 12% to 15% (about 2,036 per arm)
Week 18	All first-time quote-holders, 50/50 (cohort 2)	The lift holds for buyers covering only themselves
Month 6	95% new design vs 5% holdout (cohort 3)	Confident purchase rate at 26% against the holdout's rate

2. Supporting metrics

Leading indicators move within days and tell us whether the mechanism is working: if buyers don't open the panel or share the plan, the North Star won't move, and we'll know why.

Metric	Definition	Baseline	Target	Validates
Limits panel or timeline opened	Quote-holders who expand 'When you'd still pay' or the waiting-period timeline / quote-holders who see the quote page	New	Set after 4 weeks of data	H1: buyers engage with outcomes
Worked example viewed	Quote-holders who view at least one 'You pay / Plan pays' example / quote-holders	New	Set after 4 weeks	H1
Clause link opened	Clause or full-list opens per 100 quote-holders	New	Tracked, no target	Whether buyers want the source behind a line
Share rate	Quotes shared with family / quotes created	No sharing exists today	Set after 4 weeks	H2: the family decision moves into the product
Share-to-resume rate	Shared quotes resumed by the buyer within 14 days / quotes shared	New	Set after 4 weeks	H2: sharing brings buyers back, not away
Explainer opened before health questions	Quote-holders who open the pre-declaration explainer / quote-holders who reach health questions	New	Tracked, no target	H3
Health-question completion	Quote-holders who finish the health questions / those who start them	Acko internal	No drop vs control	H3: explaining consequences doesn't scare buyers off
Quick-check accuracy	Correct answers on the waiting-period question / quick-check answers (opt-in)	53% wrong or unsure in research	Clear improvement	Comprehension, where buyers choose to test it

Lagging indicators take weeks to months and tell us whether the business moved.

Metric	Definition	Baseline	Target	Validates
14-day confirmed purchase rate	Confirmed purchases within 14 days / first-time quote-holders	12%	26% by month 6	The brief's goal; the experiment's primary metric
30-day purchase rate	Confirmed purchases within 30 days / first-time quote-holders	Acko internal	Tracked beside the 14-day rate	Whether sharing delays decisions rather than losing them (Step 5)

Metric	Definition	Baseline	Target	Validates
Counteroffer acceptance	Accepted counteroffers / counteroffers issued	Acko internal	Up vs control	H3: buyers with a declared condition see and accept the loading
Renewal rate	Policies renewed at year 1 / policies due	Acko internal (market benchmark 89%)	At or above control	Loop 1
Members added at renewal	Members added / policies renewed that covered one person	New	Set from cohort 1 data	Loop 2
Referred quotes	New first-time quotes started from a shared page	New (needs L3)	Set from cohort 1 data	Loop 3
Premium per 10,000 quote-holders	First-year premium from confirmed purchases	Rs 1.80 cr (Step 5 model)	Rs 3.90 cr	Business impact (Step 5)

3. Guardrail metrics

Each guardrail is compared against the control group (or the holdout once rolled out). A breach stops the rollout of that cohort, as set out in the Step 4 stop criteria and the Step 5 rollout plan.

Guardrail	Definition	Baseline	Threshold	If breached
Free-look cancellations	Policies cancelled within the 30-day free look / policies issued	Acko internal	No increase vs control	Stop the cohort; review which screens the cancelling buyers saw and skipped
Post-purchase confusion	Support contacts in the first 90 days tagged 'what's covered', 'waiting period' or 'exclusion', per 100 policies	Acko internal	No increase vs control; aim for a decrease	Review the contact transcripts against the panel copy; fix the content map
Claim disputes over misunderstood terms	Claims rejected or contested for a waiting period, exclusion or undisclosed condition, plus grievances and ombudsman complaints on those topics, per 1,000 policies in the first 12 months	Acko internal	Decrease vs control	Escalate to Compliance; check whether the rejection reason was shown on the buyer's screens
Purchases that never saw key limits	Payments with no 'summary viewed' event before payment / all payments	Not measured today	0%	Treat as a bug: block the release and fix the payment path
Time to pay	Median minutes from quote to payment	Acko internal	No more than 1 minute above control (assumption to validate)	Pause and test a lighter summary

Guardrail	Definition	Baseline	Threshold	If breached
Drop-off at health questions	Quote-holders who leave at the health questions / those who reach them	Acko internal	No increase vs control	Rewrite the explainer card

Why claim disputes need 12 months: most first-year claims under a listed-condition or pre-existing waiting period happen months after purchase. The early read is the support-contact guardrail; the dispute guardrail confirms it over the first policy year.

4. Event tracking specification

Every event carries the same core properties: anonymous user ID, quote ID, cohort and variant, language, platform (app or web), first-time buyer flag and timestamp. **Privacy rule:** analytics record whether a member declared a condition (yes or no), never the condition itself, and the shared page sends no personal data back.

Event	Fires when	Key properties	Feeds
quote_created	A first-time buyer sees their first quote	members, age bands, covers_parent, sum_insured	Every rate's denominator
health_explainer_viewed	The pre-declaration explainer is opened or scrolled into view	time_on_card	Explainer opened
health_questions_completed	The buyer submits the health questions	declared_condition (yes or no, per member)	Health-question completion and drop-off
limits_panel_expanded	'When you'd still pay' is expanded	lines_shown	Limits panel opened
timeline_viewed	The waiting-period timeline is expanded	members_shown	Limits panel or timeline opened
worked_example_viewed	A 'You pay / Plan pays' example comes into view	example_id, outcome	Worked example viewed
clause_opened	A clause link or the full list is opened	clause_id	Clause link opened
term_definition_opened	A dotted-underline term is tapped	term	Content review
sum_insured_changed	The buyer changes the sum insured	from, to	Price sensitivity
premium_breakdown_viewed	The per-member breakdown is shown or expanded	has_may_change_tag	Breakdown use
share_sent	The buyer shares the plan	surface, language, format (link or PDF)	Share rate
shared_page_opened	Anyone opens a shared link	share_id, language, days_since_share	Share reach

Event	Fires when	Key properties	Feeds
shared_faq_opened	A family question on the shared page is opened	question_id	Content review
quote_resumed	The buyer returns to a saved or shared quote	source (share, reminder, direct), days_since_quote	Share-to-resume rate
summary_viewed	The one-screen summary is shown before payment	time_on_screen	Key-limits guardrail
quick_check_answered	A quick-check question is answered or skipped	question_id, correct, skipped	Quick-check accuracy
payment_succeeded	Payment completes	policy_id, premium, summary_viewed_before (yes or no)	Purchase rates, time to pay, key-limits guardrail
counteroffer_issued / _accepted / _declined / _expired	Underwriting issues a counteroffer and the buyer responds, or the deadline passes	loading band, days_to_respond	Counteroffer acceptance
free_look_cancelled	A policy is cancelled within the free look	days_since_issue, reason	Free-look guardrail, North Star
support_contact_tagged	A support contact is tagged with a coverage topic	topic, days_since_purchase	Post-purchase confusion
claim_decided	A claim is settled, rejected or contested	outcome, reason category (waiting period, exclusion, undisclosed condition, other)	Claim disputes
complaint_logged	A grievance or ombudsman complaint is logged	category, channel	Claim disputes
policy_renewed	A policy renews	sum_insured_change, members_added	Renewal rate, members added
voice_entry_tapped	'Ask about this plan' is tapped	screen	Demand for phase 2

Ownership: Data science owns the event schema and the experiment readouts; the PM reviews leading indicators and guardrails weekly; Compliance and Claims review the dispute guardrail monthly. Readouts happen at week 14, week 18 and month 6 (Step 5), and the dispute guardrail at month 12.

Step 6 summary

Item	Result
North Star	Confident purchase rate: confirmed within 14 days, saw the key limits, kept past the free look; 26% by month 6
Leading indicators	Panel and timeline opened, examples viewed, share and share-to-resume rates, explainer opened, health-question completion, quick-check accuracy

Item	Result
Lagging indicators	14-day and 30-day purchase rates, counteroffer acceptance, renewal rate, members added, referred quotes, premium per 10,000
Guardrails	Free-look cancellations, post-purchase confusion, claim disputes, purchases that never saw key limits (0%), time to pay, health-question drop-off
Tracking	27 events (24 rows above) with shared core properties; no health conditions in analytics

Step 7: Risks, Trade-offs & Constraints

Headline: the biggest risk isn't that the design fails to lift conversion. It's that it lifts conversion in the wrong way: a simplified line that leaves out a limit, a worked example that's wrong for one buyer's schedule, or buyers who pay because the screens felt reassuring rather than because they understood. Every mitigation below comes back to three habits: generate every line from the policy wording and the buyer's own quote, have Compliance approve it in every language, and measure regret as closely as purchases.

1. Risk assessment with mitigations

Likelihood and impact are PM judgements (High, Medium, Low) to rank the risks, not measured probabilities.

1.1 Regulatory risk

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early signal	Owner
A simplified line leaves out or changes a limit, which reads as mis-selling. IRDAI doesn't allow disclosures to be shortened to lift conversion.	Medium	High	Every line comes from the structured map of the policy wording, keyed by UIN, variant and clause, and links to its clause. The CIS, proposal form, consent and free-look text stay exactly as today (PRD 2.8).	Complaints tagged 'not told'; Compliance spot checks	Compliance
New content reads as advice: telling a buyer which plan, cover amount or declaration is right for them.	Medium	High	The new components state what the policy does, never what the buyer should do. Banned phrasing ('you should', 'best for you') is enforced in copy review (section 4).	Copy review findings; support transcripts	PM, Compliance
A translation changes the meaning of a limit.	Medium	High	Each language is approved by Compliance before launch, with a back-translation check. A missing string falls back to English instead of showing a guess (PRD 2.7).	Language-level complaint rate	Content, Compliance
The share pack exposes health information, which is sensitive personal data under the DPDP Act 2023.	Low	High	The pack carries plan terms and first names only, never health declarations. Links expire in 14 days, and analytics never record a condition (Step 6).	Privacy review before launch	Engineering, Legal
A referral reward counts as an inducement. Section 41 of the Insurance Act prohibits rebates to buy insurance.	Low	High	No cash or discount rewards for referrals (Step 5 loop rules).	Not applicable: designed out	PM

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early signal	Owner
Disclosure rules or formats change, for example the CIS format or Bima Sugam.	Medium	Medium	Change the content map once and every screen and the share pack update together.	IRDAI circulars	Compliance

1.2 Explanations that are wrong or oversimplified

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early signal	Owner
A worked example or timeline is wrong for one buyer, because waiting periods and special conditions differ by variant, UIN and underwriting outcome.	Medium	High	Examples and timelines are generated from the buyer's own quote schedule, never a generic template. If the schedule isn't available, the screen says 'your schedule decides' and shows no month numbers. QA covers each variant and the loaded-member case.	QA failures; support contacts on timelines	Engineering
The five 'when you'd still pay' lines are read as the complete list.	Medium	Medium	A line under the panel heading says these are the main situations, not all of them; 'See all 16 listed conditions' and the clause links sit in the same panel.	Clause and full-list opens (Step 6)	Design
A timeline marker is read as a guarantee, for example 'covered from month 25' read as covered whatever happens.	Medium	Medium	Every marker reads 'subject to policy terms'. Non-disclosure stays a line of its own in the panel.	Quick-check answers; post-purchase confusion	Content
The loading breakdown in the app doesn't match the counteroffer letter.	Low	High	Both are generated from the same underwriting record, and a reconciliation check runs before the app screen is shown.	Mismatch alerts	Underwriting, Engineering
The phase 2 voice assistant gives a wrong or advice-like spoken answer.	Medium	High	It answers only from the policy wording and the buyer's quote, names the clause, declines medical and financial questions and hands over to a person when unsure. It doesn't launch until the Step 8 prototype passes its accuracy check.	Step 8 accuracy test	PM

1.3 Conversion that rises alongside regret

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Early signal	Owner
Buyers pay because the screens felt reassuring, not because they understood: the '100%' promise still dominates.	Medium	High	'100%' always reads 'for covered treatment' and always sits beside 'When you'd still pay'. The North Star leaves out free-look cancellations (Step 6).	Free-look cancellations vs control	PM
Family pressure through the share pack pushes a buyer who isn't sure.	Low	Medium	The pack shows the same limits the buyer saw, has no countdowns or urgency, and the buyer resumes on their own.	Free looks among shared quotes	PM
Early lift is a novelty effect or a seasonal swing.	Medium	Medium	A 5% holdout runs to month 6; the decision is made on the holdout comparison, not on week-one numbers (Step 5).	Lift shrinking over time	Data science
Disputes rise a year later, after the rollout has been declared a success.	Low	High	The claim-dispute guardrail runs for 12 months, with a readout at month 12 (Step 6).	Support contacts in the first 90 days	Claims, Compliance

1.4 Delivery risks

Risk	Likelihood	Impact	Mitigation	Owner
Underwriting can't expose counteroffer data to the app by week 8.	Medium	Medium	Ship A1 to A5, A7 and B on time; the counteroffer letter stays as today until A6 is ready.	Underwriting
Honest limits put off buyers who would have bought: the friction cost in Step 5.	Medium	Medium	No mandatory step; the panel is collapsed; time-to-pay guardrail at one minute; lost-buyer cost tracked.	PM
Parent-buyer traffic can't fill the test in four weeks.	Medium	Low	Open cohort 1 to all first-time quote-holders and read parent buyers as a pre-registered segment (Step 5).	Data science
Support and the follow-up call give answers that differ from the screens.	Medium	Medium	Train the teams on the same content map and family FAQ before week 10 (Step 5).	Customer support

2. Trade-off analysis

What we consciously chose not to optimise for. Step 3 compared the two solutions; this table covers the choices behind the whole proposal.

We chose	Over	Why	What it costs us	We'd revisit if
Understanding	Speed to payment	The brief counts a purchase only if the buyer chose and confirmed it; 53% misread a basic waiting-period case	Some fast buyers drop; 5% of today's buyers is 60 policies per 10,000 (Step 5)	Time to pay rises more than 1 minute vs control
Honest limits next to the promise	A clean '100% of the bill' headline	A promise without its limits is what buyers misread; the brief's condition is 'no buried fine print'	A less striking headline; some buyers decide the plan isn't for them	Never: this is the brief's condition
Explaining	Recommending	Personalised advice is out of scope and needs a licensed advisor	Buyers who want to be told what to buy still go to agents (12 of 68 relied most on an agent or bank)	Acko adds a licensed advice channel
Parent buyers first	The largest or easiest segment	The widest gap between intent and purchase (25% vs 56%) and every feature in use	The test fills more slowly	Volume is short after four weeks
Keeping phone and OTP before price in v1	Removing lead capture now	It's Acko's existing model and needs its own test; we kept v1 to one change	Some buyers who fear spam calls still drop (10 of 68 named sales calls)	v1.1 test of price before phone number
Text first, voice later	Voice in v1	A wrong spoken answer is the costliest error, and nobody asked for voice directly	Buyers who prefer to listen wait until phase 2	The Step 8 prototype passes its accuracy check
The brief's 14-day measure	A longer window	It's the brief's definition and keeps the experiment fast	Shared quotes that convert on day 20 aren't credited	30-day rate runs well above the 14-day rate
Plan terms only in the share pack	A personalised pack with health details	Health data is sensitive and the family member may not be the one to see it	The family sees less detail about the declared member	Never in v1
No new marketing during the test	Driving more quotes	A clean comparison with the 12% baseline	No growth in quote volume for the first months	After full rollout (motor customers first)

3. Constraints and assumptions

3.1 Constraints that shape v1

Type	Constraint	What it means for v1
Regulatory	IRDAI: disclosures, exclusions and consent can't be shortened to lift conversion; the CIS is required with every policy	New content adds views alongside the required documents; nothing required is removed or reworded
Regulatory	IRDAI health rules: waiting periods capped at 36 months, 60-month moratorium, 30-day free look	The timeline and the explainer use these limits; free look is part of the North Star
Regulatory	Section 41 of the Insurance Act: no rebates or inducements	No referral rewards or discounts
Regulatory	DPDP Act 2023: health data is sensitive personal data	No health details in the share pack or analytics
Underwriting	Premiums are personalised after details and medical history; loadings come through a counteroffer after application, with 7 working days to respond (clause 5.2.14)	We can't show a final price for a declared condition before underwriting. v1 explains what can happen, tags the member and itemises the outcome when it arrives
Underwriting	Underwriting rules and pricing are out of scope	We show outcomes of underwriting, never the rules
Product	Acko's flow asks for a phone number and OTP before the price	Kept in v1; tested in v1.1
Product	The retail plan in the teardown has no add-ons, no co-pay and no room-rent limit	v1 shows none; a line is added only if a variant offers one (PRD 2.7)
Product	A confirmed purchase must be the buyer's own selections; agent overrides don't count	Agent-assisted journeys stay outside the experiment cohort
Product	Acko already offers four languages	English, Hindi, Kannada and Tamil at launch

3.2 Assumptions to validate

Assumption	Where it's used	How we'll validate it
Survey respondents behave like Acko's quote-holders (the survey's 38% purchase rate vs Acko's 12% shows they're more engaged)	Steps 2 to 5	Compare survey patterns with Acko's funnel data in week 1
Average first-year premium of Rs 15,000	Steps 2 and 5	Replace with Acko's figure
89% renewal rate (Policybazaar online benchmark)	Step 5	Acko's renewal data
About 45% of first-time quote-holders declare a condition	Step 3 RICE reach	Health-question data (Step 6 event)
Time to pay can rise by up to one minute without losing buyers	Steps 4 to 6 guardrail	Cohort 1 data: time to pay vs conversion
The buyer's waiting-period schedule is available at quote time	A2, A3 worked examples	Engineering check in weeks 1 to 2

Assumption	Where it's used	How we'll validate it
Underwriting can expose counteroffer data to the app	A6	Underwriting confirms in weeks 1 to 2
Translations can be approved in weeks 7 to 9	Launch at week 10	Compliance plan agreed in week 1
Effort estimates (about 7.5 person-months)	Step 3 RICE, Step 5	Engineering sizing in week 1

4. What we will not build, and how we avoid acting as an unlicensed advisor

4.1 Out of scope for v1

- **A 'best plan for you' engine or personalised recommendations.** It would be advice, and Step 3 dropped the guided cover chooser for this reason.
- **Cross-insurer comparison.** Acko explains its own plans; neutral comparison across insurers is what aggregators and Bima Sugam are for.
- **Discounts, urgency, fear messaging or aggressive notifications.** All ruled out by the brief.
- **Changes to underwriting rules, pricing or claims operations.** Out of scope; we show their outcomes only.
- **A live voice assistant in v1.** It's prototyped in Step 8 and launches in phase 2 only if it passes its accuracy check.
- **Referral rewards and reminders the buyer didn't opt into.**
- **Any shortened version of a required disclosure.**

4.2 Rules that keep the product on the right side of advice

Rule	What it looks like in the product
Say what the policy says, and cite it	Every line in A1 to A7 and B1 links to its clause in the policy wording
Never say what the buyer should do	No 'you should', 'best for you' or 'we recommend' in the new components; the copy review checks for these phrases
Examples illustrate the wording; they don't predict the buyer's health	Worked examples describe a situation ('if Mother needs cataract surgery in month 10') and what the clause does, never what is likely to happen to this buyer
Explain outcomes, not choices	The pre-declaration explainer says what declaring can lead to and what not declaring can lead to; it never tells the buyer whether to declare
Hand over when a question is personal	Questions about which plan, how much cover or a medical condition go to Acko's support team, not the product
The same rules bind the voice assistant	It answers only from the wording and the quote, names the clause, and declines medical and financial advice (Step 8)

Acko's existing screens already include 'Our recommendation' and a recommended sum insured. Those are Acko's own product decisions as the insurer and stay as they are; nothing in this proposal adds advice on top of them.

Step 7 summary

Item	Result
Top risks	A simplified line that misstates a limit; a worked example wrong for one buyer's schedule; conversion that rises with regret
Core mitigation	Every line generated from the policy wording and the buyer's quote, approved in every language, with regret measured as closely as purchases

Item	Result
Main trade-offs	Understanding over speed, honest limits over a clean headline, explaining over recommending, text before voice
Constraints	IRDAI disclosure rules, the Insurance Act on inducements, DPDP on health data, underwriting after application, phone before price in v1
Not building	Recommendations, cross-insurer comparison, discounts or urgency, pricing or claims changes, live voice in v1, referral rewards

Step 8: Vibe Coding & Automation

Headline: a working 'Ask about this plan' assistant, the voice policy assistant from Step 3's top 5. A buyer asks a question by voice or text in English, Hindi, Kannada or Tamil, and the answer comes only from the Acko Health II policy wording and their own quote, with the exact clause words shown beside it. Claude drafts each answer, but the page checks the draft in code before the buyer sees it: if a quote isn't word for word, a number can't be traced, or the answer sounds like advice, the buyer gets the clause itself instead. That check is what makes the strategic bet safe enough to take to phase 2.

1. The use case: where AI creates leverage

Solution A answers the questions most buyers have, on fixed screens. The long tail doesn't fit on a screen: 'Can I add my father later?', 'What if I didn't mention something?', asked in four languages about a 40-page wording. Today buyers take those questions elsewhere, so that's where AI earns its place.

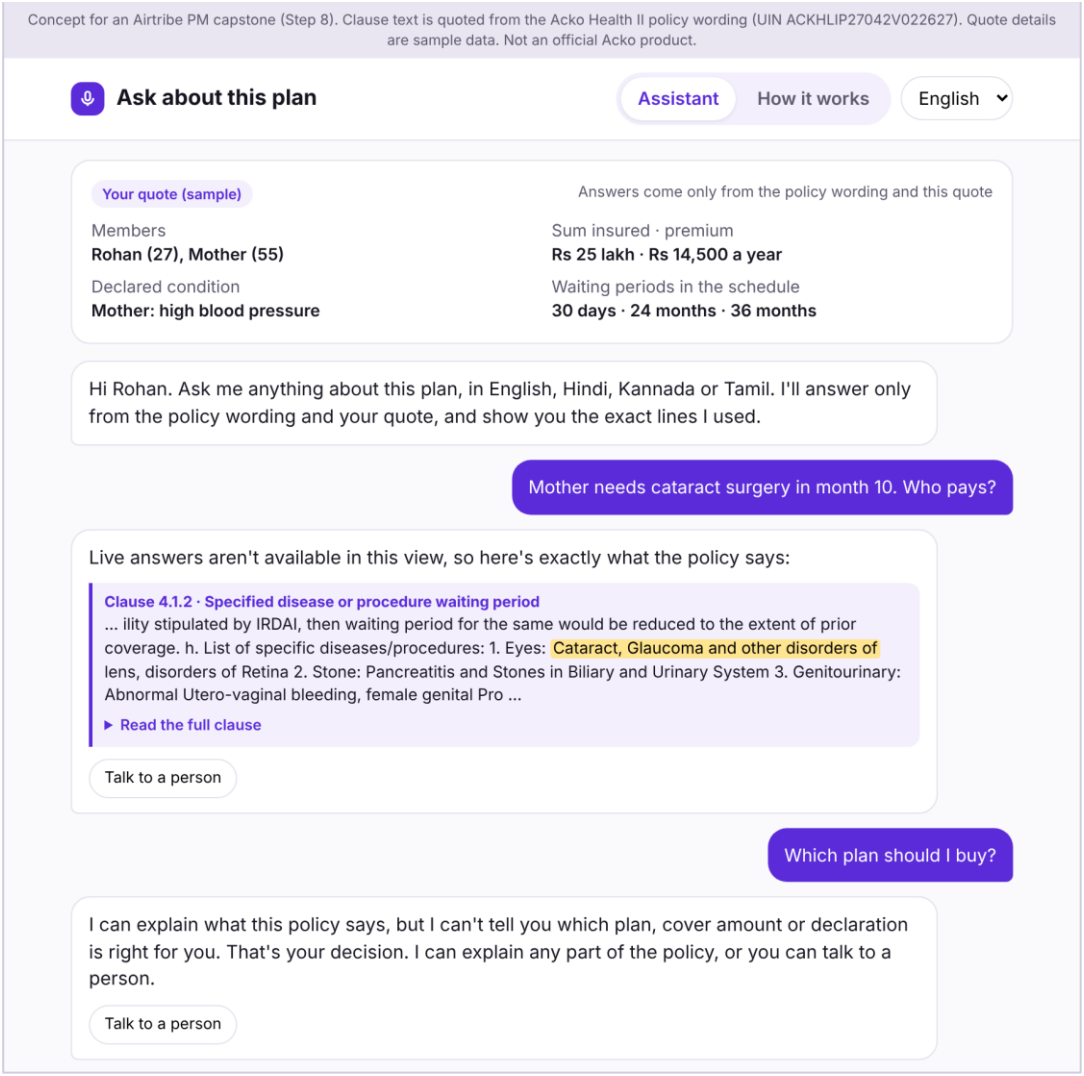
What the research shows	Why AI fits
Interviewees already use ChatGPT, Gemini, Google and YouTube to decode clauses; one wants 'someone who can explain all the clauses'	The behaviour exists; the assistant brings it back to Acko, where the answer can be tied to the actual policy
10 of 68 wanted a neutral explainer with no sales pressure	An assistant that only explains, never sells, and hands over when asked
21 of 68 prefer a language other than English; 37 of 68 buy for family	Claude answers in the buyer's language, and a parent can ask by voice instead of reading
53% misread a basic waiting-period scenario	Answers state the outcome for this buyer's quote and show the clause behind it

The risk AI adds: a confident wrong answer about cover is the costliest error in the whole proposal (Step 7). So the build is less about getting Claude to answer and more about stopping it from saying anything the policy doesn't.

2. Working demo

Link: https://sagarn9918.github.io/Acko-Health-Insurance/Policy_Assistant.html

- **Ask by text or voice:** type, or tap the mic (works in Chrome and the Claude desktop app). Tap 'Listen' to hear the answer read aloud.
- **Four languages:** switch at the top; Claude answers in that language, and the clause quotes stay in the original English wording.
- **Sample quote:** Rohan (27) and Mother (55, declared high blood pressure), Rs 25 lakh, Rs 14,500 a year, with sample waiting periods of 30 days, 24 months and 36 months: the same buyer as the Step 4 prototype.
- **Knowledge:** 20 clauses taken word for word from the Acko Health II policy wording (UIN ACKHLIP27042V022627), including waiting periods, exclusions, disclosure, free look, adding a member, portability, loadings, the moratorium and claims.
- **Where Claude isn't available** (for example a plain browser outside Claude), it still works: it finds the matching clause and shows the policy text itself, with the relevant words highlighted.



Above: a waiting-period question answered with the clause and the matching words highlighted (the view outside Claude), and 'Which plan should I buy?' declined with an offer to talk to a person.

3. How it avoids stating anything the policy wording doesn't

Grounding comes from what the model is given and what the page lets through, not from trusting the model.

Step	What happens	Why it keeps the answer inside the wording
1. Route	Claude (fast model) sorts the question into policy, advice, medical or other, and picks up to 3 clauses from the fixed list of 20	Advice and medical questions never reach the answer step; they get a fixed, pre-written reply and an offer to talk to a person
2. Draft	Claude gets the question, the quote facts and the full text of the chosen clauses, nothing else, and must return JSON with the answer, the same answer in English, and the exact words it relied on	The prompt bans anything not in the text, bans advice, and requires 'cannot answer' when the text doesn't cover it
3. Check in code	The page runs five checks on the draft (table below)	The checks are deterministic: the model can't talk its way past them

Step	What happens	Why it keeps the answer inside the wording
4. Show or fall back	A passing draft is shown with its quotes highlighted and the checks it passed. A failing draft is thrown away, and the buyer sees the clause text and 'Talk to a person'	The worst case is a buyer reading the real policy text, never a made-up summary

The five checks, run in the page:

Check	Rule
Citations exist	At least one citation, each to a clause that was actually sent to Claude
Quotes are exact	Each quote appears word for word in its clause (spacing and quote marks normalised), at least 4 words long
Numbers are grounded	Every number in the English and the translated answer appears in the cited clauses, the quote facts or the question. A waiting period's end month (month 25 after a 24-month wait) is allowed
No advice	None of: you should, we recommend, I recommend, I suggest, best plan, best option, best for you, you must, guaranteed, don't worry
Short	120 words or fewer in English

Tested before publishing. The checker was run on four drafts for 'Mother needs cataract surgery in month 10. Who pays?':

Draft	Result	Caught by
Correct answer quoting clause 4.1.2 word for word	Shown	Passed all checks
Same answer plus 'the wait is 18 months for knees'	Replaced by clause text	Numbers: 18 isn't in the clause, the quote or the question
Same answer starting 'You should buy the higher cover'	Replaced by clause text	No advice: 'you should'
Answer citing a made-up line ('cataract surgery is always covered from day one of the policy')	Replaced by clause text	Quotes: not found in clause 4.1.2

What the checks can't catch, and the plan for it: a number that exists in the sources but is used wrongly (saying 36 months for cataract when 36 is Mother's pre-existing wait) would pass the number check. Showing the clause quote under every answer makes this visible to the buyer, and the phase 2 launch bar below adds a reviewed test set to catch it before launch. Translated answers are checked for numbers only, so native-speaker review is part of that test set.

4. How it fits the journey

Where	What the buyer does	Phase
S13 to S17 (plan, price, details, summary)	Taps the purple 'Ask about this plan' button already in the Step 4 prototype and asks about their own quote	v1: the button is a placeholder that measures demand (Step 6 event voice_entry_tapped). Phase 2: live

Where	What the buyer does	Phase
Before the health questions (S10)	Asks 'What happens if I declare Mother's BP?' and hears the loading, waiting-period and moratorium rules	Phase 2
Shared family page	A parent asks in their own language	Later phase: plan terms only, with no health declarations sent to Claude, to keep the share pack's privacy rule
Any answer	'Talk to a person' hands over to the support team	Phase 2

It never sits in the purchase path: it's optional, so it can't slow anyone down (Step 3 trade-off). It launches as cohort 4 in the Step 5 rollout, starting with an opt-in group in each language. Phase 2 adds three events to the Step 6 specification: assistant_question_asked (category, language, voice or text), assistant_answer_checked (passed or fell back, and which check failed) and assistant_handover_requested.

Launch bar for phase 2: a test set of about 100 real questions, drawn from the survey and interviews and covering all four languages, reviewed by Compliance and native speakers. Zero answers that state something the wording doesn't, every advice and medical question declined, and the fallback rate measured and reported.

5. Prompts and logic used

Models: Claude through the artifact platform. Routing uses the fast model tier; drafting uses the default tier. No answer is cached, so each question is checked fresh.

Prompt 1: router

```
You route questions for a health-insurance policy explainer. The buyer has a quote and asks a question, possibly in Hindi, Kannada, Tamil or English.

Classify the question:
- "policy": asks what the policy or this quote says, covers, excludes, or how a process works.
- "advice": asks which plan, cover amount, add-on or declaration they should choose, whether to buy, or how this compares with other insurers.
- "medical": asks about their health, symptoms, treatment or medicines.
- "other": anything else.

For "policy", pick up to 3 clause ids from the list that contain the answer. Use only ids from the list.

Return JSON only, no prose:
{"category":"policy|advice|medical|other","clause_ids":["..."],"question_en":"the question in English"}

CLAUSE LIST (id | title):
{list of the 20 clauses: id | title}

QUESTION:
{buyer's question}
```

Prompt 2: grounded answer

You explain a health-insurance policy to a first-time buyer. Use ONLY the QUOTE FACTS and POLICY TEXT below.

Rules:
1. Do not add any fact, number, condition, time period or example that is not in the QUOTE FACTS or POLICY TEXT.
2. Do not recommend anything or tell the buyer what they should do. Do not give medical advice.
3. If the QUOTE FACTS and POLICY TEXT don't answer the question, set "cannot_answer" to true and leave the answer empty.
4. For every point you make, copy the exact words you relied on from the POLICY TEXT: 6 to 30 consecutive words, character for character, from one clause.
5. Plain language, short sentences, at most 70 words. Write numbers as digits (0-9), also in the translated answer.
6. When you say something is covered, add "subject to the policy terms".
7. Write "answer_en" in English and "answer" in {selected language}. Both must say the same thing.

Return JSON only, no prose:
{"cannot_answer":false,"answer_en":"...","answer":"...","citations":[{"clause_id":"...","quote":"..."}]}

QUESTION:
{question in English}

QUOTE FACTS:
{quote facts, listed below}

POLICY TEXT:
{full text of the clauses chosen by the router}

Quote facts sent with every question (sample data):

- Policy: Acko Health II (sample quote). Members: Rohan, age 27; Mother, age 55.
- Sum insured: Rs 25 lakh (2500000). Premium: Rs 14,500 a year for both members.
- Mother has declared high blood pressure. Rohan has declared no condition.
- Waiting periods in this sample schedule: initial waiting period 30 days for any illness (not accidents); listed conditions (clause 4.1.2, including cataract) 24 months; Mother's declared pre-existing condition (high blood pressure and its direct complications) 36 months.
- Room rent: no limit on this plan. Co-pay: none. Add-ons: none.
- The policy has not started yet; months are counted from the start of the first policy.

Clause library (20 clauses, quoted word for word from the policy wording):

Clause	Topic
3.2.1	In-patient hospitalisation
3.2.2	Room rent and ICU
3.2.4	Pre- and post-hospitalisation expenses
4.1.1	Pre-existing diseases
4.1.2	Specified disease or procedure waiting period
4.1.3	30-day waiting period
4.1.8	Cosmetic or plastic surgery

Clause	Topic
4.2.1	Non-payable expenses
4.2.3	Permanent exclusions (cannot be waived)
5.1.1	Disclosure of information
5.1.13	Renewal of policy
5.1.16	Free look period
5.1.18	Change of sum insured
5.2.7	Adding or removing a member
5.2.13	Portability
6.1.3	Cashless claims
6.1.4	Reimbursement claims
5.2.14	Underwriting loadings and conditions
Def 33	Moratorium period (definition 33)
Def 19	Grace period (definition 19)

Fixed replies (not generated): advice, medical, off-topic, cannot answer and fallback messages are written in advance in all four languages, so a refusal can never drift into advice.

Step 8 summary

Item	Result
Use case	Answers the long tail of policy questions, by voice or text, in four languages, about the buyer's own quote
Working demo	https://claude.ai/artifact/YKXkpG1EW1oS8ZBZxpptm2
How it stays within the wording	Answers drafted only from 20 policy clauses and the quote; five checks run in code; failing drafts replaced by the clause text
Fit in the journey	'Ask about this plan' on S13 to S17; phase 2 in the Step 5 rollout; hands over to a person
Prompts and logic	Router and grounded-answer prompts, verifier rules, quote facts and clause library, all listed above